



ANNUAL REPORT 24 / 25

**BREWARRINA
SHIRE COUNCIL**



ACKNOWLEDGMENT OF COUNTRY

The shire of Brewarrina respectfully acknowledges the Traditional Owners of our land, the Ngemba, Murrawarri, Euahlayi, Weilwan, Ualarai and Baranbinja peoples, and pay our respect to their Elders past, present and emerging.

We acknowledge and honour the unbroken spiritual, cultural and political connection they have maintained to this unique place for more than 2,000 generations.

Within this country, many cultures reside. We are committed to acknowledging the vital importance and contribution of First Nation people in strengthening and enriching our region. We respect and are dedicated to conserving First Nations cultural practices, traditional sites and significant places.



CONTENTS

Acknowledgement	2
PART 1	
ANNUAL REPORT SECTION 428	4
Mayor’s Message	8
General Manager	10
Introduction	12
Services Reports – Council Departments	18
Statutory information	61
Government Information (Public Access) Act 2009 (NSW)	65
PART 2	
ANNUAL REPORT ON ACTIVITIES	66
Delivery Program Actions	67
PART 3	
ANNUAL FINANCIAL REPORT	71

PART 1

ANNUAL REPORT

Section 428

The 2024/2025 Annual Report is a statutory reporting mechanism that documents the performance and achievements of Brewarrina Shire Council from 1 July 2024 to 30 June 2025.

The report serves as a point of reference for the Council, its staff, residents, community organisations, government departments and other stakeholders, measuring the outcomes achieved against projections in the Delivery Program and Operational Plan.

Brewarrina Shire Council is committed to engaging with its community and providing services that are responsive to community and visitor needs. The Annual Report provides the community and stakeholders with an opportunity to assess Council's performance and achievements.





MAYOR'S MESSAGE

Councillor Tom Stanton

In Memory of Councillor Angelo Pippas OAM

On behalf of Brewarrina Shire Council, I would like to acknowledge and pay tribute to the late Councillor Angelo Pippas OAM, whose passing in December 2024 was deeply felt across our entire community.

Angelo's remarkable contribution to local government and public life spanned more than 50 years of dedicated service to the people of Brewarrina. His steadfast commitment, wisdom and tireless advocacy for our town and its residents will forever be remembered as a legacy of integrity and community spirit.

Angelo's impact extended far beyond the Council chamber. He was a respected leader, mentor and friend whose passion for Brewarrina was evident in everything he did. His vision and dedication helped shape our community for generations to come, and his influence will continue to be felt through the projects, partnerships and progress he championed throughout his long and distinguished career.

This Annual Report is dedicated to the memory of Councillor Angelo Pippas OAM, in recognition of his lifetime of service, his unwavering commitment to Brewarrina, and the enduring example he leaves for all who follow in public life.

On behalf of Brewarrina Shire Council, I extend my sincerest gratitude to the community for your unwavering support and engagement throughout the 2024/2025 financial year. It has been a period marked by resilience, collaboration and meaningful progress—anchored in our shared commitment to enhancing the liveability, prosperity and cultural vitality of Brewarrina and its surrounding communities.



Driving Investment and Infrastructure

We are proud to report an unprecedented level of infrastructure activity: over \$30 million in projects have been either completed or are currently underway, with an additional \$4.5 million secured in further grant funding for Shared Paths in Brewarrina and Goodooga. Major highlights include:

- Completion of Jobs Gate Road Stage 3 in October 2025, with Stage 4 set to commence in November 2025. Completion is anticipated for early 2026 which will see the road finished to the Queensland Border.
- The Goodooga Road shoulder widening project, a 2.5 km safety upgrade under the Roads to Recovery and Block Grant program and completed in August 2025.
- Installation of key community assets including a public toilet facility at the Goodooga Cemetery in March 2025, the redevelopment of the Brewarrina Waste Facility and refurbishment works on both the Senior Citizens Room and a Mobile Resource Room.
- Delivery of shared path and solar lighting infrastructure in Weilmoringle (completed in July 2025) and Goodooga under the Active Transport program, significantly enhancing pedestrian safety and accessibility.

Strategic Planning and Budgeting

At the May 2025 Ordinary Meeting, Council endorsed the 2025–2026 Operational Plan, including a capital works program, revised fees and charges, and a modest 4.1 percent rate peg increase, positioned one percent below IPART's

maximum. The Plan forecasts a \$29.67 million budget across all funds, delivering a \$2.05 million cash surplus after depreciation and capital expenses for the upcoming year.

Enhancing Active and Cultural Spaces

Our successful Active Transport Strategy has gained national recognition, with \$4 million in Federal funding allocated toward vital pathway projects. This includes:

- A \$3 million project to deliver safe, solar-lit pedestrian and cycle paths in Brewarrina, connecting the town centre to the Barwon River and the culturally significant Baiame's Ngunnhu (Aboriginal Fish Traps).
- A \$1 million pathway in Goodooga linking the town centre to the Artesian Baths, equipped with shaded rest areas, lighting, water fountains and interpretive signage celebrating cultural heritage.

In addition, we were delighted to revive the Brewarrina Community Careers Expo, offering local job seekers and future professionals an inspiring day of opportunity. The famed Bald Archy Exhibition also returned to our Visitor Information Centre, once again bringing creativity and laughter to our community.

A significant cultural milestone has been the acquisition of \$25,000 in funding for a new Heritage Advisor, enriching our capacity to preserve and celebrate our rich Indigenous and community heritage.

Resilience, Responsiveness and Civic Renewal

Council has continued to strengthen core operations and governance. Efforts include:

- Preparing for the installation of livestreaming capabilities for Council meetings, enhancing transparency and community access which will be implemented in December 2026.
- Implementing annual unsealed road grading programs, including extensive work on Narran Lake Road, Goodooga Brenda Road, Byrock Nidgery Road, West Culgoa Road, and more; ensuring consistent road safety across the Shire.
- Supporting the reactivation of the Brewarrina Golf Club—a community-led initiative aimed at reviving a cherished social and sporting asset, with structured support to ensure sustainability.

Acknowledging Our Team

I would also like to take this opportunity to thank Council staff for their hard work, professionalism and commitment throughout the year. Their willingness to engage in professional development and build new skills has ensured that we continue to strengthen our organisational capacity. Most importantly, their dedication to delivering quality infrastructure and essential community services has benefited every township and locality across the Shire. It is through their efforts that so many of the achievements highlighted in this report have been realised.

I also extend my appreciation to my fellow Councillors for their leadership, guidance and collective decision-making throughout the year. Each Councillor brings valuable insight, local knowledge and a strong sense of responsibility to the role. Together, we have worked constructively to address challenges, set priorities and make decisions that reflect the needs and aspirations of our community. The unity and collaboration of the elected Council has been critical in driving the achievements of 2024/2025.

Thank You

Most importantly, I want to thank the people of Brewarrina Shire—our residents, community leaders, volunteers and local businesses—for your commitment, resilience and community spirit. It is your engagement in consultations, your participation in local events, and your willingness to share ideas that ensure Council's plans and projects reflect the true needs of our towns and villages. From grassroots initiatives to regional partnerships, it is the community that gives meaning to Council's work and drives the progress we celebrate in this Annual Report.

As we close this chapter and look toward the new financial year, Council remains committed to building on this momentum. Our focus remains steadfast on delivering vital infrastructure, fostering economic opportunity, celebrating cultural identity and strengthening community cohesion across our Shire.

I am deeply proud of the progress we have made together. Thank you to our dedicated staff, volunteers, partners and every resident for contributing to the strength and vibrancy of Brewarrina Shire.

Thomas Stanton

Mayor

Brewarrina Shire Council

GENERAL MANAGER'S MESSAGE



“

It gives me great pleasure to present the General Manager's message for the 2024/2025 Annual Report. This year has been one of growth, renewal and collective achievement for Brewarrina Shire Council.

”

Despite the challenges faced by our community and the realities of operating in a rural and remote environment, our Council team staff, Councillors and community partners have demonstrated resilience, dedication and a shared vision for the future.

First and foremost, I would like to acknowledge and sincerely thank our staff for their tireless efforts. Across every department, our workforce has continued to deliver vital services, maintain our facilities and progress critical infrastructure projects with professionalism and commitment. Their willingness to embrace training, participate in professional development, and take on new roles has been central to building an organisation that is strong and future ready. I would also like to thank the Mayor and Councillors for their leadership and clear direction throughout the year. Their commitment to serving the community has ensured Council's decisions reflect both the immediate and long-term needs of the Shire. Finally, I extend my appreciation to our community, whose ongoing support, ideas and feedback continue to guide our priorities and remind us who we serve.

A key focus of the past year has been enhancing our asset management systems and prioritising infrastructure renewal. Council has made concerted efforts to address a backlog of renewal and upgrade works across all asset classes, from roads and pathways to community facilities and essential utilities.

This proactive approach to asset management will strengthen the long-term sustainability of our Shire's infrastructure and ensure it continues to meet the needs of residents and visitors well into the future.



We have also placed significant emphasis on renewing our Integrated Planning and Reporting (IP&R) framework. During the year, Council commenced work on a new Community Strategic Plan, which will replace our existing IP&R priorities. This process will be guided by strong community engagement and consultation, ensuring that the new plan reflects the current needs and aspirations of the Brewarrina Shire. Alongside this, Council has developed a more strategic approach to delivery planning and reporting, providing greater transparency and alignment between our operational work and community expectations with the introduction of an Audit Risk Improvement Committee (ARIC).

Supporting our people remains a cornerstone of Council's success. In 2024/2025, we increased investment in staff training and development to strengthen capability across all levels of the organisation. We undertook a comprehensive organisational structure review, creating clearer pathways for progression into senior management and team leader roles. By embedding succession planning into our workforce strategy, we are ensuring that Council not only meets today's challenges but also builds the leadership capacity needed to sustain growth and innovation into the future.

Several key strategies completed this year will shape our Shire for years to come. The completion of the Brewarrina Housing Strategy has provided a framework for addressing housing needs across all sectors including government, service providers and social housing. This strategy is critical for tackling one of the most pressing issues in our community and will guide Council's advocacy and partnerships to deliver new and appropriate housing solutions.

Similarly, the adoption of the Active Transport Plan has given Council the ability to begin implementing identified strategies for improving connectivity for pedestrians and cyclists across the Shire. The plan emphasises inclusive access, particularly for people with disability, and anticipates future growth needs to ensure Brewarrina remains connected, accessible and liveable.

Looking ahead, Council remains focused on strengthening governance, service delivery and community wellbeing. Our commitment to continuous improvement, transparency and collaboration will ensure that we remain a Council that our community can rely on. While much has been achieved this year, we know there is more to do. By working together—with our staff, Councillors, regional partners and most importantly our community—we can continue to deliver positive outcomes for Brewarrina Shire.

It is with great pride that I present this Annual Report and acknowledge the contributions of all who made the achievements of 2024/2025 possible. I look forward to building on this foundation in the year ahead.

David Kirby

General Manager
Brewarrina Shire Council

VALE COUNCILLOR ANGELO PIPPOS



“

The passing of Councillor Angelo Pippas OAM in December 2024 marked the end of an era for the Brewarrina Shire.

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Angelo's unparalleled dedication to the Brewarrina Shire Council spanned an incredible 50 years, beginning on February 8, 1974, when Angelo was officially sworn in as Councillor of Brewarrina Shire Council for the first time. During this time, he served as Mayor for 12 years and Deputy Mayor for 15 years, leading with vision, compassion and an unwavering commitment to the people of Brewarrina and the wider Western Division. His tireless work for our community is a testament to his deep love for this region and its people.

Angelo's contributions extended far beyond the Council chambers. He was a stalwart advocate for local services and projects, playing an active role on committees including what was known as the Brewarrina Town Improvement Committee, Traffic Committee, Big Sky Libraries and the Aged Care Units Committee, where his passion for the well-being of the elderly was unmatched. Angelo also supported Council staff and the General Manager with unwavering reliability, attending every community event, no matter how demanding his schedule. His presence was a source of strength and encouragement for us all.

Angelo's family business, Café Deluxe, was a cornerstone of the Brewarrina community, established by his father, who migrated to Australia in 1927. Angelo worked tirelessly to keep

the café running, creating a welcoming space for locals and visitors alike until it was tragically destroyed by fire in 2014. Through it all, Angelo exemplified resilience, determination and a commitment to service that defined his life. There isn't a single person who grew up in the Brewarrina District that doesn't have a story to share about Angelo and the café, as it laid out the very cultural fabric of our community.

Angelo's love for life extended to his passion for horse racing, as the proud owner of the legendary Gunsynd, the "Goondiwindi Grey." This pride not only highlighted his enthusiasm for the sport but also brought joy and recognition to our region.

Above all, Angelo's life was anchored by his greatest love – his wife Margie. Their unbreakable bond and partnership were a testament to the power of love and commitment, and Margie was his rock through every step of his journey.

Angelo Pippas' service to the Brewarrina Shire, its residents, and the entire Western Division will never be matched. His leadership, kindness and unwavering dedication to community will leave a lasting legacy that Brewarrina Shire Council is committed to upholding.



OUR SHIRE

Brewarrina | Goodooga | Gongolgon | Weilmoringle | Angledool

Brewarrina is a rural and remote community located in the north-west region of NSW on the banks of the Barwon River.

The Shire has a population of 1,356 people (ABS 2021), and includes the towns and villages of Brewarrina, Goodooga, Weilmoringle, Angledool and Gongolgon. It borders the state line of Queensland and is surrounded by the local government areas of Walgett, Warren, Bogan and Bourke.

Over 51 percent of the population in the Brewarrina Shire are First Nations, and the community is strongly grounded in its First Nations heritage. Brewarrina is home to what is believed to be the oldest human construction on earth, the National Heritage-listed Baiame's Ngunnhu (Brewarrina Fish Traps). The traps were one of the great inter-tribal meeting places in Eastern Australia for many nations of Aboriginal

peoples, including the Morawari, Barkinji, Weilwan, Kamilaroi, Koamu, Valarai, Baranbinja, Wiradjuri, Ngemba and Yualwarri tribes. They are still used today and continue to have a strong social, cultural and spiritual association for First Nations.

The Brewarrina Shire spans 19,000 square kilometres, covering approximately 2.4 percent of the total area of NSW, and contains less than 0.00025% of the total population, with one person for every 11.51 square kilometres.

The Shire population has steadily declined over the past eight census counts, with close to 500 people leaving the district since 1991. At the last census date, the majority of the Brewarrina population were under 39 years of age, with one quarter younger than 15 years. A greater proportion of these younger people are amongst the First Nations population.

Snapshot

1,356
People (ABS 2021)

51%
population are
First Nations

19,000
Square Kilometres



OUR VISION

ADVANCING COUNCIL SUSTAINABILITY TO BE A LEADER IN OUR COMMUNITY

OUR MISSION

LEAD OUR COMMUNITY THROUGH PROACTIVE COUNCILLOR PRESENTATION

- **Responsible asset management**
- **Fair resource allocation**
- **Efficient and effective staff service delivery**

OUR VALUES

The way we make decisions, take action and conduct business is defined by our values:

- **Honesty and integrity**
- **Meeting community expectations with resource constraints**
- **Open and transparent decision-making**
- **Equity in fair dealings**
- **Mutual respect and reliance**
- **Accountability for our actions**

To help us achieve:

- A safe and attractive working and living environment to attract skilled people and help boost the population
- Ensure quality and well-maintained infrastructure
- A community that encourages vitality and leadership
- Provide quality and cost-effective services partners with the community in decision-making
- Inclusive and encourage the development of young people

COUNCILLORS

			Council Meeting	Extraordinary Meeting
Mayor	Thomas Stanton	Elected Mayor September 2024	Attended: 10 Apology: 0	Attended: 2 Apology: 0
Deputy Mayor	Vivian Slack-Smith	Elected Deputy Mayor October 2024	Attended: 10 Apology: 0	Attended: 2 Apology: 0
Councillor	Angelo Pippas	Re-elected September 2024 Deceased December 2024	Attended: 4 Apology: 0	Attended: 2 Apology: 0
Councillor	Trish Frail	Re-elected September 2024	Attended: 7 Apology: 3	Attended: 1 Apology: 1
Councillor	Douglas Gordon	Re-elected September 2024	Attended: 6 Apology: 4	Attended: 1 Apology: 1
Councillor	Donna Jeffries	June 2024 – September 2025	Attended: 1 Apology: 1	
Councillor	Noel Sheridan	June 2024 – September 2025	Attended: 1 Apology: 1	
Councillor	Isaac Gordon	Re-elected June 2025 due to the Count Back Election	Attended: 1 Apology: 0	
Councillor	Mark Brown	Re-elected September 2024	Attended: 10 Apology: 0	Attended: 2 Apology: 0
Councillor	Belinda Colless	Elected September 2024	Attended: 8 Apology: 0	Attended: 2 Apology: 0
Councillor	Jason Morton	Elected September 2024	Attended: 8 Apology: 0	Attended: 2 Apology: 0
Councillor	Michael Pederson	Elected September 2024	Attended: 8 Apology: 0	Attended: 2 Apology: 0



Council Charter

Section 8 of Local Government Act (1993)

Brewarrina Shire Council adopted, for its Charter, Section 8 of Local Government Act (1993);

- a) *To provide directly or on behalf of other levels of government, after due consultation, adequate, equitable and appropriate services and facilities for the community and to ensure that those services and facilities are managed efficiently and effectively.*
- b) *To exercise community leadership.*
- c) *To exercise its functions in a manner that is consistent with and actively promotes the principles of multiculturalism.*
- d) *To promote, to provide and plan for the needs of children.*
- e) *To properly manage, develop, protect, restore, enhance and conserve the environment of the area for which it is responsible, in a manner that is consistent with and promotes the principles of ecologically sustainable development.*
- f) *To have regard to the long term and cumulative effects of its decisions.*
- g) *To bear in mind that it is the custodian and trustee of public assets and to effectively account for and manage the assets for which it is responsible.*
- h) *To facilitate the involvement of Councillors, members of the public users of facilities and services and council staff in the development, improvement and coordination of local government.*
- i) *To raise funds for local purposes by the fair imposition of rates, charges and fees, by income earned from investments and, when appropriate, by borrowings and grants.*
- j) *To keep the local community and the State Government (and through it, the wider community) informed about its activities.*
- k) *To ensure that, in the exercise of its regulatory functions, it acts consistently and without bias, particularly where an activity of the council is affected.*
- l) *To be a responsible employer.*

Council Meetings

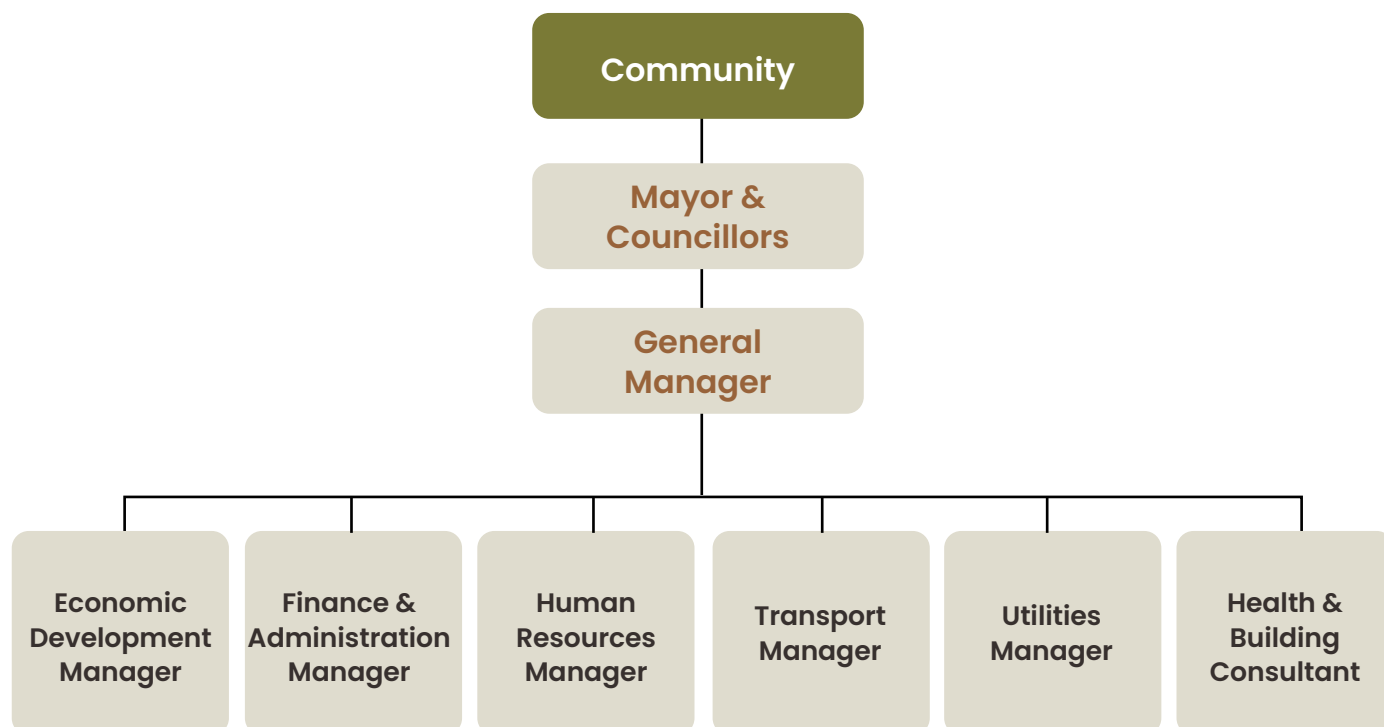
Open to the Public

Community members can attend Council meetings. Due to recent changes in meeting practices and relevant legislation, public forums may be held before Ordinary, Extraordinary, and Committee meetings, allowing oral submissions on agenda items.

To speak, applications must be submitted to the General Manager at least two days in advance, specifying the item and stance ('for' or 'against'); each applicant may only speak on one item per meeting.

Council meetings are usually held on the fourth Tuesday of each month at 10:00am in the Shire Council Chambers.

OUR ORGANISATION



General Manager

The General Manager is responsible for:

- Efficient, effective operation of the Council organisation and day-to-day management.
- Ensuring Council decisions and policies are implemented and overseeing this process.
- Appointing, directing and dismissing staff.
- Implementing Council's Equal Employment Opportunity Management Plan.

The General Manager is the only member of staff selected and appointed by Councillors.

The General Manager appoints all other members of staff, although Councillors must be consulted about the appointment and dismissal of senior officers.

Councillors have no direct responsibility for the direction of staff or for the day-to-day administration of the Council.

As the most senior employee appointed by the Council, the General Manager has the following additional responsibilities:

- Acting as the link between Councillors and staff
- Reporting to Council
- Overseeing Council financial management
- Consulting Council on appointment of senior staff
- Managing activities of Council employees
- Communicating and promoting Council's policies to Community
- Exercising other functions as delegated by the Council

Finance & Administration Manager

Provides effective administrative and financial management services to support the Council, Mayor and Council departments.

Functions include:

- Customer Service
- Services NSW
- Administration
- Records Management
- Financial Management
- Information Technology

Transport Manager

Manages roads and transport infrastructure to ensure current and future service delivery is maintained.

Functions include:

- State, Regional and Local Roads Networks
- Ancillary services
- Town street maintenance and construction
- Brewarrina town services
- Council Plant
- Works Depot
- Quarry Manager

Utilities Manager

Manages the water, sewerage and parks infrastructure and to ensure current and future service delivery is maintained.

Functions include:

- Water supply
- Sewerage services
- Cemetery
- Waste management
- Parks, gardens and sporting amenities
- Street and gutter cleaning
- Aerodromes
- Remote town services
- Animal control
- Weed management

Economic Development Manager

Manages the economic functions of Council to ensure current and future service delivery is maintained.

Functions include:

- Economic development
- Youth services
- Community engagement
- Community support
- Tourism and event co-ordination
- Human Services – Services Australia (Centrelink) and Library services

Human Resources Manager

Manages employment, work health and safety and housing functions of Council to ensure current and future service delivery is maintained.

Functions include:

- Risk management and Insurance
- Repairs, maintenance and management of Council buildings
- Recruitment and management of employment policies and conditions of employment
- Work health and safety
- Rehabilitation coordinator

Health and Building Consultant

Council has engaged the services of a part time consultant to provide public health, building and planning services. The objective of the consulting service is to provide environmentally sound planning and regulatory controls to meet the community needs through maximising community access to services that improve or enhance quality of life.

UTILITIES SERVICES





Parks, Open Spaces and Aerodromes

2024/2025 saw many upgrades to facilities throughout the Parks and Gardens space, and additions to town infrastructure. The Utilities team also delivered the first ever shared path for the Weilmoringle community, completed in July 2025, and began construction on a new shared path for Goodooga township funded by Transport for NSW.

The Goodooga Splash Park project was also completed in March 2025 with new seating, turf and upgraded of water system, BBQ units and shade structures along with beautification of surrounding areas.

Brewarrina Swimming Pool Upgrade

Significant maintenance and upgrading works were completed in September 2025 on the Brewarrina & District War Memorial Olympic Pool Complex and Aquatic Park in time for the summer opening.

Waste and Street Cleaning

Both waste and street cleaning throughout the year of 2024/2025 consisted of routine and scheduled maintenance. Council purchased a new 18m³ side loading waste compactor to complement the existing fleet of waste trucks.

Council also signed a contract extension for Netwaste, which is a voluntary regional waste group formed in 1995, to provide collaborative approaches to waste and resource management. Covering almost 40% of the state, benefits of the group include targeted waste management projects, education and community engagement programs are delivered to 25 member councils in regional NSW.

Weilmoringle Water and Sewer Infrastructure

A rehabilitation and upgrade project was completed in May at the Weilmoringle

settlement ponds and Orana bore water infrastructure, along with the installation of new water infrastructure from the township to the settlement Ponds to improve efficiency and environmental sustainability.

Residential homes within the LGA now use smart water meters replacing the analogue meters, to identify and manage leaks more efficiently, reducing wastages.

Shared Path Construction Program

Weilmoringle

A 1.5-kilometre shared path in Weilmoringle was completed in July and is now open to the public with solar lights and sheltered seats installed.

This is the first ever formalised path in Weilmoringle, providing a connected, inclusive and safe active transport network that reflects community priorities and supports the need of residents and visitors.

By focusing on accessibility, safety and environmental sustainability, the construction of the shared path:

- Enables safer routes for pedestrians and cyclists.
- Increases opportunities for physical activity, supporting community health.
- Enhances connections between key destinations, such as schools, health services and recreational areas.
- Reduce reliance on motor vehicles, contributing to environmental benefits

Goodooga

Construction is underway and expected to be completed in December 2025 for a new shared path in Goodooga, connecting the Artesian Baths with the town centre to create a connected, inclusive and safe active transport network that reflects community priorities and supports the need of residents and visitors.

TRANSPORT SERVICES





Throughout the 2024/2025 financial year, Brewarrina Shire Council has remained committed to improving the road infrastructure within the Shire.

Despite challenges posed by fluctuating weather patterns, including periods of dry and wet conditions, the Shire's road network has been maintained and enhanced, benefiting residents, businesses and visitors alike. The ongoing support from grant providers and state bodies has been invaluable in helping us achieve our transport goals.

Below is a summary of the key projects undertaken by Transport Services during the year:

Road Maintenance Council Contract (RMCC)

Under the RMCC, Brewarrina Shire Council has undertaken the following essential maintenance activities to ensure road safety and functionality:

- Slashing and roadside vegetation control
- Removal of dead animals from roads
- Weed spraying
- Pothole repairs across the Shire's road network
- Culvert cleaning and maintenance
- Resealing works along Arthur Hall VC Way (Kamilaroi Highway)
- Rejuvenating road markings restoring visibility and safety

Transport Funded Projects

Jobs Gate Road, Weilmoringle:

The sealing of 26 kilometres of Jobs Gate Road was completed in July 2025, marking a significant milestone in improving connectivity for the Weilmoringle community. These works are a key component of our broader road upgrade strategy.

Local Road Maintenance and Re-sheeting

Council developed a guide for the Unsealed Road Grading Maintenance works and a grading program to allow for each unsealed road in the shire to be graded throughout the year. The program provides our residents with assurance that all roads will be graded to consistent standards.

• Narran Lake Road:

Maintenance grading and preparation for re-sheeting were completed along 46 kilometres of Narran Lake Road, improving travel conditions for farmers, landowners and transport services.

• Byrock Nidgery Road:

Maintenance grading covered 50 kilometres of Byrock Nidgery Road, ensuring a safer and more reliable route for rural traffic and freight movement.

• West Culgoa Road:

Maintenance grading of 35 kilometres of West Culgoa Road were graded to enhance road quality and accessibility.

• Gongolgan-Byrock Road:

Maintenance grading was performed on 39 kilometres of the Gongolgan-Byrock Road, improving road conditions for local traffic and agricultural operations.

• Bukulla Brenda Road:

Maintenance grading covered approximately 40 kilometres of the Bukulla Brenda Road. In addition, gravel was deposited over the deteriorated sections, further enhancing the road's resilience to future weather impacts.

Flood Repairs

Essential Public Asset Reconstruction Works (EPA-RW) are work in progress, significantly improving the road conditions making it safer for the road users.

Bridge Street Concrete Levee Replacement

Replacing existing earthen levee running between Bridge Street and the Kamilaroi Highway in the north of Brewarrina. This has caused issues with both levee maintenance and sediments/mud depositing on the nearby highway due to scouring. Replaced a 300-metre section of the existing earthen levee with a new concrete levee structure 3.1 metres high.

Construction of Culverts and Causeway Brenda Road, Goodooga

Replacing two sections with five box culverts to the total of ten box culverts. These critical infrastructure upgrades form part of Council's ongoing commitment to improving local road safety and enhancing resilience to future flood events. The project is funded by the Infrastructure Betterment Fund which is jointly funded by the Australian and NSW Governments and was completed in October 2025.

Rejuvenating Road Markings of local Roads

Rejuvenating road markings involved cleaning existing lines using techniques like high-pressure water blasting to remove rubber and grime, then reapplying fresh, durable materials such as thermoplastic or epoxy to restore visibility and safety.

Jobs Gate Road (Stage 2 and 3)

The completion of Stage 3 of Jobs Gate Road in October 2025 involved sealing 4.1 kilometres of road, providing a vital connection to the wider regional road network. Stage 4 of the project is currently in progress and will extend this work, further improving access to remote communities and supporting economic growth.

Heavy patching

The heavy patching works were delivered under four separate programs. The first three programs focused on the rehabilitation and construction of local roads, while the final program was directed towards the state highway network.

- **Emergency Road Recovery Fund**

Under this program, approximately two kilometres of full-width road was reconstructed and completed under heavy patching, covering an area of around 17,000 square metres, to upgrade the existing condition of the Goodooga Road.

- **Road to Road Recovery**

Under this program, approximately 2.1 kilometres across the full width of the Goodooga Road was reconstructed through heavy patching works, covering an area of about 17,500 square metres. These works were completed in August 2025 and have significantly improved the road condition, addressed defects and strengthened the pavement to ensure greater durability. The improvements have also delivered a safer driving environment by eliminating surface hazards, widening the usable carriageway and providing smoother travel for all road users. In addition to enhancing safety, the reconstruction has strengthened local connectivity, improving access to adjacent routes such as Narran Lakes Road and other surrounding local roads, thereby supporting both community travel and freight movement.

- **Block Grant**

Under this program, approximately 1.2 kilometres of full-width heavy patching was completed on the section after the Weilmoringle turnoff along Goodooga Road, covering an area of approximately 9,600 square metres. In addition, around two kilometres of shoulder widening was carried out past the Narran Lake turnoff on Goodooga Road, encompassing an area of approximately 10,400 square metres. These combined works have widened the roadway, improved surface strength and enhanced stability, resulting in a safer and more reliable route for all road users. The upgrades reduce the risk of edge drop-offs, provide greater tolerance for heavy vehicles and improve overall travel efficiency along this important corridor.

- **RMCC**

Under this program, approximately 26,300 square metres of heavy patching was completed across state highways within the Brewarrina Shire Council boundary, including Highway 29 and Main Road 70 (Arthur VC Way).

These works have delivered substantial improvements by:

- Restoring pavement strength and durability across key highway sections.
- Enhancing road safety for all users through the removal of potholes, deformations and surface defects.
- Supporting the ongoing maintenance of road standards in line with Transport for NSW requirements.

Resealing

Under this program, approximately 23 kilometres of the state highway network within the Brewarrina Shire Council boundary was resealed.

These resealing works have:

- Extended the pavement life by protecting the existing surface from water ingress and further deterioration.
- Enhanced road safety through improved skid resistance and smoother driving conditions.
- Reduced future maintenance needs, supporting long-term cost efficiency.

Looking Ahead

The 2024/2025 financial year has been marked by significant progress across Brewarrina Shire's transport network. These efforts ensure the ongoing safety, connectivity and economic development of our region. With additional projects in the pipeline, Council remains committed to maintaining and upgrading our transport infrastructure to meet the evolving needs of the community.



HUMAN RESOURCES AND WORK, HEALTH & SAFETY



This report reviews the Human Resources and Work Health and Safety (WHS) developments that have occurred at Brewarrina Shire Council over the past 12 months. It highlights our advancements in strategic initiatives aimed at enhancing employee wellbeing, optimising workforce management and improving safety measures, all while navigating changing legislative environments and shifting workforce expectations.



74

Headcount
(54 male,
20 female)



67

**Full Time
Employees**



65%

**Indigenous
Representation**



Age Profile

37.5%

aged 50+ years

15%

Under 30 years



Employment type

49 Full Time

1 Part Time

22 Casual

8 Term Contracts

HUMAN RESOURCES

12 Months in Review

Council's Workforce Management Plan (WMP)
Refresh and Integration with IP&R

During the past 12 months Council reviewed, re-aligned and adopted a refreshed WMP for the 2025 to 2028 period that sharpened alignment between workforce capability, the Delivery Program, budget settings and community service needs.

The WMP now provides clearer focus on targeted recruitment strategies, D&I employment pathways, succession and leadership development, diversity/inclusion and risk management.

What changed in practice this year:

- The WMP was redeveloped with a strong IP&R focus and updated to reflect existing and future project development needs, emphasis on succession planning, training and strengthening leadership pipelines.
- The Plan commits to maintaining high First Nations employment and strengthening school to work pathways through traineeships/apprenticeships and partnerships.

Action: (WMP Strategic Alignment – 'Workforce Planning, Succession, D&I')

- Embed WMP actions in Operational Plan items and people KPIs (e.g., retention, professional role fulfilment and annual training hours per employee).
- Continue First Nations employment, leadership pathways and local talent development.

Managing Psycho-Social Risk and Employee Wellbeing

Council continues to strengthen its approach to managing psycho-social hazards by increasing employee and supervisor awareness, ensuring management actively considers how operating environments impact staff, and embedding respectful workplace practices. During the year, Council strengthened policies tied to mental health and wellbeing, including the adoption of Domestic Violence Leave, the Right to Disconnect and the refreshed Employee Development Policy,

reinforcing a psychologically safe and supportive workplace.

Action: (WMP Strategic Alignment – 'Safe Workplace Environment; Employer of Choice')

- Council enhanced mental health support policies and systems to address psycho-social hazards.
- Council reviewed job descriptions in roles historically more exposed to isolation or heightened psycho-social risks and introduced additional resources and practical tools for staff in these positions.
- Council adopted a Domestic Violence Leave Policy, consistent with the Local Government (State) Award and Council's wellbeing commitments.
- Council adopted a Right to Disconnect Policy to reduce fatigue and after-hours work pressures.
- Council readopted the Employee Development Policy, aligned to the 2023 Award, to prioritise capability development.

These initiatives ensured compliance with legislative requirements while also promoting the physical and mental wellbeing of the workforce, making Council a healthier, safer and more supportive environment for all employees.

Retention, Internal Growth and Workforce Flexibility

Council continues to focus on stabilising critical roles, recognising that staff retention remains a key challenge for regional councils across the Orana area. Retaining skilled, experienced employees and preserving in-house organisational knowledge has been central to this work.

Finding skilled candidates for specialised roles in areas such as regulatory compliance, specific RMCC works, and environmental health and planning continues to be a challenge. While Council has achieved some success in strengthening regulatory capacity, the highly specialised nature of these niche positions, combined with ongoing labour market constraints and the remote and isolated location of Brewarrina, make recruitment and retention in these areas particularly difficult.



Over the past year, Council has seen improvements in retention by clarifying role expectations and career pathways, supporting flexible work arrangements, along with the nine-day fortnight, which has been well supported by staff as a practical measure to strengthen work + life balance.

Recognising our Talent

Council actively participated in Local Government Week 2024, showcasing staff achievements and highlighting the people behind service delivery through stories and profiles. This provided an opportunity to celebrate the contribution of employees across different areas of Council and share these successes with the community. Similarly, International Women's Day 2025 was marked by recognising and celebrating the achievements of women across Council, reinforcing the organisation's commitment to diversity and inclusion, while acknowledging the vital role staff play in strengthening both the workplace and the community

Funding Opportunities

Council has also made use of additional external funding opportunities to grow capability from within, with the success of six full time Traineeship/Apprentice funded positions under the Office of Local Governments Fresh Start Program. This funding opportunity has been used to build on our local capacity, with the majority of our new trainees having onboarded with us as mature aged so far, bringing with them prior work knowledge and experience.

Youth Forum and Council Careers Day

Council proudly hosted its first Community Careers Day in partnership with the Community and Economic Development Team, creating a showcase of career pathways available locally. The event brought together the Australian Defence Force, Universities, emergency services, mining industries, TAFE, National Parks and Council itself, giving students and jobseekers the chance to explore opportunities, ask questions and connect directly with employers.

Council also participated in the Orana Youth Forum held in Dubbo, engaging with young people from across the region to highlight the diverse range of traineeships and apprenticeships available within Council. These initiatives not only strengthened awareness of career options in local government but also reinforced Council's commitment to investing in future talent and building stronger employment pathways.

Connection between Staff Retention and Work Flexibility

Council has continued to adapt to the changing workforce landscape, where expectations for greater work + life balance are reshaping how roles are designed and delivered. Flexible work arrangements remain a decisive factor in both attracting and retaining staff, influencing not only where people choose to work, but also how long they stay.

Increasingly, employees are seeking roles that combine career opportunity with genuine flexibility. Without ongoing adaptation to these priorities, Council risks losing valued employees and future recruits to larger regional centres and urban areas that are often able to offer broader options and more family friendly conditions.

The updated Workforce Management Plan also provides additional structure for addressing skills shortages, succession risk and attraction in a highly competitive regional market.

Recruitment activity throughout this period, placed emphasis on transferable skills, while structured training was delivered to upskill existing staff in areas such as compliance, road safety, utilities and plant operations. These measures broadened the internal pool for hard to fill roles and supported service continuity.

In summary actions met against: (WMP Strategic Alignment – ‘Retention; Succession’)

- Council refined career development processes, expanded acting-up opportunities and enhanced mentoring to support progression and transfer of organisational knowledge.
- Council maintained flexible work options (including the nine-day fortnight) where operationally appropriate, supporting stronger work + life balance and overall retention.
- Council clarified competency descriptors and progression pathways to manage staff expectations fairly and consistently.
- Council maintains its focus towards leveraging internal growth and upskilling existing employees to meet critical needs.

In summary actions met against: (WMP Strategic Alignment – ‘Attraction, Development & Skills’) and (WMP ‘Succession Plan, Attractive and Accessible Work Environment, Retention of existing high-quality Employees’)

- Council continued to prioritise mandatory and formal training ie tickets, licences (e.g. 4-in-1 plant, traffic control, RMS accreditation) and mandatory safety competencies to secure service continuity.
- Council have invested in structured upskilling programs across high risk and compliance areas to address skill shortages internally.
- Council has undertaken an organisational functional review of our management positions and job functions to ensure they are

aligned with future needs, and in accordance with Local Government Act within 12 months of newly appointed Council.

- We have cross-trained various departments and expanded responsibilities to reduce the burden on individual staff members. Creating greater flexibility, supports succession planning and reduces burnout by sharing specialised tasks across a broader team.
- Consistent with last year, Council continued to manage staff housing strategically to support attraction and retention for priority roles, with property maintenance and upgrades scheduled and delivered during the period.
- Council is finalising our dedicated training rooms, designed specifically for staff studies and the delivery of both internal and external training opportunities providing a central, purpose-built space, to strengthen learning, development pathways and ensure that training is accessible across the organisation

Cyber Security Awareness and Data Protection

Protecting Council’s information and systems remains critical as the scale and sophistication of cyber threats continue to increase across all sectors. Ensuring that staff are equipped to recognise risks and apply safe practices has been central to Council’s approach over the past several years, alongside strengthening system safeguards and physical protections.

In summary actions met against: (WMP Strategic Alignment – ‘Safe Workplace Environment’)

- Council delivered targeted cyber safety awareness online training for staff, reinforcing the importance of secure data handling practices.
- Council upgraded and monitored physical safety measures, including duress alarms and cameras where appropriate, to provide an additional layer of protection.

WORK HEALTH AND SAFETY

12 Months in Review

Compliance and Innovations (*WMP Strategic Alignment 'Safe Workplace Environment'*)

Council strengthened its WHS governance and practice during the year through a combination of planned improvements and practical initiatives. The focus remained on ensuring compliance with statutory obligations while also embedding a culture of safety across all operations.

Regular committee oversight, and targeted programs supported continuous improvement, while new tools and processes were introduced to improve reporting, accountability and risk management.

WHS Audits, Management Review and WHS Commitment (*WMP Strategic Alignment 'Safe Workplace Environment'*)

Council implemented the updated WHS Management Plan (March 2025), which clearly defined responsibilities for officers, PCBUS, managers and workers, and strengthened consultation arrangements through the reinstated WHS Committee and regular MANEX oversight. With each department now represented, the Committee has become an effective forum for raising issues, sharing feedback and ensuring safety concerns are addressed in a timely and practical way.

As part of embedding the new plan, hazard and incident reporting processes were standardised across all departments. Scheduled inspections and audit schedules were reintroduced, with findings tabled through the WHS Committee and MANEX, keeping safety performance visible and actionable. This included the review and update of Material Safety Data Sheets (MSDS), improvements to chemical shed storage and access, and targeted compliance support through RMCC inspections and accreditation activities.

Additional resourcing enhanced the delivery of WHS improvements during the year. Two external project consultants supported compliance in construction and high-risk areas, while one on one coaching was provided to supervisors to strengthen leadership capability. Council also expanded its WHS capacity with the appointment of a full time WHS/HR Officer and a WHS Compliance Coordinator (due to commence in September 2025).

Looking forward, Council has also engaged an external consultant to assist with the draft planning for the Brewarrina Depot upgrade. This planning work is following feedback and input from the WHS Committee, traffic flow, public access and storage arrangements to ensure the upgraded depot delivers a safer and more efficient working environment.

Changes to WHS System and Performance Monitoring

A significant improvement this year was the adoption of iAuditor, providing Council with a digital platform to complete inspections and audits, track close out of corrective actions, and monitor the completion of training and inductions. Whilst a relatively new system, use of it has already enhanced accountability, and will continue to allow Council to spot and track emerging risk trends more effectively. Council also reinforced the use of Safe Work Method Statements (SWMS) for all high-risk activities, including overhead and underground utility work, traffic control environments, confined spaces, working at heights, energised services, and plant and forklift operation ensuring consistent risk controls across Council.

Incident Management, Situational Awareness and High-Risk Work Safety

Daily pre-starts and vehicle checks continued as part of Council's risk control framework. Incident and near-miss data was actively reviewed to guide targeted interventions. One example was the delivery of Defensive Driver Training, which was rolled out to address recurring driving-related risks. This training reinforced the importance of safe driving and linked strongly to Council's ongoing "Home Safe" safety message.

Council maintained its program of weekly Toolbox Talks and targeted safety campaigns, focusing on risks such as overhead and underground services, workers on foot and hearing protection. Outdoor teams participated in the RMCC Annual Induction, with reviews of high-risk SWMS to ensure staff remained current and confident in applying safe work practices. These initiatives reinforced situational awareness and built capability in areas of greatest operational risk.

WHS Campaigns and Health and Wellbeing Initiatives

Council continued to recognise the strong link between wellbeing and safe operations, with Wellbeing Days and a range of staff initiatives delivered during the reporting period. These programs provided employees with opportunities learn more about work safety, mental health, to reflect on their health, access advice on lifestyle improvements, and promote both physical and psychological wellbeing. Council also reinforced expectations around creating a supportive and respectful workplace, complemented by ongoing promotion of the Employee Assistance Program (EAP) as a key support resource for staff and their families, and Policy update that align with wellbeing at work such as the Right to Disconnect Policy.

Changes to StateCover WHS Self Audit and StateWide Continuous Improvement Objectives

During 2024, StateCover transitioned its WHS Self-Audit to a new online system and process, and as a result, there was no mandatory audit for that period. This change means that benchmarking results will come later in the year and are not available for inclusion in this reporting cycle.

Council progressed significant improvements to WHS practice over the past 12 months demonstrating Council's readiness for the self-auditing system and our ongoing commitment to safe and compliant operations.

With such changes, including the implementation of our updated WHS Management Plan (March 2025), which clarifies responsibilities across all levels of the organisation and embeds a

stronger consultation through the reinstated WHS Committee. Each department is now represented on the Committee, and regular MANEX oversight has ensured that WHS audit and inspection outcomes are tracked and acted on.

Key compliance initiatives were advanced during the year, including:

- Standardised hazard and incident reporting, ensuring consistency across all departments.
- Review and update of Material Safety Data Sheets (MSDS), alongside improvements to chemical shed storage and access arrangements.
- Participation in RMCC safety inspections, supporting accreditation and compliance for high-risk roadwork environments.
- Initial Depot upgrade planning, WHS Committee input shaping design considerations such as traffic flow, storage and safe access for workers and the public.

As part of the Continuous Improvement Pathway Program, Statewide Mutual requires Council to conduct a self-assessment audit, referred to as the 'CIP Workbook' which captures cross Council benchmarking information relevant to risk concerns, actions and initiatives. The StateWide Regional Risk Management team monitors the CIP program for opportunities to promote good risk management and evolve current risk practices within Council.

As part of the Statewide Mutual Continuous Improvement Pathway (CIP) program, Council completed the 2024 self-assessment workbook. This initiative provides benchmarking across key risk areas and supports Council's to identify strengths as well as opportunities for improvement.

For Brewarrina, the 2024 findings showed Council achieved strong results in Pools (90%), while Enterprise Risk Management (ERM) scored in the mid-range (56%) and Footpaths identified as an area requiring further focus (45%). These results provide Council with clear guidance on where policies, planning and documentation needed strengthening and demonstrated the value these programs in keeping Council accountable and on track with continuous improvement.

Council is still awaiting overall CIP program average statistics for this year's reporting period, which focused on the following four CIP Benchmarking areas of Bridges, Trees and incident investigations.

Situational Awareness and High-Risk Work Safety

Council continued to place strong emphasis on situational awareness and high-risk work safety throughout the year, ensuring staff remain alert to the risks inherent in both their day-to-day tasks and the broader operating environment. Regular Toolbox Talks reinforced key safety themes and provided opportunities for staff to share learnings from incidents, while weekly staff meetings integrated both indoor and outdoor teams into open conversations about workplace risks and safe practices.

- The "Home Safe" campaign remained central to Council's messaging, through regular Toolbox prompting and visual reminders, strategically placed in staff areas to keep safety on the minds of our staff. This program emphasises the importance of safe behaviours not only in the workplace but also at home, reinforcing Council's holistic approach to employee wellbeing.
- Council Safety Awareness Day in partnership with Essential Energy and Dial Before You Dig was an event in the reporting period that provided practical demonstrations and guidance on working safely around overhead and underground utilities, including electricity, gas and water services. Staff feedback was overwhelmingly positive, with participants rating the training 4 out of 5 stars for its impact and relevance to their work.
- Further, as part of RMCC compliance, outdoor teams attended the Annual Induction Day and undertook workshops reviewing High Risk Safe Work Method Statements (SWMS). This process ensured that staff remain current with best practice and regulatory requirements in relation to Transport activities.

HR and WHG Industry Trends

WHS: Increased Focus on Psychosocial Hazards and Mental Health (*Strategic Alignment: WMP Objective: Safe Workplace Environment; Employer of Choice and WHS Management Plan*).

- Industry Trend: Stronger legislative and regulatory focus on psychosocial risks, with organisations expected to manage mental health, bullying, fatigue and isolation.
- Action: Council have commenced psychosocial risk management into everyday work planning through adoption of Domestic Violence Leave, Right to Disconnect and the updated Employee Development Policy. Mental Health First Aid training reinforced leadership capability.

WHS: Data-Driven Safety and Incident Analysis (*Strategic Alignment: WMP Objective: Safe Workplace Environment*)

- Industry Trend: Organisations are increasingly relying on own WHS data to identify internal risks rather than relying on insurer identified risks and preventative activities and implement targeted prevention.
- Council Alignment: Council analysed incident data (2017–2023) to identify risk trends, which informed Defensive Driver Training and weekly toolbox talks.

WHS: Technology in WHS Management (*WMP Objective: Safe Workplace Environment*) (*WHS Management Plan Objective: Adopt technology solutions to streamline audits, inspections, and training compliance*)

- Industry Trend: Growth in digital safety systems to monitor compliance and risk in real time.
- Council Alignment: Implementation of vehicle tracking devices, remote worker support monitoring and implementation of iAuditor to digitise inspections and audits, track corrective actions, and monitor induction completion.



HR: Talent Retention and Workforce Flexibility (*WMP Objective: Retention of Existing High-Quality Employees*) (*WHS Management Plan Objective: Support wellbeing through work-life balance measures and consistent competency pathways*)

- Industry Trend: Flexible work and structured career pathways are critical for attracting and retaining staff.
- Council Alignment: Adoption of the nine-day fortnight, flexible arrangements and clearer career expectations improved retention.

HR: Employee Wellbeing and Engagement (*WMP Objective: Promote Council as a Preferred Employer*) (*WHS Management Plan Objective: Strengthen wellbeing programs and integrate psychosocial hazard management*)

- Industry Trend: Holistic health and wellbeing programs are now core retention strategies.
- Council Alignment: Wellbeing Day (Feb 2024) provided health checks and defensive driving awareness, complemented by ongoing promotion of the EAP and mental health awareness initiatives.

HR: Internal Growth and Upskilling (*WMP Objective: Succession Planning; Attraction, Development & Skills*) (*WHS Management Plan Objective: Address succession risks by building internal capability through training and progression pathways*)

- Industry Trend: Talent scarcity drives investment in traineeships, apprenticeships and upskilling programs.
- Council Alignment: Secured six Fresh Start Program funded traineeships/apprenticeships (majority mature-aged) and delivered structured compliance and operations training.
- Future focus on Elsa Dixon SBAT Trainees

HR: Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (DEI) (*WMP Objective: Promote Council as a Preferred Employer and EEO – Sustain pathways for local and underrepresented groups to strengthen diversity and inclusion*)

- Industry Trend: DEI and local employment pathways remain national HR priorities.
- Council Alignment: 66% First Nation representation and mentoring programs with Goodooga and Brewarrina Central Schools reinforced Council's inclusive workforce model.

Combined Council Training and Development

Council delivered an extensive program across mandatory WHS competencies, licensing/ticket upgrades, professional development and policy-linked refreshers.

- Human Resources AWC Group Conference
- Work Health and Safety Professionals Group
- Orana Risk Group
- Annual Weeds Conference
- Statewide Mutual Annual Risk Management Conference
- LGNSW Annual HR Conference
- LGNSW Annual Conference
- Code of Conduct
- Chemical Certification (ChemCert)
- First Aid and CPR Training
- Construction Induction (White Card)
- Compliance and Regulatory Training
- Child Protection Training
- Service NSW
- ePlanning Portal
- Vision Super Visit
- In-depth SWMS analysis on high-risk functions
- Aboriginal Mental Health First Aid; Mental Health Awareness
- Work Experience Programs
- Construction Certificate III; Mechanical and Plumbing Trainee Programs
- HR and HC Licence Upgrades
- Leadership 360 Survey

- Safe Dog Handling Course
- Orana Youth Forum
- Council Career's Day
- Snake awareness
- Maintenance and delivery of Workers on Foot (TfNSW) & RMCC Annual Induction Day
- Council Wellbeing Initiatives
- Safety around Overhead and Underground Electrical Lines and SWMS Review
- NRMA Non-Technical Training
- StateCover Workshop – Psychosocial Hazards in the Workplace
- Local Government Professionals Finance Intensive 2024
- NSW Revenue Professionals 2024 Annual Conference
- Employment Law Seminar
- International Women's Day
- Local Government Week
- Traffic Control – Design Worksite Traffic Control Plan and Traffic Control (General)
- Working at Heights, Confined Spaces, Driver Training
- Tag and Test Training

Future Outlook and Strategic Goals for 2025/2026

Council will continue its commitment to building a safe, capable and engaged workforce, with the following priorities set for the year ahead:

- **Employee Retention and Development:** Retention will remain a focus through structured career pathways, leadership programs, staff recognition and wellbeing initiatives. These efforts will help employees see clear links between their roles and community outcomes.
- **Health and Wellbeing:** Preventative health measures will be expanded, with Wellbeing Days, health screenings and ongoing mental health awareness programs forming part of a broader strategy to support safe and sustainable performance.
- **Community and Workforce Pathways:** Council will strengthen its partnerships with LGA Schools to provide mentoring, work experience and traineeships, creating stronger local employment pipelines.
- **Work Health and Safety:** The WHS Management Plan will be further supported by continuous use of digital monitoring through tools such as iAuditor, and a focus on closing out corrective actions. Council will also progress the Depot Upgrade, designed to improve safety, traffic flow and operational efficiency.
- **Situational Awareness and Risk Reduction:** Targeted training, awareness campaigns and regular toolbox talks will continue to reinforce safe practices across high-risk work environments.

Conclusion

As we move into 2026, Brewarrina Shire Council remains committed to delivering positive outcomes for our staff, community and stakeholders. We are grateful for the hard work and dedication of our teams and look forward to another year of continued progress and meaningful impact.

FINANCE AND ADMINISTRATION

The Finance and Administration functions of Council – encompassing Finance, Information Technology and Customer Services – work in partnership to provide the foundation for effective governance, reliable service delivery and long-term sustainability.

These functions are central to how Council manages its resources, supports its workforce and delivers services to the community.

Together, they ensure that Council remains financially responsible, digitally resilient and community focused. Finance provides strong stewardship of public funds through sound budgeting, careful cash management and transparent reporting. Information Technology delivers the secure and modern digital infrastructure required for efficient operations, while safeguarding Council from emerging cyber security risks. Customer Services ensures that every resident has access to frontline government services locally, delivered with professionalism and care.

By maintaining robust financial management, strengthening cyber security and IT infrastructure, and ensuring accessible customer services, Council continues to meet its statutory obligations under the Local Government Act 1993 (NSW) and the Office of Local Government's reporting framework. More importantly, these integrated functions support the broader vision of Council: providing reliable, efficient and transparent services that build community confidence and lay a strong foundation for future growth.

Finance

The Finance Team continues to play a pivotal role in upholding Council's commitment to sound financial management and long-term sustainability, in accordance with section 8B of the Local Government Act 1993 (NSW). This year's focus has been on maintaining a stable financial base despite external funding distortions, while ensuring that Council meets all statutory obligations and manages resources prudently.

2024/2025 results were heavily influenced by factors outside Council's control. The Commonwealth reduced the advance percentage of the Financial Assistance Grant (FAG) to 50 percent (previously 70–85 percent), resulting in a \$2.98m shortfall in recognised income. Council also absorbed \$2.9m in rejected flood damage claims and did not benefit from the prior year's \$4m Regional Road Repair funding.

As a result, Council reported a net operating deficit before capital grants of \$6.79m (FY23/24: \$0.86m deficit). On a normalised basis—excluding timing and one-off impacts—performance was consistent with last year. Importantly, areas under Council's direct control remained strong:

- Rates and annual charges: \$2.83m (up from \$2.69m).
- User fees and charges: \$7.66m (up from \$6.07m).
- Investment income: \$1.13m (up from \$1.02m).

Liquidity was temporarily reduced by a \$5m RMCC payment received in July rather than June, but unrestricted cash and internally restricted reserves remain adequate to support the FY25/26 capital works program.

In May 2025, Council established its Audit, Risk and Improvement Committee (ARIC) under the Local Government Amendment (Governance and Planning) Act 2016 and OLG Guidelines. While its first meeting is scheduled for July 2025, the Committee will provide independent oversight of financial reporting, internal controls, risk management and continuous improvement, strengthening accountability and governance into the future.

Below is the summary of the Financial Statement as at 30 June 2025:

	2025 \$'000	2024 \$'000
Income Statement		
Total income from continuing operations	26,519	31,503
Total expenses from continuing operations excluding depreciation, amortisation and impairment of non-financial assets	23,965	20,4055
Operating result from continuing operations excluding depreciation, amortisation and impairment of non-financial assets	2,554	11,048
Depreciation, amortisation and impairment of non-financial assets	5,689	5,910
Net operating result for this year	(3,135)	5,138
Net operating result before grants and contributions provided for capital purposes	(6,785)	(858)
Statement of Financial Position		
Total current assets	33,433	38,804
Total current liabilities	(11,296)	(10,882)
Total non-current assets	244,970	252,828
Total non-current liabilities	(126)	(140)
Total equity	266,981	280,610
Other financial information		
Unrestricted current ration (times)	6.56	5.26
Operating performance ratio (%)	(25.30)%	(2.93)%
Debt service cover ratio (times)	–	13.87
Rates and annual charges outstanding ratio (%)	3.19%	5.02%
Infrastructure renewals ratio (%)	43.96%	3.35%
Own source operation revenue ratio (%)	46.13%	32.57%
Cash expense cover ratio (months)	10.32	14.06

Income Statement

Financial performance

	2025 \$m	2025 \$m	Variance %
Rates and annual charges revenue	2.8	2.7	3.7
Grants and contributions provided for operating purposes revenue	10.6	15.2	30.3
Grants and contributions provided for capital purposes revenue	3.7	6.0	38.3
Operating result from continuing operations	(3.1)	5.1	>100
Net Operating result for the year before grants and contributions provided for capital (6.8) purposes		(0.9)	>100

Operating result from continuing operations

This graph shows the operating result from continuing operations for the current and prior two financial years.

Council's operating result from continuing operations for the year was \$8.2 million lower than the 2023–24 result.

In 2024–25, depreciation, amortisation and impairment of non-financial assets expense (\$5.7 million) decreased by \$0.2 million (3.4 per cent).

The decrease in the operating result is primarily due to reduced revenue from grants and contributions and incurring expenses funded by grants received from prior years.

The net operating result for the year before grants and contributions provided for capital purposes was a deficit of \$6.8 million. Refer to 'Grants and contributions revenue' below for details.

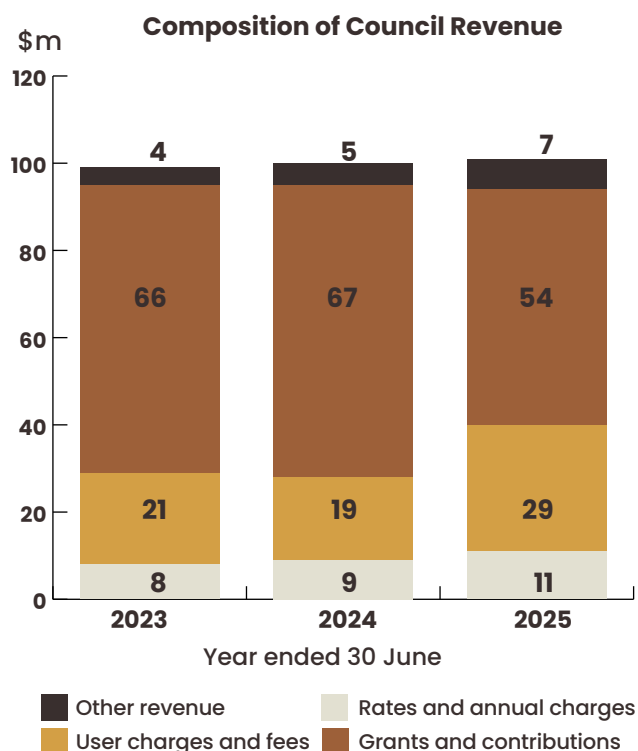


Council revenue

This graph shows the composition of Council's revenue recognised for the current and prior two financial years.

Council revenue (\$26.5 million) decreased by \$5 million (15.8 per cent) in 2024–25 due to:

- rates and annual charges revenue (\$2.8 million) increased by \$0.1 million (3.7 per cent)
- user charges and fees revenue (\$7.7 million) increased by \$1.6 million (26.1 per cent) due to an increase in Transport for NSW works
- grants and contributions revenue (\$14.3million) decreased by \$7 million (32.7 per cent) – see additional details below.

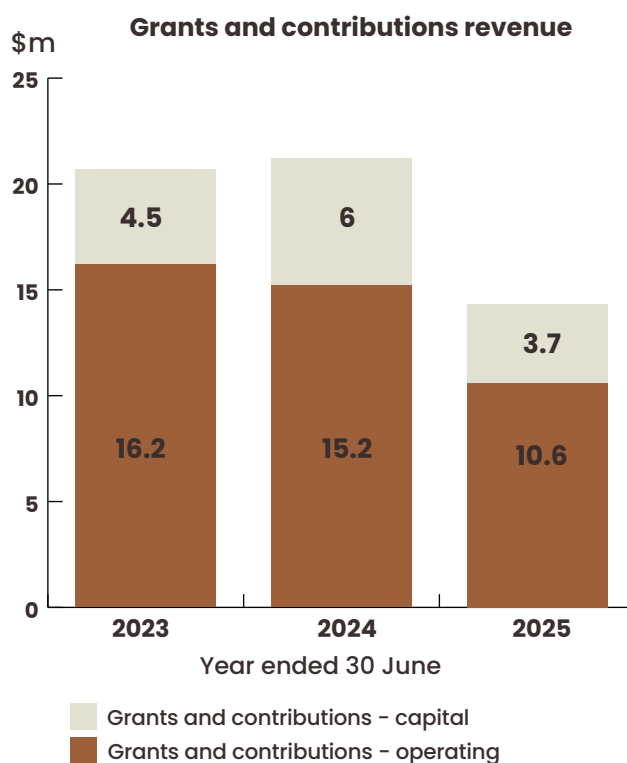


Grants and contributions revenue

This graph shows the amount of grants and contributions revenue recognised for the current and prior two financial years.

Grants and contributions revenue (\$14.3 million) decreased by \$7 million (32.7 per cent) in 2024–25 due to:

- a decrease in specific purpose operating grants of \$3 million, primarily relating to roads funding
- a decrease in capital grants of \$2.3 million, primarily relating to roads capital projects
- receiving 50 per cent of the financial assistance grants for 2025–26 in advance compared to receiving 85 per cent for 2024–25 in 2023–24.



Cash Flows

Statement of cash flows

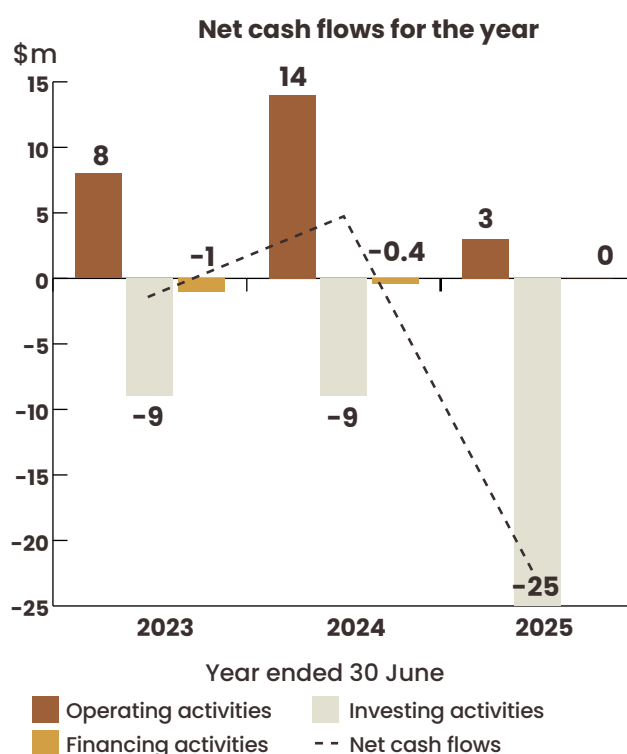
The Statement of Cash Flows details the Council's inflows and outflows of cash over a specific period. It helps in assessing the Council's ability to generate cash to fund its operations, pay off debts, and support future projects. It also aids in identifying any pressures or issues in the Council operating in a financially sustainable manner.

This graph shows the net cash flows for the current and prior two financial years.

The net cash outflows for the year were \$22.1 million (inflow of \$4.5 million in 2023–24).

In 2024–25 the net cashflows:

- from operating activities decreased by \$11.1 million, mainly due to reduced revenue from grants and contributions
- used in investing activities increased by \$15.9 million, due to increased purchases of investments in long term deposits and capital expenditure
- used in financing activities decreased by \$0.4 million as borrowing were fully repaid in the prior year.



Financial Position

Cash, cash equivalents and investments

This section of the Report provides details of the amount of cash, cash equivalents and investments recorded by the Council at 30 June 2025.

Externally restricted funds are the cash, cash equivalents and investments that can only be used for specific purposes due to legal or contractual restrictions.

Cash, cash equivalents, and investments without external restrictions can be allocated internally by the elected Council's resolution or policy. These allocations are matters of Council policy and can be changed or removed by a Council resolution.

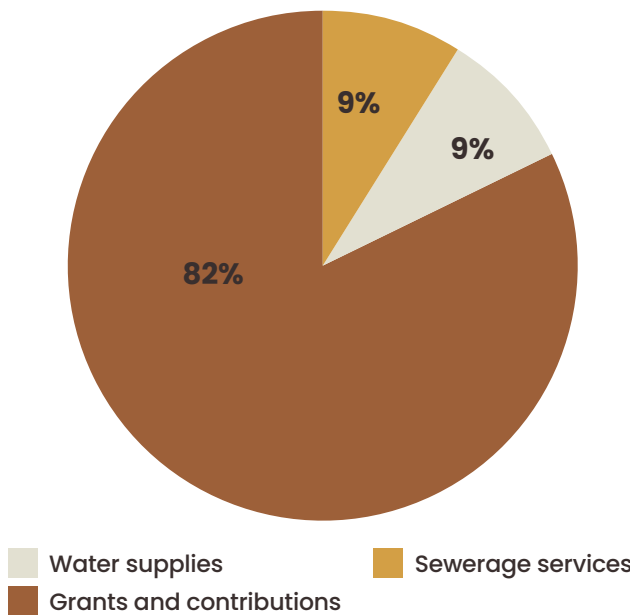
Cash, cash equivalents and investments	2025 \$m	2025 \$m	Percentage of total cash and investments 2025 %	Commentary
Total cash, cash equivalents and investments	21.2	26.8		Externally restricted balances are those which are only available for specific use due to a restriction placed by legislation or third-party contract. A breakdown of the sources of externally restricted balances is included in the graph below.
Restricted and allocated cash, cash equivalents and investments:				
• External restrictions	12.4	15.2	58.5	
• Internal allocations	8.7	11.1	41.0	Internal allocations are determined by council policies or decisions, which are subject to change.

This graph shows the sources of externally restricted cash, cash equivalents and investments.

In 2024-25 the Council's main sources of externally restricted cash, cash equivalents and investments include:

- grants and contributions of \$10.2 million
- water supplies of \$1.1 million
- sewerage services of \$1.2 million.

Source of externally restricted cash, cash equivalents and investments

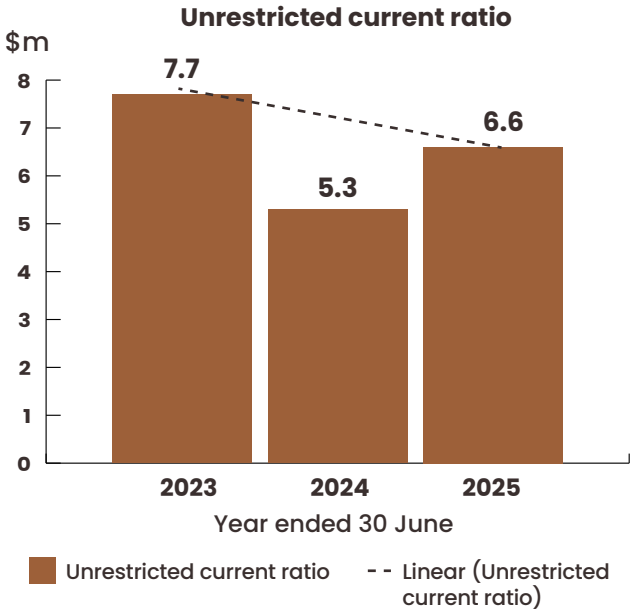


Council liquidity

This graph shows the Council’s unrestricted current ratio for the current and prior two financial years.

The unrestricted current ratio is specific to local government and represents council’s ability to meet its short-term obligations as they fall due. It measures the ratio of unrestricted current assets to specific purpose liabilities.

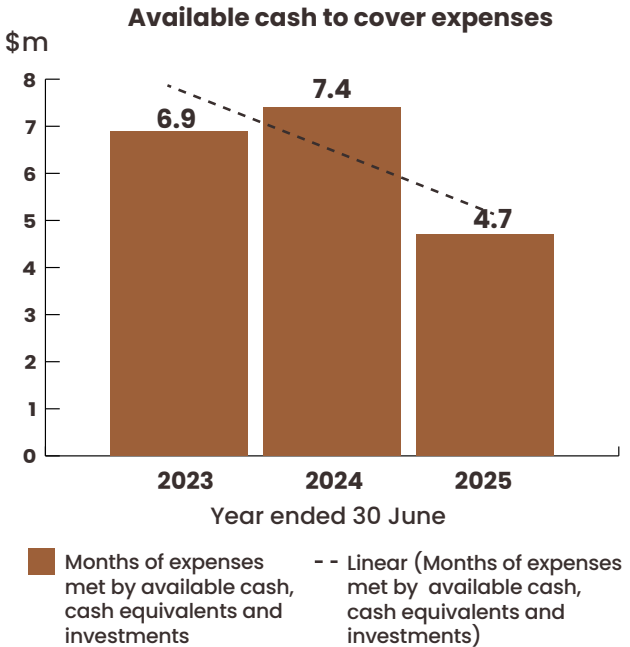
In 2023–24, the average unrestricted current ratio was an average of 5.6x for rural councils.



This graph shows the number of months of general fund expenses (excluding depreciation and borrowing costs), Council can fund from its available cash, cash equivalents and investments (not subject to external restrictions).

Further details on cash, cash equivalents and investments including the sources of external restrictions are included in the section above.

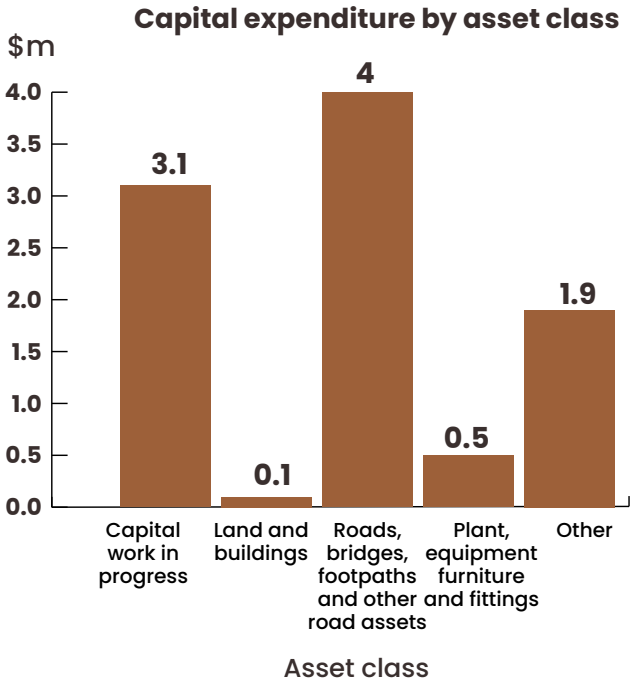
In 2023–24, the available cash to cover expenses was an average of 8 months for rural councils.



Infrastructure, property, plant and equipment

This graph shows how much the Council spent on renewing and purchasing assets in 2024–25.

Council renewed \$2.1 million of infrastructure, property, plant and equipment during the 2024–25 financial year. This was mainly spent on roads and other capital works in progress. A further \$7.6 million was spent on new assets including roads and other infrastructure



INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY (IT) SERVICES

In 2024/25, Council undertook a comprehensive and independent review of its information technology (IT) environment to ensure systems meet modern standards of service delivery, resilience and cyber security. The review assessed infrastructure, applications, governance and compliance, and identified several critical areas requiring improvement. These included gaps in cyber security protections, limited disaster recovery arrangements, reliance on legacy infrastructure and fragmented endpoint management.

With the expiry of the previous managed services agreement, Council initiated a competitive procurement process under the NSW Government's ICT Services Scheme to ensure best value, transparency and compliance with the Local Government Act 1993 (NSW). This process confirmed the need for a new provider capable of delivering modernised infrastructure, proactive support and enhanced cyber resilience.

The incoming provider commenced under a formal Service Level Agreement (SLA), which sets clear standards for performance, accountability and reporting. The SLA includes:

- Proactive monitoring and maintenance of servers, networks and endpoints to reduce downtime and improve efficiency.
- Defined response times, with urgent and critical issues addressed promptly to minimise operational disruption.
- Structured disaster recovery planning, including routine backup verification and test restorations.
- Comprehensive cyber security services, progressing Council's compliance with the Essential 8 strategies and incorporating independent penetration testing and audits.

Looking ahead, Council's IT Roadmap for 2025–26 and beyond sets out a staged program of investment and reform designed to reduce risk and support long-term digital transformation. Priorities include:

- Migration of legacy applications and infrastructure to cloud-first platforms, reducing reliance on on-premises hardware.
- Network segmentation to separate public, corporate and operational systems, addressing vulnerabilities and strengthening security for critical infrastructure.
- Expansion of Microsoft 365 and cloud-based security tools for centralised management, identity protection and threat detection.
- Introduction of a formal disaster recovery framework, supported by regular drills to ensure service continuity.
- Progression towards higher levels of compliance with the Essential 8 maturity model, with the goal of achieving sustainable, auditable security practices.

By modernising infrastructure, embedding structured cyber security protections and strengthening governance oversight, Council is ensuring that technology remains a reliable enabler of day-to-day operations and long-term community outcomes. These improvements will protect essential services, safeguard data and privacy, and provide a resilient platform to support the region's future digital and service delivery needs.

CUSTOMER SERVICES

The Customer Services team continues to serve as the community’s first point of contact with Council and the NSW Government. Our emphasis this year has been on accessibility and reliability—ensuring that residents can complete transactions locally and receive accurate, courteous assistance under Council’s Agency Agreement with Service NSW.

Services delivered include:

- Driver licensing and vehicle registrations on behalf of Transport for NSW.
- Issuing Responsible Service of Alcohol (RSA) and Responsible Conduct of Gambling (RCG) competency cards for Fair Trading.
- Supporting a wide range of other delegated Service NSW transactions.

In 2024/2025, the team processed 1,895 customer transactions, demonstrating the ongoing importance of Council as a trusted local service hub. Strict standards are applied to maintain privacy, service baselines and equitable access for all residents, including vulnerable and diverse groups.

Looking forward, the team will continue to:

- Adopt updated Service NSW training and processes.
- Strengthen compliance with privacy and audit obligations.
- Maintain a high level of accessibility for all members of the community.

Through this partnership, Council ensures that government services remain locally accessible, reinforcing our role as both a reliable delivery partner and a trusted contact point for residents.

Below is a summary of the customers served by month for the past three years.

	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Total
2024-25	209	156	192	124	147	101	142	151	98	128	277	169	1,895
2023-24	133	171	157	157	145	94	207	159	140	161	199	184	1,907
2022-23	186	213	195	173	106	141	169	146	182	108	143	51	1,816



ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT & COMMUNITY



The 2024/25 financial year has been a period of significant progress for Brewarrina Shire Council's Economic Development Department. With a strong focus on infrastructure delivery, tourism growth and community wellbeing, Council has leveraged grant funding and partnerships to advance multiple major projects while ensuring active engagement with residents and stakeholders.

ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

Major Projects

The **Main Place Project (CBD Revitalisation)** remained a major focus for Brewarrina Shire Council throughout 2024/2025. This \$6 million-plus initiative is designed to revitalise the central business district, enhancing infrastructure, improving public amenity and fostering community pride.

Early in the year, Council successfully negotiated a funding variation with the State Government to ensure the project scope aligned with the updated Main Place Plan. Project signage was then installed across town to keep residents and visitors informed of progress and upcoming works.

A key milestone was reached in February 2025, when a detailed design tender was released. Multiple submissions were received and carefully evaluated, and by May a preferred consultant had been identified. In June, Council formally endorsed the appointment and entered contract negotiations, confirming the scope, deliverables and milestones.

With these steps completed, the project has now transitioned into the design phase, where the appointed consultant will refine endorsed concepts into detailed engineering and construction documentation. This work sets the stage for construction tenders and the commencement of on-ground works in 2025/2026.

Four Mile Reserve Restoration Project

The **Four Mile Reserve Restoration Project** made significant progress during 2024/2025, laying a strong foundation for construction in the year ahead. The project is designed to upgrade amenities, improve access and safeguard the site's cultural and environmental values.

Community consultation, held in October 2024, attracted strong participation and provided valuable feedback that shaped the design direction. Later that month, the concept design was formally approved, enabling the project to progress into detailed design and planning. Geotechnical investigations were completed, and engineering designs advanced in preparation for delivery.

To ensure cultural values are respected, Extent Heritage was engaged to undertake an Aboriginal Cultural Heritage Assessment, with on-ground consultation commencing in early 2025.

Overall, the Four Mile Reserve Project advanced well through planning, design and compliance during the year. While some delays were experienced due to site and tender challenges, the project remains firmly on track to move into construction in 2025/26.

Golf Clubhouse

The redevelopment of the Brewarrina Golf Club was a key focus throughout 2024/2025, with the dual aim of improving facilities and supporting the long-term sustainability of the newly formed committee.

In mid-2024, Council prepared a draft scope of works to the committee outlining proposed upgrades, including new infrastructure and enhancements designed to improve functionality and the overall player experience. These improvements started rolling out in 2025 with the intention to attract new players from across the region, strengthening Brewarrina's profile as a unique sporting hub.

Council has maintained regular discussions and meetings with the Golf Club Committee to ensure the project reflects both member expectations and broader community priorities.

By June 2025, the project remained in the design and assessment phase, with Council and the Committee working collaboratively to refine preferred options and prepare for the next stage of delivery.

Brewarrina Multipurpose Centre (with PCYC)

The development of the Brewarrina PCYC Multipurpose Centre was one of Council's flagship projects in 2024/2025, representing a major investment in youth, sport and community facilities. With more than \$11 million secured through the Growing Regions Program, it stands as one of the largest single investments in Brewarrina's recent history.

A comprehensive Project Management Plan (PMP) was completed in early 2025, setting out governance arrangements, risk management strategies and delivery pathways. A governance framework was also established to oversee milestones and ensure accountability.

Council worked closely with PCYC NSW throughout the year to refine the project vision and ensure the facility will meet both local and regional needs for sport, youth engagement and community wellbeing. In March 2025, Council and PCYC representatives visited established PCYC facilities in Sydney, gaining valuable insights into design options, operational models and best-practice approaches to youth engagement.

During 2024/2025, options for procurement and delivery were assessed, and preparations began for design tender documentation. By June 2025, governance and project management frameworks had been finalised, initial design research was completed, and the project was formally positioned to move into the design and procurement phase in 2025/26.

Brewarrina Cemetery Upgrade

Council progressed upgrades at the Brewarrina Cemetery to enhance the township's appeal to residents and visitors. Works in 2024/2025 focused on smart irrigation (Bluetooth solenoid controllers and new sprinklers) were installed to improve water efficiency and resilience during heat events, reducing maintenance costs and supporting year-round presentation standards.

The program also advanced planning for future capacity through cemetery expansion work and celebrated community partnerships, including the restoration of a significant monument in the Old Catholic section. Local suppliers and contractors were engaged wherever possible, circulating project spend through the regional economy and building delivery capability for future capital works.

Housing Action Plan and LEP Issues Paper

The Housing Action Plan and Local Environmental Plan (LEP) Issues Paper were key planning initiatives advanced by Brewarrina Shire Council in 2024/2025, reflecting Council's commitment to tackling housing challenges and supporting sustainable growth.

In mid-2024, Council secured \$75,000 from the NSW Regional Housing Strategic Planning Fund to develop both documents. Consultants were engaged to prepare drafts that analysed existing housing supply, forecasted future demand, and identified planning reforms required to encourage development.

Community consultation was held in November 2024, with residents, stakeholders and service providers delivering valuable input on housing needs, barriers and opportunities. Feedback from these sessions was incorporated into the final versions, which were formally endorsed by Council in March 2025.

Council successfully acquitted the grant funding in April 2025, confirming that all deliverables had been met. By June 2025, the Housing Action Plan and LEP Issues Paper were complete and endorsed, providing Council with a clear roadmap for addressing housing needs and laying the foundation for sustainable, long-term growth in the shire.



Active Transport Plan

The Active Transport Plan was a major strategic initiative for Brewarrina Shire Council in 2024/2025, developed to improve walking, cycling and accessible travel options across the shire. The plan is designed to support healthier lifestyles, enhance connectivity and strengthen links between key community facilities.

In October 2024, Council secured \$110,000 from Transport for NSW to prepare the plan. Consultants were appointed later in the year to lead the process, ensuring best-practice design and strong community input. Two rounds of consultation followed: the first in November 2024, which gathered community ideas and identified priority routes, and the second in February 2025, which presented draft proposals focused on safety, connectivity and key destinations.

A draft Active Transport Plan was presented to Council and stakeholders in February 2025, outlining proposed footpaths, cycle ways and shared paths. Following revisions based on feedback, the final plan was completed and endorsed in April 2025. Importantly, the endorsed plan positioned Council to secure more than \$4 million in federal funding for active transport projects, with additional applications submitted under NSW's Get Active program.

By June 2025, the Active Transport Plan was fully finalised and endorsed, with several priority projects already moving into delivery through secured state and federal funding.

Old Mission and Hospital Creek Projects

The Old Mission and Hospital Creek projects are significant cultural heritage and community initiatives being advanced by Brewarrina Shire Council. In 2024/2025, groundwork was undertaken to ensure these projects are planned and delivered with deep respect for cultural values and community aspirations.

Both locations hold profound importance for the community, central to preserving local history and identity. In early 2025, Council engaged Extent Heritage to provide professional advice and deliver Aboriginal Cultural Heritage

Assessments. These assessments ensure all works comply with heritage requirements and are guided by cultural protocols.

Engagement with Traditional Custodians and community stakeholders was also initiated to shape cultural design principles. These discussions are influencing how the spaces will be protected, interpreted and shared with future generations. Early planning placed a strong focus on embedding cultural considerations into design concepts so that any upgrades or improvements reflect the values and stories of the community.

By June 2025, both projects were progressing through the planning and cultural assessment phase. Heritage assessments were underway, and early cultural design frameworks were being developed in close consultation with community representatives.

Brewarrina Library

The Brewarrina Library underwent significant planning and development in 2024/2025, with major progress made on a revitalisation project aimed at expanding capacity, modernising facilities and strengthening community services.

In June 2025, Council secured \$500,000 through the Public Library Infrastructure Grant to deliver the project. This investment will allow the library to grow from its current 70m² footprint into a new 250m² facility co-located within the Visitor Information & Exhibition Centre.

The expansion will address critical shortcomings identified by the State Library and bring Brewarrina into alignment with NSW Public Library Standards, ensuring the community has access to a modern, functional and inclusive library space.

NSW Get Active and Federal Active Transport

The NSW Get Active program and Federal Active Transport funding were key opportunities leveraged by Brewarrina Shire Council in 2024/2025 to enhance walking, cycling and accessibility infrastructure across the shire.

In December 2024, Council submitted four funding applications under the NSW Get Active program, seeking support for priority active transport projects. At the same time, Council prepared and lodged applications for Federal Active Transport funding, targeting large-scale projects designed to connect communities and deliver safer, more accessible active travel routes.

The Active Transport Plan, endorsed in April 2025, provided the strategic framework and evidence base for these applications. The plan identified priority routes in Brewarrina, Goodooga and Weilmoringle, with a focus on shared paths, cycleways and safe pedestrian connections.

As a result, Council successfully positioned itself to secure more than \$4 million in Federal Active Transport funding to support priority projects, with additional NSW applications still under assessment at the close of the financial year.

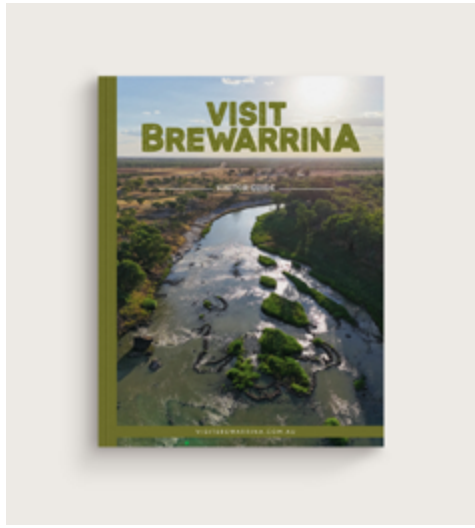
National Heritage Trust Funding – Aboriginal Fish Traps Conservation and Interpretation

The conservation and interpretation of Baiame's Ngunnhu (Brewarrina Aboriginal Fish Traps) was a key heritage initiative advanced by Brewarrina Shire Council in 2024/2025, supported through funding from the National Heritage Trust.

During the year, Council successfully secured funding to undertake conservation works and develop cultural interpretation at the Fish Traps, recognised as one of Australia's oldest and most significant Aboriginal heritage sites. Heritage specialists were engaged to provide advice on conservation priorities and cultural design principles, ensuring the project is guided by best practice and cultural integrity.

Looking ahead, Council will work with heritage advisors and Traditional Custodians to finalise the conservation works program. This collaboration will ensure the project reflects cultural knowledge and priorities, while also strengthening Brewarrina's cultural tourism offering through authentic interpretation of this iconic site.





TOURISM

Goodooga Artesian Baths

The Goodooga Artesian Baths continued to stand out as one of Brewarrina Shire's premier tourism and community attractions in 2024/2025, drawing strong visitation and contributing significantly to the local economy.

During the peak cooler months, the baths consistently welcomed 60 or more caravans and campers per night, underscoring their popularity with travellers. The facility also maintained an excellent reputation, holding a 4.5-star Google rating, with visitors praising its cleanliness, therapeutic waters and welcoming atmosphere.

Ongoing improvements and maintenance ensured the baths remained in great condition, with landscaping, seating and amenity upgrades enhancing both comfort and usability. These efforts reinforced Goodooga's reputation as a destination, supporting local businesses and boosting caravan tourism.

The baths' reputation for health and relaxation benefits continued to grow, encouraging repeat visits and strong word-of-mouth promotion. By June 2025, the Goodooga Artesian Baths remained a cornerstone of the shire's tourism offering, with both visitation and satisfaction levels consistently high.

Brewarrina Visitor Information Centre

Throughout 2024/2025, the Brewarrina Visitor Information Centre (VIC) remained the frontline gateway for visitors and a lively hub for community activity. A mid-year refresh introduced new furniture and an improved layout, lifting comfort, accessibility and the overall visitor experience.

Building on the merchandise range introduced in 2025, staff broadened retail offerings with additional branded products designed to boost sales and promote the Brewarrina brand.

Community use also strengthened. Hall bookings grew, ranging from five to 12 bookings per month, supporting training sessions, meetings and local events. The VIC now operates as a flexible, multi-use space that balances tourism services with community needs.

To support destination visibility, the team maintained regular updates to the Australian Tourism Data Warehouse (ATDW), ensuring accurate and consistent promotion of local attractions across national tourism channels.

Overall, the VIC recorded 21,233 visits across the year, reflecting sustained visitor demand alongside strong community use. Together, these improvements and activities reinforced the VIC's role as both a welcoming first stop for travellers and a valued gathering place for residents.

Brewarrina Brochure

The redevelopment of Brewarrina's tourism brochure was a key marketing initiative in 2024/2025, aimed at enhancing the shire's profile and providing visitors with clear, engaging information about the region.

In mid-2025, a new brochure was designed to replace outdated material and align with modern tourism standards. The updated brochure showcases major attractions such as Baiame's Ngunnhu (Aboriginal Fish Traps), Four Mile Reserve, Goodooga Artesian Baths, and other local cultural sites. It also highlights signature events like the Brewarrina Blizzard and the Bald Archy Exhibition, while including practical visitor information on walking trails, accommodation

and community facilities. Importantly, the brochure incorporates First Nations storytelling and cultural elements, ensuring authenticity and depth in promoting Brewarrina's unique heritage.

Distribution will occur through Visitor Information Centre's across the state, regional tourism partners and digital platforms, maximising reach and accessibility. By June 2025, the redesign was finalised and ready for rollout, positioning the brochure as a key marketing tool to support increased visitation and deeper engagement with Brewarrina's attractions.

Brewarrina Blizzard

The 2025 Brewarrina Blizzard was one of the most successful in recent years, combining strong community participation, vendor success and meaningful economic benefits for the region. Building on planning and promotion undertaken in 2024/2025, the event showcased Brewarrina's capacity to host large-scale community and tourism activities.

Across the week, the Blizzard welcomed 5,829 ice skaters with around 8,700 visitors in total. Attendees enjoyed a vibrant program of recreational, social and food-focused activities that created an inclusive and energetic atmosphere.

Vendor feedback confirmed positive outcomes, reinforcing the event's important role in stimulating local economic activity. Families, young people and visitors alike praised the organisation and atmosphere, noting that this year's program exceeded expectations and set a new benchmark for future events.

Brewarrina Shire Council played a central role in the event's success, leading planning, coordination and on-site support. Proactive facilitation by Council staff ensured smooth site management, clean facilities, effective signage and a high-quality visitor experience throughout the precinct.

Bald Archy Art Exhibition

The Bald Archy Art Exhibition was a cultural highlight for Brewarrina in 2024/2025, reinforcing the shire's profile as a regional hub for arts and community engagement.

Hosted in June 2025, the exhibition brought nationally recognised satirical portraits to Brewarrina, attracting a diverse audience of local residents, school groups and regional art enthusiasts. It provided opportunities for learning, conversation and appreciation of contemporary satire and portraiture, enriching the community's cultural experience.

By hosting this national touring exhibition, Brewarrina positioned itself as a venue capable of delivering high-quality arts programming and expanding access to cultural opportunities for its residents. Building on this success, Council also secured the Bald Archy Exhibition for 2026, ensuring continuity and ongoing cultural enrichment for the community.

COMMUNITY

Christmas Carols

The annual Christmas Carols in December 2024 was a much-loved community celebration, fostering festive spirit and strengthening social connections across Brewarrina.

Delivered in partnership with the Josiah Healing Centre, the event brought together families, community members and visitors for an inclusive evening of music, entertainment and festive activities. People of all ages participated, and positive feedback reflected the sense of joy and unity it created.

Collaboration with local organisations ensured the event was well-supported and accessible, highlighting the value of partnerships in delivering cultural celebrations. Council played a central role by providing sponsorship, planning, coordination and logistical support, including site preparation, amenities and promotion.

The Christmas Carols formed part of Council's broader program of community and cultural activities delivered throughout the year, reinforcing its commitment to fostering togetherness and celebrating local traditions.

Australia Day

Australia Day 2025 was celebrated as a major community event in Brewarrina, bringing residents together to recognise local achievements and enjoy a relaxed, family-friendly day of activities.

The celebrations were held at the Brewarrina Pool, creating an inclusive atmosphere that encouraged broad community participation. A highlight of the day was the presentation of awards across six categories, recognising the outstanding contributions of citizens, youth and community leaders:

- **Citizen of the Year:** Chris Redmond
- **Young Citizen of the Year:** Taniell Pokarier-Baker
- **Young Sports Person of the Year:** Matthew Thompson and Sophia Dowell
- **Community Achievement Award:** Nathan Johnson
- **Senior Citizen Award:** Peter Orcher

Welcome to Brewarrina Event

The Welcome to Brewarrina event, held in February 2025, provided a warm introduction for new residents while strengthening community connections.

Hosted at the Visitor Information Centre, the event welcomed more than 50 attendees, including new residents, local service providers and community members. Participants were introduced to local services, organisations and community activities, helping them feel connected and supported.

Feedback highlighted that attendees felt welcomed and valued, with the event recognised as an important initiative for community integration.

Community Careers Expo

The 2025 Brewarrina Community Careers Expo, held in July 2025 at the Brewarrina Community Hall, was hailed as a resounding success, attracting more than 60 attendees from across the shire and surrounding areas.

The event provided an invaluable opportunity for participants of all ages—from school leavers and students to mature-aged community members – to explore a diverse range of employment, training and study pathways.

The hall was filled with a vibrant and engaging atmosphere as 14 exhibitors from a broad range of sectors came together to share their expertise and inspire attendees. Exhibitors included Orana Haven, Catholic Care, University of NSW, TAFE NSW, NSW Ambulance, Fire and Rescue NSW, the Australian Defence Force (ADF), NSW Police, Rural Fire Service (RFS), Brewarrina Shire Council, Yancoal, Legal Aid, Western Local Land Services and Bilingarra.

Their combined presence offered a comprehensive overview of career and study options available both locally and beyond, ensuring that attendees left with greater awareness of the opportunities open to them and pathways to pursue their goals.

Bike Kitchen Project

Launched in February 2025, the Bike Kitchen Project quickly became an innovative and valuable initiative for Brewarrina Shire Council, promoting mobility, sustainability and youth skill development across the shire.

Since its launch, the Bike Kitchen repaired and refurbished more than 70 bikes in Brewarrina, Goolooga and Weilmoringle. New helmets were provided to participants, ensuring safer riding practices and encouraging responsible cycling.

The project also delivered hands-on training in bike maintenance and repair, helping young people develop practical skills in mechanics, safety awareness and sustainability. Beyond training, it improved local mobility by returning bikes to active use, promoted sustainable transport options and encouraged healthier, more active lifestyles across the community.

Community Interagency Meetings

Brewarrina's Community Interagency Meetings provided a consistent and valued forum for local organisations, government agencies and service providers to connect, share updates and collaborate.



With attendance ranging between 13 and 25 participants most months, the meetings fostered stronger partnerships, supported joint planning for key community events and enhanced service coordination across the shire. The program demonstrated Council's commitment to ensuring services are responsive, collaborative and accessible for the Brewarrina community

NAIDOC Week

NAIDOC Week 2024 was a major cultural celebration in Brewarrina, showcasing the community's rich First Nations heritage and fostering unity through events, storytelling and activities.

Held in July 2024, the week brought together community members, schools, service providers and visitors to celebrate First Nations culture and history. The program featured cultural performances, art displays, music, dance and storytelling, creating opportunities for intergenerational sharing and learning.

Local schools participated enthusiastically, with students engaging in cultural workshops and performances that promoted pride, knowledge and understanding.

The program was delivered through strong collaboration between Brewarrina Shire Council, local organisations and Traditional Custodians, ensuring authenticity and inclusivity in all activities. Council supported the coordination, promotion and delivery of events, working alongside community partners to make NAIDOC Week widely accessible and celebrated across the shire.

Brewarrina Youth Centre

The Brewarrina Youth Centre played a central role in community life throughout 2024/2025, providing a safe, inclusive and engaging space for young people and families. It became a hub for recreation, learning and cultural connection, while also hosting major community events that fostered pride and unity across the shire.

Youth engagement grew steadily during the year, with average attendance increasing from 20–25 young people per week to around 40 by March 2025. Holiday programs, family fun days and movie nights consistently drew large crowds, with many events attracting more than 80 children.

The Centre coordinated a broad mix of programs that supported both recreation and personal development. Through the Targeted Early Intervention (TEI) program, seven families received tailored support and case management, and on average 40 referrals per fortnight were registered with external agencies.

The Youth Centre also played a leading role in coordinating and linking into broader cultural celebrations:

- **NAIDOC Week 2024**, held in July, showcased Brewarrina's rich First Nations heritage through performances, art, music, dance, and storytelling, with strong school and community participation.
- **Youth Week 2025**, which ran into the school holidays, featured a suite of activities including Girls Night In, the Financial Literacy Camp, barbering and music workshops, and culminated in the Baime's Ngunnhu Festival at the Fish Traps. This festival brought together community members, visitors and young people to celebrate First Nations culture and heritage, creating opportunities for intergenerational connection and pride.



To meet the demands of growing participation, Council invested in both staffing and infrastructure. Two additional casual youth workers were recruited, strengthening program delivery and supervision. Facility upgrades included new games equipment such as pool tables, air hockey and table tennis, which became popular daily activities. The Centre also hosted four high school work experience students, giving them exposure to youth work, WHS and community program delivery.

Partnerships were central to the Centre's success, with strong collaboration between Council, schools, police, health providers and community organisations. These relationships improved school attendance, promoted youth safety and supported coordinated case management. Events such as family fun days, community movie nights and holiday activities strengthened intergenerational ties and reinforced Brewarrina's sense of pride and inclusion.

Elder Care Day

A key initiative launched in 2025 was the Elder Care Day, developed in collaboration with Brewarrina Hospital and Council's community engagement team. This monthly program created a safe and welcoming environment for seniors to connect, socialise and access support from visiting health professionals. Activities included morning teas, games and presentations on important health topics, such as heart health. The program quickly established itself as a valued gathering, providing social connection and practical wellbeing advice for the shire's older residents.

Seniors Week 2025

As part of Seniors Week in March 2025, Council hosted a morning tea event attended by more than 25 elders. The event fostered social interaction and highlighted the ongoing need for regular opportunities for seniors to gather. Feedback from this celebration reinforced the importance of dedicated spaces and programs that combat isolation and encourage connection among older community members.

MEDIA & COMMUNICATIONS

Media Coverage

Council achieved consistent exposure across major outlets, including Prime7 News, ABC Western Plains, ABC Central West Radio, RM Williams Magazine, Western Plains App, National Tribune, Western Herald, 2WEB, the Kamilaroi Highway Group, and the Darling River Run. A particular highlight was the Brewarrina Blizzard launch, which received statewide television coverage on Prime7 News and reached a metropolitan audience of around 300,000 viewers.

Council's digital presence also experienced strong growth throughout 2024/2025.

- Facebook grew from 2,650 followers in October 2024 to more than 3,000 by June 2025, with posts in May alone peaking at 127,000+ views.
- Instagram expanded to 340+ followers, generating 7,300 views, 1,000 reach, and 250 interactions, reflecting increased engagement from youth and regional audiences.

Top-performing campaigns included:

- **Welcome to Brewarrina Event** – 15.8k views, 5.7k reach, 131 interactions.
- **Bike Kitchen Launch** – 12.8k views, 5.1k reach, 127 interactions.
- **Goodooga Artesian Baths Opening** – 13.4k views, 9.4k reach, 80 interactions.
- **Brewarrina Blizzard Launch** – 112.4k views, 54.6k reach, 1.1k interactions, 33 shares.

Across the year, Council's media and digital campaigns generated significant engagement:

- Over 113,000 video views on Facebook.
- Peaks of 62,000 views and 25,000 reach in December 2024.
- Regular post interactions ranging from 80–700, with notable spikes for major events and funding announcements.

Council's integrated media strategy ensured residents, stakeholders and potential visitors remained well-informed. By pairing traditional outlets such as radio, print and television with dynamic social media campaigns, Council successfully amplified the visibility of local projects, services and events. This approach strengthened transparency, built community pride, and showcased Brewarrina as an active and event-ready shire.

A particular highlight was Brewarrina's inclusion in the Great Aussie Road Trip, a national TV and digital campaign coordinated through the Kamilaroi Highway Group. This exposure elevated Brewarrina's profile within regional and national tourism markets, providing promotion well beyond traditional advertising channels and leveraging the reach of both digital and televised media.

The campaign not only showcased Brewarrina's cultural and natural attractions but also aligned with Council's broader tourism and events strategy. By complementing local events, infrastructure upgrades and media engagement, it reinforced Brewarrina's image as both a destination in its own right and a key part of the wider regional tourism offering.



ENVIRONMENTAL, HEALTH & BUILDING SERVICES



The objective of the environmental services program is to provide environmentally sound planning and regulatory controls to meet the community needs through maximising the Communities access to services that improve or enhance the quality of life. Functions include:

Environmental Planning.

Environmental Planning generally covers the assessment of Development Applications (DA's) for compliance with the appropriate legislative controls, Issue of Consents (usually with conditions aimed at ensuring minimal negative impact on the property or adjoining lands), refusal of consent and monitoring of the development until completed. It also involves monitoring of the currency of the Local Environmental Plan (LEP).

This year, Council began reviewing the Local Environmental Plan (LEP 2012) after discussions with consultants and the Department of Planning highlighted barriers to development and service diversity. The first stage focuses on simple amendments to remove current restrictions, supporting developments like Rural Residential projects in suitable areas. While major changes are not expected immediately, these adjustments aim to encourage a more diverse economy and flexible land use, responding to community needs and interests.

Building Certification

Building certification ensures all construction in the Shire meets legislative requirements. Council assesses applications, supervises construction with key inspections, and issues occupancy certificates upon completion. After a period without a Building Certifier, Kim Talbert has resumed the role, providing valuable support to applicants and property owners. His ongoing presence benefits both the community and the certification process.

Development Applications

The 2024/2025 financial year has not experienced a significant number of Development Applications, and projections suggest that this trend is unlikely to change substantially in the upcoming financial year. Several applications received have not been particularly well received, and the ongoing constraints associated with the RU5 Village zone continue to complicate the evaluation of new commercial or industrial development proposals. This zoning often leads to confusion among applicants, as many believe the RU5 designation allows unrestricted development on properties they have acquired.

Throughout the 2025/26 financial year, it is important to advise all identified potential developers to engage in preliminary discussions with Council staff prior to making any commitments to acquire land within the shire or towns, or before progressing with detailed plans for proposed projects. Such early engagement will help clarify requirements and reduce misunderstandings regarding permitted uses and development controls.

In addition, Council recognises the need to undertake a major review of the Local Environmental Plan (LEP) during the next financial year. This process will be essential in addressing ongoing issues and providing clearer guidance for future developments.

DA Reg #	Location	Street Address	Lot #	Value
DA03-2024	Brewarrina	15 Barwon Street	1	\$10,000.00
DA04-2024	Brewarrina	74 Bourke Street	11	\$3,500.00
DA05-2024	Brewarrina	24 Wilson Street	A	\$ 1,945,113.20
DA06-2024	Brewarrina	Doyle Street	9	\$4,805,090.00
DA07-2024	Brewarrina	14 Bokhara Street	2	\$240,357.00
DA01-2025	Brewarrina	1 Bokhara Street	9	\$2,037,575.00
DA04-2025	Gongolgon			\$264,504
DA05-2025	Brewarrina	8725 Kamilaroi Highway	4890	\$966,935.00

Derelict/Fire Damaged Buildings

Derelict and fire damaged buildings continue to be a problem, and we continue to face challenges in rectifying this. Despite serving notices, if the owners cannot be found, or the owner cannot afford to carry out demolition and removal, Council faces the prospect of a costly process of carrying out the work necessary and then trying to recover those costs through legal process against the owners. At present there are a significant number of these premises that have had notices serviced on them and the work has not been carried out and, more often than not, the premises will require specialised Asbestos Assessment and removal.

Overgrown Lots/Urban Properties

Each year, Council continues to receive complaints regarding overgrown lots, which are frequently unoccupied or have absentee owners. These properties often present significant risks to the community, serving as potential fire hazards and attracting rodents or snakes. Such conditions can subsequently pose health risks to neighbours and the wider community.

With consultant Kim Talbert now back on staff, there has been greater attention devoted to these matters compared to previous years. Despite increased oversight, challenges persist when owners fail to comply with issued notices. In these instances, Council may be required to undertake the necessary works to address the overgrowth and then seek to recover the associated costs from the property owner.

Prior to commencing any physical work on these properties, Council has determined the necessity of issuing a Penalty Infringement Order (PIN). The PIN is recovered by the State Government on behalf of Council and can be used to offset a portion of the costs incurred. However, should there be any excess costs beyond what is covered by the PIN, Council may be required to pursue costly legal action to recover these funds, with no guarantee of success.

Food Premises

Recent inspections of food premises within the shire have indicated a general improvement in both the standard of conduct and the quality of fit out. However, several persistent issues remain that require resolution to ensure full compliance with regulatory standards and to promote public health and safety, including unlicensed food premises, unpaid inspection fees, misleading advice from some premises, and failure to keep up to date with legislative changes.

During the reporting period, one premises was issued with a Prohibition Order due to the facility being unsuitable for processing readily perishable foods. This action was taken to protect public health and demonstrates Council's commitment to enforcing standards where significant risks are identified.

A number of older food premises continue to require substantial improvements to meet current standards. The requirements for Food Safety Supervisors have also become more stringent, now demanding not only successful completion of a formal Food Safety Supervisor course but also relevant practical experience. This change reflects the increasing complexity of food safety management and the need for skilled supervision within all food businesses.

As previously reported, many premises still fall short of ideal standards relating to the condition of the premises, record keeping practices and staff conduct. While there has been an informal approach of "deferred progressive improvement" in the past, this strategy is no longer appropriate. Moving forward, it is essential that Council issues clear and definitive improvement notices where necessary to ensure timely rectification of all outstanding issues. This will help to achieve consistent compliance and maintain high standards across all food premises in the shire.

Crown Land Reserves

All Councils have had to prepare new Plans of Management (POM) for all Crown Land Reserves managed by Council. This has been a major project and required considerable outside Consultant input.

Brewarrina Council has now completed all of these, with finishing touches currently being carried out on the Four Mile Reserve and Fish Traps Reserve. Once reviewed by Crown Lands, they will all be advertised for Community review and input.

The Year Ahead

It is anticipated that the year ahead will require extra time and resources concentrated in the following areas:

- LEP initial review and changes to facilitate new development opportunities and begin preparation for a major LEP review in the next financial year of 2025/2026.

Note: Council needs to budget a significant amount for this undertaking in the next budget review.

- Seek to establish better zoning than RU5 to control Industrial and Commercial Development – this may be possible in conjunction with new ownership of lands by Council, Aboriginal Land Councils in the area that have received land settlements and private landowners.

- Development of Staff housing for specialist staff.
- Significant progressive improvement of certain food premises.
- Possible development of a Brewarrina based housing capacity that will provide less costly housing for Council projects and even private housing for local residents, who have aspiration to own their own dwellings. This may well include discussions with Aboriginal Housing as well as working with that organisation as it strives to keep up with the increasing demand for new housing and improved existing housing.
- Possible increase of TAFE training in new technics for low-cost housing.



DISABILITY INCLUSION ACTION PLAN

In August 2014, the NSW Disability Inclusion Act 2014 was passed. This Act requires Brewarrina Shire Council to develop a Disability Inclusion Action Plan to help remove barriers and enable people with a disability to participate fully in their communities.

Council's vision is for an inclusive, respectful and diverse community where all residents and visitors enjoy a safe and friendly environment. Council's Disability Inclusion Action Plan aims to provide better access to Council information, services and facilities, ensuring people with disabilities can fully participate in their community.

This Disability Inclusion Action Plan was developed through community consultation and research processes. A review of Council documents and Government policy took place, and a staff/community survey was conducted. Community consultation involved talking with service providers that work with aged and disabled members of our community.

The plan was endorsed at Council's November 2016 meeting, placed on public exhibition and formally adopted at Council's February 2017 meeting. The following achievements of Council relevant to DIAP key four areas:

Building positive attitudes and behaviours: Audits of both Council and tourism websites are carried out to ensure effectiveness; the new tourism website continues to meet Disability Inclusion Act by being AA compliant with the Web Content Accessibility Guidelines 2.0 (WCAG) however, Council's main website still requires additional work to meet necessary standard.

Council indoor staff have undertaken online training in disability awareness to promote positive views and confidence in providing customer service to a diverse range of people.

Creating liveable communities: Council Continues to utilise event management planning resources in order to ensure inclusiveness to increase social participation for all.

Whilst Council have now installed a hoist at the swimming pool and lit shared footpaths in Brewarrina, Weilmoringle and Goodooga, continuous improvement remains a focus for Council.

Targeted works include: More kerb and guttering, additional shared pathways with lighting to support connectivity of villages to township, and inclusive equipment for recreation i.e. parks and splash park.

Council has specific referrals and pathways to NDIS providers and continues to chair the interagency monthly meeting to identify community needs for recommendations to Council.

DIAP outcomes are incorporated in Council employment policies, induction and recruitment processes, which are reviewed regularly. Staff continue to undertake online disability awareness training.

Plans are currently underway for the development of a new DIAP in early 2025/2026.

STATUTORY INFORMATION

Councillor Activities & Payments Sect 217 (a) & (a1)

No Councillors or staff of Brewarrina Shire Council undertook overseas travel at Council's expense during 2024/2025 whilst representing Council.

Mayoral & Councillor Fees

Item	Amount
Mayoral Allowance	\$27,611
Councillors Fees	\$105,151
Travelling & Sustenance	\$2,051
Total	\$135,813

Councillor Expenses

Item	Amount
Delegate expenses (incl ACT)	Nil
Office equipment	Nil
Phone calls	Nil
Attendance at conferences / seminars	Nil
Training	\$17,067
Interstate travel	Nil
Overseas travel	Nil
Expenses incurred by spouse	\$1,455
Expenses incurred by provision	Nil
Partner or other persons accompanied	Nil
Councillor of care for a child or/and immediate family member	Nil
Total	\$18,522

Council Tenders Section 217 (a2)

Statement of Contracts Awarded – excess of \$250,000. Council attempts to maximise the utilisation of its scarce financial resources by attempting to secure goods and services at the most competitive price taking into account quality service and reliability. During the year ended 30 June 2025 Council awarded the following contracts that exceeded \$250,000:

- Rehabilitation and Upgrading of the Weilmoringle Settlement Ponds and Water Infrastructure
- Replacement with concrete levee, drainage upgrade at Bridge Street
- Construction of share path and installation of solar lights in Weilmoringle
- Construction of share path and installation of solar lights in Goodooga
- Engaging a suitably qualified design consultant to deliver the Main Place Project
- Supply of Side Loading Waster Compactor

More information is available at
www.brewarrina.nsw.gov.au

Legal Proceedings

Summary amounts incurred in relation to legal proceedings during period 1 July 2024 – 30 June 2025 was \$2,367.

Work on Private Land Section 217 (a4)

Generally, Council undertakes a considerable amount of private work, however, that is charged in accordance with the schedule of fees and charges adopted by Council in conjunction with the 2024/2025 Operational Plan.

Council has the resources to undertake such work and sees it both as an important service to its ratepayers, and a revenue generating opportunity given the isolation of the Shire and the lack of other persons with the resources to undertake the work. However, during this reporting period no such work was undertaken.

Modern Slavery 2018 and Local Govt Act 1993

Section 428 (4c) And (4d)

Action taken by Council in relation to any issue raised by the Anti-slavery Commissioner during the year concerning the operations of the council identified as being a significant issue – Not applicable.

There were no goods and services procured by and for the Council during the year that were a product of modern slavery within the meaning of the Modern Slavery Act 2018 – Not applicable.

Council Contributions under Section 356 (Section 217 (5a))

Council's policy is not to make donations to charitable organisations and that contributions to community-based organisations or other organisations contributing to the general amenity of the shire are considered on their individual merit. Council did not make any donations to community-based organisations and aspiring local athletes under Section 356.

External Bodies that Exercised Functions on Behalf of Council (Section 217 (A6))

There were no external bodies exercising any Council function during the year 2024/2025

Statement of Corporations, Partnerships, Trusts, Joint Ventures, Syndicates or Other Bodies where Council had a Controlling Interest (Section 217 (A7))

Council has no controlling interest in corporation, partnership, trust, joint venture, syndicate or other body.

Statement of Corporations, Partnerships, Trusts, Joint Ventures, Syndicates or Other Bodies (Section 217 (A8))

Brewarrina Shire Council has an interest in the following organisations:

Group/Association	Summary
Big Sky Libraries – Brewarrina Shire Council	Member of North West Slopes and Plains Cooperative Library Service (Moree Plains, Brewarrina, Walgett, Gwydir Shires). Enables better library services, resource access, and cost savings through shared membership and administration by Moree Plains Shire Council.
Statewide Mutual Insurance Group	Local Government insurance group administered by Jardine Lloyd Thomas Pty Ltd, supported by NSW councils and associations. Develops tailored insurance products and negotiates best prices for councils, resulting in significant savings, especially in public liability and professional indemnity.
Kamilaroi Highway Tourism Promotion Group	Six Shire Councils (including Gunnedah, Narrabri, Walgett, Brewarrina) formed to promote the Kamilaroi Highway as a tourism link from New England to the Outback, aiming to increase tourist numbers along the 600-kilometre route.
Orana Water Utilities Alliance	Alliance of Warren, Bogan, Bourke, Brewarrina, Cobar, Dubbo, Mid West Regional, Warrumbungle, Walgett, Central Darling, Narromine Shires. Shares resources and consultants for integrated water cycle, drought management, and best practice water management.
Murray Darling Association	Formed by Local Government in the Murray Darling Basin to focus on conservation, sustainable development, and natural resource management. Facilitates community participation, provides information, and influences government policy.
Local Government NSW (LGNSW)	Peak industry association representing all 128 NSW general purpose councils, 12 special purpose councils, and NSW Aboriginal Land Council. Supports and advocates for councils, strengthening local government and delivering quality services.
Western Alliance	Alliance of 13 Western NSW Councils covering 32% of NSW. Collaborates to improve water and sewerage outcomes, sharing knowledge and resources for better community services through cooperative relationships.

General Manager Total Remuneration Package (Section 217 (B))

In accordance with Section 332 of the Local Government Act, the position of General Manager is the only position at council determined as a senior staff position.

Expenses relating to the General Manager’s position were:

Item	Amount
Salary Component	\$249,686
Superannuation	\$28,714
Fringe Benefits Tax	\$17,898

A subsidised house and car were also provided to the General Manager.

Senior Staff Remuneration Package (Section 217 (C))

Brewarrina Shire Council did not employ any senior staff during the financial year as classified under the NSW Local Government Act.

Storm Water Management Services Levy (Section 217 (E))

Brewarrina Shire Council did not undertake any additional charges or levies for storm water management for services provided by Council during the financial year.

Statement of Activities Relating to Companion Animals (Section 217 (F))

Brewarrina Council lodges all Pound data to the Department by the due date as required.

Brewarrina Council lodges all data relating to dog attacks with the Department as soon as practicable after attack.

Funding spent in relation to companion animal management and activities is reported in annual financial report.

Promotion of animal programs carried out through public awareness programs, media, social media and leaflets.

Strategies Council has in place to promote and assist in the de-sexing of dogs and cats:

- Responsible pet ownership encouraged and promoted.
- Dogs and cats purchased from pound must be registered and microchipped.
- Strategies in place to comply with the requirement under section 64 (Companion Animals Act) to seek alternatives to euthanasia for unclaimed animals
- Encourage re-housing of animals in the community.

Animal Control

The 2024/2025 year has been one for increased surrender and captured animals in the Shire.

The reports of nuisance dogs have decreased slightly on the previous year’s total.

Cat issues are stable with a number of wild and stray animals caught or handed into Shire over the year.

Council is continuing with a social media and community awareness campaign to re-unite owners with their pets, re-homing of unwanted animals in Shire care and reminding the community of their responsibilities as pet owners.

We also successfully secured funding to undertake a research program alongside the RSPCA to understand and target stray animals across the community. The program will get underway in September 2025.

Works undertaken:

- Continual trap upgrades
- Six new temporary cages installed.

	Dogs	Cats
Total	119	10
Complaints	13	–
Re-homed	98	6
Released	12	4

EEO Management Plan

During the period July 2024 to June 2025 Council has undertaken the following activities to ensure the principles of Equal Employment Opportunity Legislation are applied:

- All new staff employed in this period have been provided with an induction manual that has been reviewed in this time period and includes the Equal Employment Opportunity Policy.
- All advertising for vacant positions, comply with EEO principles and are reviewed by the General Manager to ensure advertising is non-discriminatory.
- Council’s EEO statement is included on all position vacant advertisements.
- All staff have been given a copy and acknowledged receipt of the Council’s Code of Conduct, and the grievance procedures outlined to them.
- Selection panels to be composite. (Min 3) and are fully aware of and implement the principles of EEO and Anti-Discrimination.
- Council’s Human Resources Manager continues to provide assistance to employees and supervisors regarding EEO issues and grievances.
- Council continues to maintain its membership of LG NSW HR Advance facility to ensure Council has access up to date legal advice and information relating to industrial Relations matter.

Government Information
(Public Access) Act 2009 (NSW)

Section 125 of the Government Information
(Public Access) Act 2009 (NSW)

Council is required by the Government Information (Public Access) Act 2009 to include in its Annual Report statistics relating to applications received for access to its records under the Act and these are detailed hereunder:

	Personal	Other	Total
New (incl transferred in)	-	-	-
Brought Forward	-	-	-
Total to be Processed	-	-	-
Completed	-	1	1
Transferred Out	-	-	-
Withdrawn	1	-	1
Total Processed	-	-	2
Unfinished (carried forward)	1	-	-

Privacy and Personal Information Act
(1998)

Council provides adequate access to records and information. Council adopted the Model Privacy Management Plan and the Model Code of Practice for Local

Government in 2000 and has not made any amendments to the Plan. Council continues to assist customers by providing information in response to legitimate enquiries.

PART 2

ANNUAL REPORT ON ACTIVITIES

2024/2025



Brewarrina Shire Council's Delivery Program for 2024/25 set out clear priorities, ongoing activities and specific actions that Council will undertake within its responsibilities and capacity towards achieving the communities' outcomes.

The Delivery Program sets out the principal activities Council will undertake across the full range of Council's operations. These activities directly address the goals and strategies outlined in the Community Strategic Plan 'Brewarrina Shire Council 2026'. The activities are those that Council have the responsibility and capacity to implement through links to Council's Resourcing Strategy.

The Delivery Program will run for four years covering a full Council term and is reviewed on an annual basis. This report addresses the annual progress in relation to the achievement of the key objectives for the 2024/2025 financial year.

Key issues and challenges and our community vision statement

"Create an economic and socially sustainable Brewarrina Shire for our children"

Community consultation identified key challenges affecting Brewarrina

- The hollowing out of the population – trend toward increases in older, less skilled, more welfare dependent population. Need to boost the population (and skill levels) by attracting and retaining working families and employed young adults.
- Need to attract new industry and enterprises to reduce reliance on agriculture industry and help boost employment – particularly semiskilled industry.
- Provision of community services and facilities, such as health services and law enforcement, to service existing residents and attract new residents.

- Infrastructure and services across the shire need to be of an adequate standard to support local business and the community – e.g. local and rural roads, water supply, waste management and drainage.
- Need to support the youth of the community and encourage their development, education and ensure there are adequate facilities and services to meet their needs.

Strategic goals that community identified to address key challenges

1. Provide a safe and attractive working and living environment that will attract skilled people and help boost the population

Council actions:

- Council maintains and upgrades community facilities and infrastructure: pool, parks, tourist facilities, roads, water and sewerage, show ground upgrade, airport facilities.
- Successfully lobbying Government on issues concerning schooling, health, promoting and supporting First Nations cultural heritage, law and order, transport, electricity and water.
- Ensuring access to services and facilities, local events and sponsorships.
- Promoting the use of CCTV cameras, public lighting; regular meetings with community policing, maintaining community infrastructure, alcohol accord, heritage, waste and environmental management.
- Subsidising and facilitating the provision of medical, dental, youth services, Commonwealth and State agency services, Service NSW, Centrelink, fire and emergency services.
- Providing housing and accommodation for staff, community and elderly.

2. Continue to support and develop agriculture and other existing industries but reduce reliance on the agriculture industry via development of alternate income sources.

Council actions:

- Improving road access with successful funding for roads and engaging with local contractors and Council labour to undertake where possible.
- Involvement in Murray Darling water groups, lobbying on water use and entitlements, drought funding assistance.
- Developing and promoting options for kangaroo abattoir, sporting amenities and tourism infrastructure.
- Encouraging business development, local purchasing, policy promoting work opportunities in the community.

3. A shire that has quality and well-maintained infrastructure.

Council actions:

- Council maintains and upgrades community facilities and infrastructure: pool, parks, tourist facilities, roads, water and sewerage, showground upgrade, airport facilities.
- Maintaining Council buildings: housing, aged care and civic buildings. Depot upgrade Goodooga, and VIC Bowling Club Building.
- Funding and design new Sewerage Treatment Plant, upgrade to water and rubbish facilities.

4. A place that encourages vitality and leadership in the community.

Council actions:

- Councillors and management working together to maintain active involvement in community consultation and communications.
- Team approach with Councillors and management working for common goals.
- Maintaining local community news sources, community meetings and electronic access to information.

- Community meetings, newsletters, web publishing, social media to actively seek community views on current and new development opportunities.
- Open forum prior to Council meetings and Councillors and staff participates in community meetings and encourages open discussion.
- Involvement in regional, state and federal Local Government forums to promote and communicate the best interest of Brewarrina community in those forums.

5. A council that provides quality and cost-effective services, and that partners with the community in decision-making.

Council actions:

- Council undertakes regular communications through local media outlets, Council website, Facebook and Instagram. Council representatives attend community group and committee meetings.
- Council representatives are involved with community groups and have attended meetings to engage with local community leaders and invited representatives to attend both formal and informal Council and parliamentary briefing sessions.

6. A community that is inclusive and encourages the development of its young people.

Council actions:

- Council employs community development staff and youth centre staff to develop programs for youth in conjunction with interagency groups.
- Council is working on increasing staffing in Brewarrina and Goodooga youth centres.
- Council offers traineeships and apprenticeships, and supports school work experience, literacy programs, school-based traineeships and apprenticeships, community development programs and bush to beach activities.

Included in this report details specific strategies in line with the community plan and actions that Council has taken to address those issues.

Brewarrina Shire Councillors and staff are committed to the Brewarrina Community Strategic Plan and work as a team for the betterment of the Brewarrina Shire Local Government Area.

Delivery Program Actions

Community consultation identified key challenges affecting Brewarrina Shire

- The hollowing out of the population – trend toward increases in older, less skilled, more welfare dependent population. Need to boost the population (and skill levels) by attracting and retaining working families and employed young adults.
- Need to attract new industry and enterprises to boost employment.
- Provision of community services and facilities, such as health services and law enforcement, to service existing residents and attract new residents.
- Infrastructure and services across the shire need to be of an adequate standard to support local business and the community – e.g. local and rural roads, water supply, waste management and drainage.
- Need to support the youth of the community and encourage their development, education and ensure there are adequate facilities and services to meet their needs.

Brewarrina Shire Councillors at a workshop on October 28, 2016, set out the following as desired outcomes they would like for the Brewarrina Shire during their term of Council. Some of the outcomes described below are the responsibility of Council, however Council can support actions that are responsibility of others i.e. State and Federal Governments.

Councillors identified the following for their community;

Capital Projects

- Proclaimed place for people effected by drugs and alcohol
- Additional aged care units
- Healing centre for youth
- Shop and service station for Goodooga
- Improvements to view the Fish Traps
- Sealing of the Goodooga Road
- Access to the Narran Lake Reserve for the public
- Increased water infrastructure to ensure water reliability to the communities of the Brewarrina Shire.

Community Ideals

- Community working as one to achieve goals
- Create and promote the positives in the community
- Community to have ownership and be leaders in governance.

Education

- Children to attend school and value education
- Council to offer traineeships / education opportunities to youth.

Culture and Heritage

- "ONE" Community – Aboriginal heritage and European heritage both are important and should be respected
- Tourism opportunities with river.

The Environment

- Healthy river is important to all
- Water equity – everyone has the right to access water.

Roads

- Brewarrina to Hebel to be sealed
- Many existing dirt roads in the Shire to be reformed
- Streets and footpaths to meet community expectations
- Additional work on Narran Lake Road with opal dirt.

Recreation

- Waterwise bowling green
- Four Mile Camping Reserve and parks along river to look appealing to encourage visitors to stay.

Employment

- Needs accountability of State and Australian Government as in dollars spent in Brewarrina versus employment outcomes
- No jobs for people to aspire to – need some type of industry so there is a viable employment outcome.

These issues will be addressed under the following categories:

1. Social
2. Economic
3. Infrastructure
4. Environmental
5. Governance

Each of these categories outlines a summary of the community views as outlined in the Community Strategic Plan “Brewarrina Shire 2026”. These views have led to the development of objectives for each category.

Each objective has set strategies and a “Council Delivery Program Action” has been put in place outlining what Council aims to do, who is responsible, the measure of success against the actions and timeframe.

Responsible department – officer

GM	General Manager
EDM	Economic Development Manager
FAM	Finance and Administration Manager
HRM	Human Resources Manager
TM	Transport Manager
UM	Utilities Manager
CHB	Consultant Health and Building

PART 3

ANNUAL FINANCIAL REPORT

Council Financial Report
LGA Sect 428 (4)

Council's financial reports were audited by the Auditor General of NSW, under Section 417(1) of the Local Government Act, 1993 and the Local Government Code of Accounting Practice and Financial Reporting to the General and Special Purpose Financial Statements.

Brewarrina Shire Council

GENERAL PURPOSE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
for the year ended 30 June 2025

*Building on the economic and social sustainability in order
to preserve the rich heritage of the community*



Brewarrina Shire Council

General Purpose Financial Statements

for the year ended 30 June 2025

Contents	Page
Statement by Councillors and Management	3
Primary Financial Statements:	
Income Statement	4
Statement of Comprehensive Income	5
Statement of Financial Position	6
Statement of Changes in Equity	7
Statement of Cash Flows	8
Notes to the Financial Statements	9
Independent Auditor's Reports:	
On the Financial Statements (Sect 417 [2])	59
On the Financial Statements (Sect 417 [3])	62

Overview

Brewarrina Shire Council is constituted under the Local Government Act 1993 (NSW) and has its principal place of business at:

57 Bathurst Street
Brewarrina NSW 2839

Council's guiding principles are detailed in Chapter 3 of the LGA and includes:

- principles applying to the exercise of functions generally by council,
- principles to be applied when making decisions,
- principles of community participation,
- principles of sound financial management, and
- principles for strategic planning relating to the development of an integrated planning and reporting framework.

A description of the nature of Council's operations and its principal activities are provided in Note B1-2.

Through the use of the internet, we have ensured that our reporting is timely, complete and available at minimum cost. All press releases, financial statements and other information are publicly available on our website: www.brewarrina.nsw.gov.au.

Brewarrina Shire Council

General Purpose Financial Statements

for the year ended 30 June 2025

Statement by Councillors and Management made pursuant to Section 413 (2c) of the *Local Government Act 1993 (NSW)*

The attached general purpose financial statements have been prepared in accordance with:

- the *Local Government Act 1993* and the regulations made thereunder,
- the Australian Accounting Standards issued by the Australian Accounting Standards Board
- the Local Government Code of Accounting Practice and Financial Reporting.

To the best of our knowledge and belief, these statements:

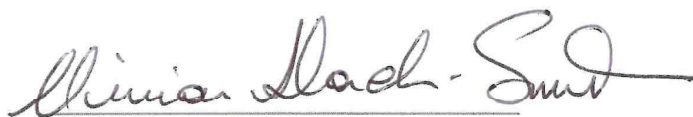
- present fairly the Council's operating result and financial position for the year
- accord with Council's accounting and other records.

We are not aware of any matter that would render these statements false or misleading in any way.

Signed in accordance with a resolution of Council made on 26 August 2025.



Tommy Stanton
Mayor
26 August 2025



Vivian Slack-Smith
Deputy Mayor
26 August 2025



David Kirby
General Manager
26 August 2025



Angus Chan
Responsible Accounting Officer
26 August 2025

Brewarrina Shire Council

Income Statement

for the year ended 30 June 2025

Original unaudited budget 2025 \$ '000		Notes	Actual 2025 \$ '000	Actual 2024 \$ '000
	Income from continuing operations			
2,793	Rates and annual charges	B2-1	2,834	2,691
3,720	User charges and fees	B2-2	7,659	6,074
170	Other revenues	B2-3	456	339
9,902	Grants and contributions provided for operating purposes	B2-4	10,636	15,245
13,424	Grants and contributions provided for capital purposes	B2-4	3,650	5,996
737	Interest and investment income	B2-5	1,131	1,020
185	Other income	B2-6	153	138
30,931	Total income from continuing operations		26,519	31,503
	Expenses from continuing operations			
4,885	Employee benefits and on-costs	B3-1	6,481	6,625
8,945	Materials and services	B3-2	13,164	13,254
–	Borrowing costs	B3-3	–	10
305	Other expenses	B3-5	3,322	456
–	Net loss from the disposal of assets	B4-1	998	110
	Total expenses from continuing operations excluding depreciation, amortisation and impairment of non-financial assets		23,965	20,455
14,135	Operating result from continuing operations excluding depreciation, amortisation and impairment of non-financial assets		2,554	11,048
	Depreciation, amortisation and impairment of non-financial assets	B3-4	5,689	5,910
10,845	Operating result from continuing operations		(3,135)	5,138
10,845	Net operating result for the year attributable to Council		(3,135)	5,138
	Net operating result for the year before grants and contributions provided for capital purposes		(6,785)	(858)

The above Income Statement should be read in conjunction with the accompanying notes.

Brewarrina Shire Council

Statement of Comprehensive Income

for the year ended 30 June 2025

	Notes	2025 \$ '000	2024 \$ '000
Net operating result for the year – from Income Statement		(3,135)	5,138
Other comprehensive income:			
Amounts which will not be reclassified subsequent to operating result			
Gain (loss) on revaluation of infrastructure, property, plant and equipment	C1-7	(10,494)	12,564
Impairment (loss) reversal / (revaluation decrement) relating to infrastructure, property, plant and equipment	C1-7	–	(1,425)
Total items which will not be reclassified subsequent to operating result		(10,494)	11,139
Total other comprehensive income for the year		(10,494)	11,139
Total comprehensive income for the year attributable to Council		(13,629)	16,277

The above Statement of Comprehensive Income should be read in conjunction with the accompanying notes.

Brewarrina Shire Council

Statement of Financial Position

as at 30 June 2025

	Notes	2025 \$ '000	2024 \$ '000
ASSETS			
Current assets			
Cash and cash equivalents	C1-1	1,697	23,819
Investments	C1-2	19,500	3,000
Receivables	C1-4	6,932	10,700
Inventories	C1-5	200	284
Contract assets and contract cost assets	C1-6	5,034	956
Other		70	45
Total current assets		33,433	38,804
Non-current assets			
Infrastructure, property, plant and equipment (IPPE)	C1-7	244,970	252,828
Total non-current assets		244,970	252,828
Total assets		278,403	291,632
LIABILITIES			
Current liabilities			
Payables	C3-1	2,316	4,113
Contract liabilities	C3-2	7,730	5,400
Employee benefit provisions	C3-4	1,250	1,369
Total current liabilities		11,296	10,882
Non-current liabilities			
Payables	C3-1	51	51
Employee benefit provisions	C3-4	75	89
Total non-current liabilities		126	140
Total liabilities		11,422	11,022
Net assets		266,981	280,610
EQUITY			
Accumulated surplus		175,203	178,338
IPPE revaluation surplus	C4-1	91,778	102,272
Council equity interest		266,981	280,610
Total equity		266,981	280,610

The above Statement of Financial Position should be read in conjunction with the accompanying notes.

Brewarrina Shire Council

Statement of Changes in Equity

for the year ended 30 June 2025

	Notes	2025			2024		
		Accumulated surplus \$ '000	IPPE revaluation surplus \$ '000	Total equity \$ '000	Accumulated surplus \$ '000	IPPE revaluation surplus \$ '000	Total equity \$ '000
Opening balance at 1 July		178,338	102,272	280,610	173,200	91,133	264,333
Opening balance		178,338	102,272	280,610	173,200	91,133	264,333
Net operating result for the year		(3,135)	–	(3,135)	5,138	–	5,138
Net operating result for the period		(3,135)	–	(3,135)	5,138	–	5,138
Other comprehensive income							
Gain (loss) on revaluation of infrastructure, property, plant and equipment	C1-7	–	(10,494)	(10,494)	–	12,564	12,564
– Impairment (loss)/ reversal relating to IPP&E	C1-7	–	–	–	–	(1,425)	(1,425)
Other comprehensive income		–	(10,494)	(10,494)	–	11,139	11,139
Total comprehensive income		(3,135)	(10,494)	(13,629)	5,138	11,139	16,277
Closing balance at 30 June		175,203	91,778	266,981	178,338	102,272	280,610

The above Statement of Changes in Equity should be read in conjunction with the accompanying notes.

Brewarrina Shire Council

Statement of Cash Flows

for the year ended 30 June 2025

Original unaudited budget 2025 \$ '000		Notes	Actual 2025 \$ '000	Actual 2024 \$ '000
Cash flows from operating activities				
Receipts:				
2,793	Rates and annual charges		2,884	2,706
3,720	User charges and fees		8,423	6,606
737	Interest received		1,111	985
23,326	Grants and contributions		13,298	22,646
–	Bonds, deposits and retentions received		4	2
355	Other		2,057	1,227
Payments:				
(4,885)	Payments to employees		(6,402)	(6,474)
(8,945)	Payments for materials and services		(17,633)	(13,248)
–	Borrowing costs		–	(13)
(306)	Other		(621)	(226)
16,795	Net cash flows from operating activities	G1-1	3,121	14,211
Cash flows from investing activities				
Receipts:				
–	Proceeds from sale of IPPE		82	26
Payments:				
–	Purchase of investments		(16,500)	(3,000)
(16,314)	Payments for IPPE		(8,825)	(6,356)
(16,314)	Net cash flows from investing activities		(25,243)	(9,330)
Cash flows from financing activities				
Payments:				
–	Repayment of borrowings		–	(363)
–	Net cash flows from financing activities		–	(363)
481	Net change in cash and cash equivalents		(22,122)	4,518
–	Cash and cash equivalents at beginning of year		23,819	19,301
481	Cash and cash equivalents at end of year	C1-1	1,697	23,819
–	plus: Investments on hand at end of year	C1-2	19,500	3,000
481	Total cash, cash equivalents and investments		21,197	26,819

The above Statement of Cash Flows should be read in conjunction with the accompanying notes.

Brewarrina Shire Council

Contents for the notes to the Financial Statements for the year ended 30 June 2025

A About Council and these financial statements	11
A1-1 Basis of preparation	11
B Financial Performance	13
B1 Functions or activities	13
B1-1 Functions or activities – income, expenses and assets	13
B1-2 Components of functions or activities	14
B2 Sources of income	15
B2-1 Rates and annual charges	15
B2-2 User charges and fees	16
B2-3 Other revenues	17
B2-4 Grants and contributions	18
B2-5 Interest and investment income	19
B2-6 Other income	20
B3 Costs of providing services	21
B3-1 Employee benefits and on-costs	21
B3-2 Materials and services	22
B3-3 Borrowing costs	22
B3-4 Depreciation, amortisation and impairment of non-financial assets	23
B3-5 Other expenses	24
B4 Gains or losses	24
B4-1 Gain or loss from the disposal, replacement and de-recognition of assets	24
B5 Performance against budget	25
B5-1 Material budget variations	25
C Financial position	27
C1 Assets we manage	27
C1-1 Cash and cash equivalents	27
C1-2 Financial investments	27
C1-3 Restricted and allocated cash, cash equivalents and investments	28
C1-4 Receivables	30
C1-5 Inventories	31
C1-6 Contract assets	32
C1-7 Infrastructure, property, plant and equipment	33
C2 Leasing activities	36
C2-1 Council as a lessee	36
C2-2 Council as a lessor	37
C3 Liabilities of Council	37
C3-1 Payables	37
C3-2 Contract Liabilities	38
C3-3 Borrowings	39
C3-4 Employee benefit provisions	40

Brewarrina Shire Council

Contents for the notes to the Financial Statements for the year ended 30 June 2025

C4 Reserves	41
C4-1 Nature and purpose of reserves	41
D Council structure	42
D1 Results by fund	42
D1-1 Income Statement by fund	42
D1-2 Statement of Financial Position by fund	43
E Risks and accounting uncertainties	44
E1-1 Risks relating to financial instruments held	44
E2-1 Fair value measurement	47
E3-1 Contingencies	50
F People and relationships	53
F1 Related party disclosures	53
F1-1 Key management personnel (KMP)	53
F1-2 Councillor and Mayoral fees and associated expenses	55
F2 Other relationships	55
F2-1 Audit fees	55
G Other matters	56
G1-1 Statement of Cash Flows information	56
G2-1 Commitments	57
G3-1 Events occurring after the reporting date	58

A About Council and these financial statements

A1-1 Basis of preparation

These financial statements were authorised for issue by Council on 26 August 2025. Council has the power to amend and reissue these financial statements in cases where critical information is received from public submissions or where the OLG directs Council to amend the financial statements.

The material accounting policy information related to these financial statements are set out below. Accounting policies have been consistently applied to all the years presented, unless otherwise stated.

These general purpose financial statements have been prepared in accordance with Australian Accounting Standards and Australian Accounting Interpretations, the *Local Government Act 1993 (NSW)* and Regulations, and the Local Government Code of Accounting Practice and Financial Reporting.

Council is a not for-profit entity.

The financial statements are presented in Australian dollars and are rounded to the nearest thousand dollars.

Unless otherwise indicated, all amounts disclosed in the financial statements are actual amounts. Specific budgetary amounts which are not subject to external audit have been included for comparative analysis (to actuals) in the following reports and notes:

- Income statement
- Statement of cash flows
- Note B5-1 – Material budget variations

and are clearly marked.

Historical cost convention

These financial statements have been prepared under the historical cost convention, as modified by the revaluation of certain infrastructure, property, plant and equipment and investment property.

Significant accounting estimates and judgements

The preparation of financial statements requires the use of certain critical accounting estimates. It also requires management to exercise its judgement in the process of applying the Council's accounting policies.

Estimates and judgements are continually evaluated and are based on historical experience and other factors, including expectations of future events that may have a financial impact on the Council and that are believed to be reasonable under the circumstances.

Critical accounting estimates and assumptions

Council makes estimates and assumptions concerning the future.

The resulting accounting estimates will, by definition, seldom equal the related actual results.

The estimates and assumptions that have a significant risk of causing a material adjustment to the carrying amounts of assets and liabilities within the next financial year include:

- (i) estimated fair values of infrastructure, property, plant and equipment – refer Note C1-7 and Note E2-1
- (ii) employee benefit provisions – refer Note C3-4.

Significant judgements in applying the Council's accounting policies

- (i) Impairment of receivables

Council has made a significant judgement about the impairment of a number of its receivables – refer Note C1-3.

Monies and other assets received by Council

The Consolidated Fund

In accordance with the provisions of Section 409(1) of the Local Government Act 1993 (NSW), all money and property received by Council is held in the Council's Consolidated Fund unless it is required to be held in the Council's Trust Fund.

A1-1 Basis of preparation (continued)

Cash and other assets of the following entities have been included as part of the Consolidated Fund:

- General purpose operations
- Water service
- Sewerage service

New accounting standards and interpretations issued but not yet effective

New accounting standards and interpretations issued but not yet effective

Certain new accounting standards and interpretations have been published that are not mandatory for the 30 June 2025 reporting period. Council has not applied any pronouncements before its operative date in the annual reporting period beginning 1 July 2024.

As at the date of authorisation of these financial statements Council does not consider that any of these new (and still to be applied) standards and interpretations are likely to have a material impact on the Council's future financial statements, financial position, financial performance or cash flows.

New accounting standards adopted during the year

During the year Council adopted all accounting standards and interpretations (as issued by the Australian Accounting Standards Board) which were mandatorily effective from the first time at 30 June 2025.

The following new standard is effective for the first time at 30 June 2025:

- *AASB 2022-10 Amendments to Australian Accounting Standards – Fair Value Measurement of Non-Financial Assets of Not-for-Profit Public Sector Entities.*

Based on analysis of existing fair value methodology, the new standard will not have significant impact on the council's reported financial position.

- *AASB 2020-1 Amendments to Australian Accounting Standards – Classification of Liabilities as Current or Non-current*
- *AASB 2020-6 Amendments to Australian Accounting Standards – Classification of Liabilities as Current or Non-current – Deferral of Effective Date*
- *AASB 2022-6 Amendments to Australian Accounting Standards – Non-current Liabilities with Covenants*

Based on analysis of existing loans and other financial liabilities, the new standards will not have significant impact on the council's reported financial position.

B Financial Performance

B1 Functions or activities

B1-1 Functions or activities – income, expenses and assets

Income, expenses and assets have been directly attributed to the following functions or activities. Details of those functions or activities are provided in Note B1-2.

	Income		Expenses		Operating result		Grants and contributions		Carrying amount of assets	
	2025 \$ '000	2024 \$ '000	2025 \$ '000	2024 \$ '000	2025 \$ '000	2024 \$ '000	2025 \$ '000	2024 \$ '000	2025 \$ '000	2024 \$ '000
Functions or activities										
Governance	5	5	817	767	(812)	(762)	–	–	–	–
Administration	433	346	5,239	4,044	(4,806)	(3,698)	–	–	35,184	43,901
Public Order and Safety	63	286	536	419	(473)	(133)	38	110	–	–
Health	74	52	112	207	(38)	(155)	–	–	–	–
Environment	1,092	387	834	857	258	(470)	738	71	5,638	3,877
Community Services and Education	332	328	810	911	(478)	(583)	189	218	27,202	27,663
Housing and Community Amenities	328	369	533	551	(205)	(182)	202	272	2,120	1,061
Water Supplies	1,364	1,378	1,578	1,644	(214)	(266)	–	–	17,301	17,184
Sewerage Services	759	584	866	655	(107)	(71)	137	–	10,097	9,993
Recreation and Culture	1,032	2,244	1,239	1,212	(207)	1,032	1,026	2,234	4,494	4,974
Mining, Manufacturing and Construction	3	1	41	31	(38)	(30)	–	–	–	–
Transport and Communication	13,993	16,487	15,227	13,720	(1,234)	2,767	7,414	12,146	176,367	182,979
Economic Affairs	1,579	904	1,822	1,347	(243)	(443)	5	–	–	–
General Purpose Income	5,462	8,132	–	–	5,462	8,132	4,537	6,190	–	–
Total functions and activities	26,519	31,503	29,654	26,365	(3,135)	5,138	14,286	21,241	278,403	291,632

B1-2 Components of functions or activities

Details relating to the Council's functions or activities as reported in B1-1 are as follows:

GOVERNANCE

Includes costs relating to Council's role as a component of democratic government, including elections, members' fees and expenses, subscriptions to local authority associations, meetings of Council and policymaking committees, public disclosure (e.g. GIPA), and legislative compliance.

ADMINISTRATION

Includes corporate support and other support services, engineering works, and any Council policy compliance.

PUBLIC ORDER AND SAFETY

Includes Council's fire and emergency services levy, fire protection, emergency services, beach control, enforcement of regulations and animal control.

HEALTH

Includes immunisation, food control, health centres etc.

ENVIRONMENT

Includes noxious plants and insect/vermin control; other environmental protection; solid waste management, including domestic waste; other waste management; other sanitation; and garbage, street cleaning, drainage and stormwater management.

COMMUNITY SERVICES AND EDUCATION

Includes administration and education; social protection (welfare); migrant, Aboriginal and other community services and administration (excluding accommodation – as it is covered under 'housing and community amenities'); youth services; aged and disabled persons services; children's services, including family day care; child care; and other family and children services.

HOUSING AND COMMUNITY AMENITIES

Includes public cemeteries; public conveniences; street lighting; town planning; other community amenities, including housing development and accommodation for families and children, aged persons, disabled persons, migrants and Indigenous persons.

WATER SUPPLIES

Includes water supplies to Brewarrina, Angledool and Goodooga.

SEWERAGE SERVICES

Includes sewerage services to Brewarrina and Goodooga.

RECREATION AND CULTURE

Includes public libraries; museums; art galleries; community centres and halls, including public halls and performing arts venues; sporting grounds and venues; swimming pools; parks; gardens; lakes; and other sporting, recreational and cultural services.

MINING, MANUFACTURING AND CONSTRUCTION

Includes building control, quarries and pits, mineral resources, and abattoirs.

TRANSPORT AND COMMUNICATION

Urban local, urban regional, includes sealed and unsealed roads, bridges, footpaths, parking areas, and aerodromes.

ECONOMIC AFFAIRS

Includes camping areas and caravan parks; tourism and area promotion; industrial development promotion; sale yards and markets; real estate development; commercial nurseries; and other business undertakings.

B2 Sources of income

B2-1 Rates and annual charges

	2025 \$ '000	2024 \$ '000
Ordinary rates		
Residential	79	75
Farmland	1,132	1,053
Business	20	19
Less: pensioner rebates (mandatory)	(3)	(3)
Rates levied to ratepayers	1,228	1,144
Pensioner rate subsidies received	2	2
Total ordinary rates	1,230	1,146
Annual charges (pursuant to s496, 496A, 496B, 501 & 611)		
Domestic waste management services	250	241
Water supply services	830	799
Sewerage services	531	511
Less: pensioner rebates (mandatory)	(15)	(14)
Annual charges levied	1,596	1,537
Pensioner annual charges subsidies received:		
– Water	2	2
– Sewerage	2	2
– Domestic waste management	4	4
Total annual charges	1,604	1,545
Total rates and annual charges	2,834	2,691
Timing of revenue recognition for rates and annual charges		
Rates and annual charges recognised at a point in time (2)	2,834	2,691
Total rates and annual charges	2,834	2,691

Council has used 2022 year valuations provided by the NSW Valuer General in calculating its rates.

Material accounting policy information

Rates and annual charges are recognised as revenue at the beginning of the rating period to which they relate. Prepaid rates are recognised as a financial liability until the beginning of the rating period.

Pensioner rebates relate to reductions in rates and certain annual charges for eligible pensioners' place of residence in the local government council area.

Pensioner rate subsidies are received from the NSW Government to provide a contribution towards the pensioner rebates and are recognised within the underlying revenue item based on their substance.

B2-2 User charges and fees

	2025 \$ '000	2024 \$ '000
Specific user charges (per s502 - specific 'actual use' charges)		
Water supply services	380	436
Waste management services (non-domestic)	91	66
Total specific user charges	471	502
Other user charges and fees		
(i) Fees and charges – statutory and regulatory functions (per s608)		
Planning and building regulation	4	1
Private works – section 67	1,532	1,036
Regulatory / statutory fees	36	8
Section 10.7 certificates (EP&A Act)	8	7
Section 603 certificates	5	4
Other	2	1
Total fees and charges – statutory/regulatory	1,587	1,057
(ii) Fees and charges – other (incl. general user charges (per s608))		
Centrelink agency fee	72	74
Cemeteries	34	30
Community centres	3	7
Leaseback fees – Council vehicles	50	52
Transport for NSW works (state roads not controlled by Council)	5,376	4,310
Sundry sales	22	27
Tourism	35	5
Water connection fees	4	5
Youth services	5	5
Total fees and charges – other	5,601	4,515
Total other user charges and fees	7,188	5,572
Total user charges and fees	7,659	6,074
Timing of revenue recognition for user charges and fees		
User charges and fees recognised over time (1)	5,919	4,812
User charges and fees recognised at a point in time (2)	1,740	1,262
Total user charges and fees	7,659	6,074

Material accounting policy information

Revenue arising from user charges and fees is recognised when or as the performance obligation is completed and the customer receives the benefit of the goods / services being provided.

The performance obligation relates to the specific services which are provided to the customers and generally the payment terms are within 30 days of the provision of the service or in some cases such as caravan parks, the customer is required to pay on arrival or a deposit in advance. There is no material obligation for Council in relation to refunds or returns.

Where an upfront fee is charged such as joining fees for the leisure centre the fee is recognised on a straight-line basis over the expected life of the membership.

Licences granted by Council are all either short-term or low value and all revenue from licences is recognised at the time that the licence is granted rather than over the term of the licence.

B2-3 Other revenues

	2025 \$ '000	2024 \$ '000
Legal fees recovery – rates and charges (extra charges)	3	–
Commissions and agency fees	57	49
Diesel rebate	35	119
Insurance claims recoveries	237	95
Rebates and Reimbursements	77	60
Other	47	16
Total other revenue	456	339
Timing of revenue recognition for other revenue		
Other revenue recognised over time (1)	57	49
Other revenue recognised at a point in time (2)	399	290
Total other revenue	456	339

Material accounting policy information for other revenue

Where the revenue is earned for the provision of specified goods / services under an enforceable contract, revenue is recognised when or as the obligations are satisfied.

Statutory fees and fines are recognised as revenue when the service has been provided, the payment is received or when the penalty has been applied, whichever occurs first.

Other revenue is recorded when the payment is due, the value of the payment is notified, or the payment is received, whichever occurs first.

B2-4 Grants and contributions

	Operating 2025 \$ '000	Operating 2024 \$ '000	Capital 2025 \$ '000	Capital 2024 \$ '000
Notes				
General purpose grants and non-developer contributions (untied)				
General purpose (untied)				
Current year allocation				
Financial assistance – general component	763	448	–	–
Financial assistance – local roads component	265	65	–	–
Payment in advance - future year allocation				
Financial assistance – general component	2,612	4,221	–	–
Financial assistance – local roads component	897	1,456	–	–
Amount recognised as income during current year	4,537	6,190	–	–
Special purpose grants and non-developer contributions (tied)				
Cash contributions				
Community care	189	218	–	–
Domestic waste – rubbish tip	–	–	60	–
Heritage and cultural	60	–	–	–
Library	50	52	23	20
Noxious weeds	9	71	–	–
NSW rural fire services	17	7	–	–
Recreation and culture	–	86	1,096	2,334
Sewerage	–	–	137	–
Storm/flood damage	2,542	1,612	670	–
Transport (other roads and bridges funding)	107	–	1,664	3,538
Transport (roads to recovery)	1,774	1,556	–	–
Transport for NSW contributions (regional roads, block grant)	1,326	5,440	–	–
– Other	25	13	–	–
Total special purpose grants and non-developer contributions – cash	6,099	9,055	3,650	5,892
Non-cash contributions				
Bushfire services	–	–	–	104
Total other contributions – non-cash	–	–	–	104
Total special purpose grants and non-developer contributions (tied)	6,099	9,055	3,650	5,996
Total grants and non-developer contributions	10,636	15,245	3,650	5,996
Comprising:				
– Commonwealth funding	6,371	7,761	1,303	2,106
– State funding	4,265	7,484	2,347	3,890
	10,636	15,245	3,650	5,996

B2-4 Grants and contributions (continued)

Unspent grants and contributions

Certain grants and contributions are obtained by Council on the condition they be spent in a specified manner or in a future period but which are not yet spent in accordance with those conditions are as follows:

	Operating 2025 \$ '000	Operating 2024 \$ '000	Capital 2025 \$ '000	Capital 2024 \$ '000
Unspent grants and contributions				
Unspent funds at 1 July	6,315	4,131	5,797	3,274
Add: Funds recognised as revenue in the reporting year but not yet spent in accordance with the conditions	2,081	6,315	10	–
Add: Funds received and not recognised as revenue in the current year	–	–	4,527	5,797
Less: Funds recognised as revenue in previous years that have been spent during the reporting year	(6,315)	(4,083)	–	–
Less: Funds received in prior year but revenue recognised and funds spent in current year	–	(48)	(2,205)	(3,274)
Unspent funds at 30 June	2,081	6,315	8,129	5,797

Material accounting policy information

Grants and contributions – enforceable agreement with sufficiently specific performance obligations

Grant and contribution revenue from an agreement which is enforceable and contains sufficiently specific performance obligations is recognised as or when control of each performance obligations is transferred.

The performance obligations vary according to the agreement. Payment terms vary depending on the terms of the grant, cash is received upfront for some grants and on the achievement of certain payment milestones for others.

Performance obligations may be satisfied either at a point in time or over time and this is reflected in the revenue recognition pattern. Point in time recognition occurs when the beneficiary obtains control of the goods / services at a single time (e.g. completion of the project when a report / outcome is provided), whereas over time recognition is where the control of the services is ongoing throughout the project (e.g. provision of community health services through the year).

Where control is transferred over time, generally the input methods being either costs or time incurred are deemed to be the most appropriate methods to reflect the transfer of benefit.

Capital grants

Capital grants received by Council under an enforceable contract for the acquisition or construction of infrastructure, property, plant and equipment to identified specifications which will be under Council's control on completion are recognised as revenue as and when the obligation to construct or purchase is completed.

For construction projects, this is generally as the construction progresses in accordance with costs incurred since this is deemed to be the most appropriate measure of the completeness of the construction project.

For acquisitions of assets, the revenue is recognised when the asset is acquired and controlled by the Council.

Other grants and contributions

Assets, including cash, received from other grants and contributions are recognised at fair value when the asset is received. Council considers whether there are any related liability or equity items associated with the asset which are recognised in accordance with the relevant accounting standard.

Once the assets and liabilities have been recognised then income is recognised for any remaining asset value at the time that the asset is received.

B2-5 Interest and investment income

B2-5 Interest and investment income (continued)

	2025	2024
	\$ '000	\$ '000
Interest on financial assets measured at amortised cost		
– Overdue rates and annual charges (incl. special purpose rates)	84	63
– Cash and investments	1,047	957
Total interest and investment income	1,131	1,020

B2-6 Other income

		2025	2024
	Notes	\$ '000	\$ '000
Rental income			
Hire of Council owned property		153	138
Total rental income	C2-2	153	138
Total other income		153	138

B3 Costs of providing services

B3-1 Employee benefits and on-costs

	2025 \$ '000	2024 \$ '000
Salaries and wages	5,189	5,183
Employee leave entitlements (ELE)	646	936
Superannuation	604	565
Workers' compensation insurance	371	337
Fringe benefit tax (FBT)	60	72
Total employee costs	6,870	7,093
Less: capitalised costs	(389)	(468)
Total employee costs expensed	6,481	6,625

Material accounting policy information

Retirement benefit obligations

All employees of the Council are entitled to benefits on retirement, disability or death. Council contributes to various defined benefit plans and defined contribution plans on behalf of its employees.

Superannuation plans

Contributions to defined contribution plans are recognised as an expense as they become payable. Prepaid contributions are recognised as an asset to the extent that a cash refund or a reduction in the future payments is available.

Council participates in a defined benefit plan under the Local Government Superannuation Scheme, however, sufficient information to account for the plan as a defined benefit is not available and therefore Council accounts for its obligations to defined benefit plans on the same basis as its obligations to defined contribution plans, i.e. as an expense when it becomes payable – refer to Note E3-1 for more information.

B3-2 Materials and services

		2025	2024
	Notes	\$ '000	\$ '000
Raw materials and consumables		8,388	9,122
Contractor costs		1,241	595
Audit Fees	F2-1	84	86
Councillor and Mayoral fees and associated expenses	F1-2	151	173
Advertising		98	88
Bank charges		4	5
Cleaning		229	261
Computer software charges		210	153
Election expenses		46	—
Electricity and heating		274	295
Insurance		681	589
Postage		6	6
Printing and stationery		41	24
Street lighting		34	49
Subscriptions and publications		114	87
Telephone and communications		83	78
Valuation fees		11	10
Yetta Farm operations		49	87
Travel expenses		137	188
Registration costs		68	69
Training costs (other than salaries and wages)		239	245
Other expenses		573	515
Aboriginal Communities Program Costs		337	510
Legal expenses:			
– Legal expenses: debt recovery		48	19
– Legal expenses: other		18	—
Total materials and services		13,164	13,254

B3-3 Borrowing costs

Interest bearing liability costs

Interest on loans	—	10
Total interest bearing liability costs	—	10
Total borrowing costs expensed	—	10

B3-4 Depreciation, amortisation and impairment of non-financial assets

	Notes	2025 \$ '000	2024 \$ '000
Depreciation and amortisation			
Plant and equipment		1,080	1,436
Office equipment		46	34
Furniture and fittings		4	5
Infrastructure:	C1-7		
– Buildings – non-specialised		72	67
– Buildings – specialised		576	539
– Other structures		372	351
– Roads		2,375	2,310
– Bridges		254	241
– Footpaths		58	50
– Stormwater drainage		27	26
– Water supply network		534	508
– Sewerage network		224	206
– Swimming pools		75	72
– Bulk earthworks – levee bank		50	47
– Airport		66	64
– Other open space/recreational assets		30	29
Less: capitalised costs		(154)	(75)
Total depreciation and amortisation costs		5,689	5,910
Impairment / revaluation decrement of non-financial assets			
Infrastructure:	C1-7		
– Roads		–	1,425
Amounts taken through revaluation reserve	C1-7	–	(1,425)
Total IPPE impairment / revaluation decrement costs charged to Income Statement		–	–
Total depreciation, amortisation and impairment for non-financial assets		5,689	5,910

Material accounting policy information

Depreciation and amortisation

Depreciation and amortisation are calculated using the straight line method to allocate their cost, net of their residual values, over their estimated useful lives. Useful lives are included in Note C1-7 for IPPE assets.

Depreciation is capitalised where in-house assets have contributed to new assets.

B3-5 Other expenses

	Notes	2025 \$ '000	2024 \$ '000
Impairment of receivables			
Grants and contributions		2,757	–
Other		188	175
Total impairment of receivables	C1-4	2,945	175
Other			
Contributions/levies to other levels of government			
– NSW fire brigade levy		27	24
– NSW rural fire service levy		294	199
Donations, contributions and assistance to other organisations (Section 356)		1	4
– Moree regional library		55	54
Total other		377	281
Total other expenses		3,322	456

B4 Gains or losses

B4-1 Gain or loss from the disposal, replacement and de-recognition of assets

	Notes	2025 \$ '000	2024 \$ '000
Gain (or loss) on disposal of plant and equipment			
Proceeds from disposal – plant and equipment	C1-7	82	14
Less: carrying amount of plant and equipment assets sold/written off		(357)	(129)
Gain (or loss) on disposal		(275)	(115)
Gain (or loss) on disposal of infrastructure			
Proceeds from disposal of infrastructures	C1-7	–	12
Less: carrying amount of infrastructure assets sold/written off		(723)	(7)
Gain (or loss) on disposal		(723)	5
Net gain (or loss) from disposal of assets		(998)	(110)

B5 Performance against budget

B5-1 Material budget variations

Council's original budget was adopted by the Council on 28 May 2024 and is not required to be audited. The original projections on which the budget was based have been affected by a number of factors. These include state and federal government decisions, including new grant programs, changing economic activity, environmental factors, and by decisions made by Council.

While these General Purpose Financial Statements include the original budget adopted by Council, the Act requires Council to review its financial budget on a quarterly basis, so it is able to manage the variation between actuals and budget that invariably occur during the year.

Material variations of more than 10% between original budget and actual results or where the variance is considered material by nature are explained below.

Variation Key: **F** = Favourable budget variation, **U** = Unfavourable budget variation.

\$ '000	2025 Budget	2025 Actual	2025 ----- Variance -----	
Revenues				
Rates and annual charges	2,793	2,834	41	1% F
User charges and fees	3,720	7,659	3,939	106% F
More than expected works on repair and maintenance works on state roads.				
Other revenues	170	456	286	168% F
Due to insurance claims received for stolen and broken vehicles.				
Operating grants and contributions	9,902	10,636	734	7% F
Increase in operating grants income is driven by extra works funded by Roads to recovery and AGRN funding.				
Capital grants and contributions	13,424	3,650	(9,774)	(73)% U
Council could not allocate enough resources on utilisation of capital grants received in previous year due to focusing on emergency works and works on state roads in the current financial year.				
Interest and investment revenue	737	1,131	394	53% F
Due to larger amount of investments following receipt of capital grants in this year which are restricted.				
Other income	185	153	(32)	(17)% U
Not material and hard to budget.				
Expenses				
Employee benefits and on-costs	4,885	6,481	(1,596)	(33)% U
Actual capitalisation of employee costs was less than budgeted.				
Materials and services	8,945	13,164	(4,219)	(47)% U
More than expected works on repair and maintenance works on state roads.				
Depreciation, amortisation and impairment of non-financial assets	5,951	5,689	262	4% F
Other expenses	305	3,322	(3,017)	(989)% U
Due to impairment of receivables and grant related accrued income which is hard to budget, see Note B3-5.				

B5-1 Material budget variations (continued)

\$ '000	2025 Budget	2025 Actual	2025 ----- Variance -----	
Statement of cash flows				
Cash flows from operating activities	16,795	3,121	(13,674)	(81)% U
Due to less operating grants income.				
Cash flows from investing activities	(16,314)	(25,243)	(8,929)	55% U
Due to larger amount of investments following receipt of capital grants which have not been spent yet.				
Cash flows from financing activities	–	–	–	∞ F

C Financial position

C1 Assets we manage

C1-1 Cash and cash equivalents

	2025 \$ '000	2024 \$ '000
Cash assets		
Cash on hand and at bank	32	5,719
Cash equivalent assets		
– Deposits at call	1,665	7,100
– Short-term deposits	–	11,000
Total cash and cash equivalents	1,697	23,819

Reconciliation of cash and cash equivalents

Total cash and cash equivalents per Statement of Financial Position	1,697	23,819
Balance as per the Statement of Cash Flows	1,697	23,819

C1-2 Financial investments

	2025 Current \$ '000	2025 Non-current \$ '000	2024 Current \$ '000	2024 Non-current \$ '000
Debt securities at amortised cost				
Short-term deposits	19,500	–	3,000	–
Total	19,500	–	3,000	–
Total financial investments	19,500	–	3,000	–
Total cash assets, cash equivalents and investments	21,197	–	26,819	–

C1-3 Restricted and allocated cash, cash equivalents and investments

	2025 \$ '000	2024 \$ '000
(a) Externally restricted cash, cash equivalents and investments		
Total cash, cash equivalents and investments	21,197	26,819
Less: Externally restricted cash, cash equivalents and investments	(12,431)	(15,188)
Cash, cash equivalents and investments not subject to external restrictions	8,766	11,631
External restrictions		
External restrictions – included in liabilities		
External restrictions included in cash, cash equivalents and investments above comprise:		
Specific purpose unexpended grants – general fund	7,551	5,743
Specific purpose unexpended grants – sewer fund	–	45
External restrictions – included in liabilities	7,551	5,788
External restrictions – other		
External restrictions included in cash, cash equivalents and investments above comprise:		
Specific purpose unexpended grants – (GF)	2,659	6,324
Water supplies – (bank)	1,067	1,848
Sewerage services – (bank)	1,154	1,228
External restrictions – other	4,880	9,400
Total external restrictions	12,431	15,188

Cash, cash equivalents and investments subject to external restrictions are those which are only available for specific use by Council due to a restriction placed by legislation or third-party contractual agreement.

C1-3 Restricted and allocated cash, cash equivalents and investments (continued)

	2025	2024
	\$ '000	\$ '000

(b) Internal allocations**Cash, cash equivalents and investments not subject to external restrictions**

8,766	11,631
--------------	---------------

Less: Internally restricted cash, cash equivalents and investments

(8,704)	(11,136)
----------------	-----------------

Unrestricted and unallocated cash, cash equivalents and investments

62	495
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Internal allocations

At 30 June, Council has internally allocated funds to the following:

Infrastructure replacement	1,500	2,000
Employees leave entitlement	1,325	1,459
Plant and vehicle replacement	1,500	1,000
Carry over works	400	1,000
Prepaid financial assistance grant – general	2,612	4,221
Prepaid financial assistance grant – roads	897	1,456
Other	470	–
Total internal allocations	8,704	11,136

Cash, cash equivalents and investments not subject to external restrictions may be internally allocated by resolution or policy of the elected Council.

	2025	2024
	\$ '000	\$ '000

(c) Unrestricted and unallocated**Unrestricted and unallocated cash, cash equivalents and investments**

62	495
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C1-4 Receivables

	2025 Current \$ '000	2025 Non-current \$ '000	2024 Current \$ '000	2024 Non-current \$ '000
Rates and annual charges	635	–	650	–
Interest and extra charges	163	–	174	–
User charges and fees	845	–	1,286	–
Accrued revenues				
– Interest on investments	180	–	158	–
Government grants and subsidies	5,783	–	9,300	–
Net GST receivable	165	–	–	–
Other debtors	32	–	3	–
Total	7,803	–	11,571	–
Less: provision for impairment				
Rates and annual charges	(559)	–	(524)	–
Interest and extra charges	(141)	–	(150)	–
User charges and fees	(171)	–	(197)	–
Total provision for impairment – receivables	(871)	–	(871)	–
Total net receivables	6,932	–	10,700	–

	2025 \$ '000	2024 \$ '000
Movement in provision for impairment of receivables		
Balance at the beginning of the year	871	695
+ new provisions recognised during the year	–	176
Balance at the end of the year	871	871

C1-4 Receivables (continued)

Material accounting policy information

Receivables are recognised initially at fair value and subsequently measured at amortised cost using the effective interest method, less provision for impairment. Receivables are generally due for settlement within 30 days.

Impairment

Impairment of financial assets measured at amortised cost is recognised on an expected credit loss (ECL) basis.

When determining whether the credit risk of a financial asset has increased significantly since initial recognition, and when estimating ECL, the Council considers reasonable and supportable information that is relevant and available without undue cost or effort. This includes both quantitative and qualitative information and analysis based on Council's historical experience and informed credit assessment, and including forward-looking information.

When considering the ECL for rates debtors, Council takes into account that unpaid rates represent a charge against the rateable property that will be recovered when the property is next sold. For non-rates debtors, Council uses the presumption that an asset which is more than 30 days past due has seen a significant increase in credit risk.

The Council uses the presentation that a financial asset is in default when:

- the other party is unlikely to pay its credit obligations to the Council in full, without recourse by the Council to actions such as realising security (if any is held) or
- the financial assets (for non-rates debtors) are more than 90 days past due.

Credit losses are measured as the present value of the difference between the cash flows due to the entity in accordance with the contract, and the cash flows expected to be received. This is applied using a probability weighted approach.

On initial recognition of the asset, an estimate of the expected credit losses for the next 12 months is recognised. Where the asset has experienced significant increase in credit risk then the lifetime losses are estimated and recognised.

Council uses the simplified approach for trade receivables where the expected lifetime credit losses are recognised on day 1.

There has been no change in the estimation techniques or significant assumptions made during the current reporting period.

The Council writes off a trade receivable when there is information indicating that the debtor is in severe financial difficulty and there is no realistic prospect of recovery, e.g. when the debtor has been placed under liquidation or has entered into bankruptcy proceedings, or when the receivables are over 5 years past due, whichever occurs first.

None of the receivables that have been written off are subject to enforcement activity.

Where the Council renegotiates the terms of receivables due from certain customers, the new expected cash flows are discounted at the original effective interest rate and any resulting difference to the carrying value is recognised in profit or loss.

Rates and annual charges outstanding are secured against the property.

C1-5 Inventories

	2025 Current \$ '000	2025 Non-current \$ '000	2024 Current \$ '000	2024 Non-current \$ '000
(i) Inventories at cost				
Stores and materials	200	–	284	–
Total inventories at cost	200	–	284	–
Total inventories	200	–	284	–

C1-6 Contract assets

	2025 Current \$ '000	2025 Non-current \$ '000	2024 Current \$ '000	2024 Non-current \$ '000
Contract assets	5,034	–	956	–
Total contract assets	5,034	–	956	–

C1-7 Infrastructure, property, plant and equipment

By aggregated asset class	At 1 July 2024			Asset movements during the reporting period								At 30 June 2025		
	Gross carrying amount	Accumulated depreciation and impairment	Net carrying amount	Additions renewals	Additions new assets	Carrying value of disposals	Depreciation expense	WIP transfers	Adjustments and transfers	Revaluation decrements to equity (ARR)	Revaluation increments to equity (ARR)	Gross carrying amount	Accumulated depreciation and impairment	Net carrying amount
	\$ '000	\$ '000	\$ '000	\$ '000	\$ '000	\$ '000	\$ '000	\$ '000	\$ '000	\$ '000	\$ '000	\$ '000	\$ '000	\$ '000
Capital work in progress	6,215	–	6,215	844	2,244	–	–	(5,874)	(68)	–	–	3,363	–	3,363
Plant and equipment	13,344	(9,271)	4,073	–	515	(357)	(1,080)	–	–	–	–	13,423	(10,267)	3,156
Office equipment	503	(364)	139	–	15	–	(46)	–	–	–	–	519	(410)	109
Furniture and fittings	176	(166)	10	–	–	–	(4)	–	–	–	–	176	(170)	6
Land:														
– Operational land	2,097	–	2,097	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	215	2,302	–	2,302
– Community land	397	–	397	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	37	434	–	434
Infrastructure:														
– Buildings – non-specialised	3,686	(1,581)	2,105	–	–	–	(72)	–	–	–	90	3,845	(1,726)	2,119
– Buildings – specialised	38,514	(11,685)	26,829	67	–	(40)	(576)	–	–	–	1,165	40,233	(12,788)	27,445
– Other structures	8,258	(3,111)	5,147	27	317	(26)	(372)	892	–	–	80	9,603	(3,541)	6,062
– Roads	181,713	(30,645)	151,068	799	3,198	(482)	(2,375)	3,425	–	(12,122)	–	189,230	(45,719)	143,511
– Bridges	25,380	(6,549)	18,831	–	–	–	(254)	–	–	(2,227)	–	25,105	(8,754)	16,351
– Footpaths	3,949	(940)	3,009	–	4	–	(58)	155	–	(101)	–	4,232	(1,223)	3,009
– Bulk earthworks – levee bank	6,837	(2,960)	3,877	–	–	–	(50)	–	–	–	1,071	7,299	(2,400)	4,899
– Stormwater drainage	1,943	(1,235)	708	–	–	–	(27)	–	–	–	33	2,037	(1,323)	714
– Water supply network	25,902	(11,655)	14,247	–	1,119	–	(534)	474	–	–	343	28,146	(12,495)	15,651
– Sewerage network	15,381	(6,842)	8,539	335	2	(175)	(224)	107	–	–	208	15,880	(7,088)	8,792
– Swimming pools	3,196	(1,464)	1,732	–	–	–	(75)	–	–	–	28	3,250	(1,565)	1,685
– Other open space/recreational assets	1,393	(219)	1,174	–	144	–	(30)	821	–	–	19	2,383	(254)	2,129
– Airport	4,774	(2,143)	2,631	–	–	–	(66)	–	–	–	667	4,884	(1,651)	3,233
Total infrastructure, property, plant and equipment	343,658	(90,830)	252,828	2,072	7,558	(1,080)	(5,843)	–	(68)	(14,450)	3,956	356,344	(111,374)	244,970

C1-7 Infrastructure, property, plant and equipment (continued)

By aggregated asset class	At 1 July 2023			Asset movements during the reporting period									At 30 June 2024		
	Gross carrying amount	Accumulated depreciation and impairment	Net carrying amount	Additions renewals	Additions new assets	Carrying value of disposals	Depreciation expense	Impairment loss / revaluation decrements (recognised in equity)	WIP transfers	Adjustments and transfers	Contributed (from Note B2-4)	Revaluation increments to equity (ARR)	Gross carrying amount	Accumulated depreciation and impairment	Net carrying amount
	\$ '000	\$ '000	\$ '000	\$ '000	\$ '000	\$ '000	\$ '000	\$ '000	\$ '000	\$ '000	\$ '000	\$ '000	\$ '000	\$ '000	\$ '000
Capital work in progress	1,334	–	1,334	188	5,406	–	–	–	(713)	–	–	–	6,215	–	6,215
Plant and equipment	12,622	(7,630)	4,992	–	542	(129)	(1,436)	–	–	–	104	–	13,344	(9,271)	4,073
Office equipment	466	(330)	136	–	37	–	(34)	–	–	–	–	–	503	(364)	139
Furniture and fittings	176	(161)	15	–	–	–	(5)	–	–	–	–	–	176	(166)	10
Land:															
– Operational land	1,869	–	1,869	–	62	(7)	–	–	–	–	–	173	2,097	–	2,097
– Community land	362	–	362	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	35	397	–	397
Infrastructure:															
– Buildings – non-specialised	3,446	(1,411)	2,035	–	–	–	(67)	–	–	–	–	137	3,686	(1,581)	2,105
– Buildings – specialised	36,008	(10,388)	25,620	6	–	–	(539)	–	–	–	–	1,742	38,514	(11,685)	26,829
– Other structures	7,898	(2,662)	5,236	86	–	–	(351)	–	17	–	–	159	8,258	(3,111)	5,147
– Roads	172,298	(25,427)	146,871	2	184	–	(2,310)	(1,425)	19	(30)	–	7,757	181,713	(30,645)	151,068
– Bridges	24,088	(5,975)	18,113	–	–	–	(241)	–	–	–	–	959	25,380	(6,549)	18,831
– Footpaths	3,363	(842)	2,521	–	405	–	(50)	–	–	–	–	133	3,949	(940)	3,009
– Stormwater drainage	1,850	(1,150)	700	–	–	–	(26)	–	–	–	–	34	1,943	(1,235)	708
– Water supply network	24,558	(10,588)	13,970	68	–	–	(508)	–	34	–	–	683	25,902	(11,655)	14,247
– Sewerage network	14,027	(6,306)	7,721	–	–	–	(206)	–	643	–	–	381	15,381	(6,842)	8,539
– Bulk earthworks – levee bank	6,489	(2,762)	3,727	–	–	–	(47)	–	–	–	–	197	6,837	(2,960)	3,877
– Swimming pools	3,061	(1,346)	1,715	35	–	–	(72)	–	–	–	–	54	3,196	(1,464)	1,732
– Other open space/recreational assets	1,347	(183)	1,164	2	–	–	(29)	–	–	–	–	37	1,393	(219)	1,174
– Airport	4,623	(2,011)	2,612	–	–	–	(64)	–	–	–	–	83	4,774	(2,143)	2,631
Total infrastructure, property, plant and equipment	319,885	(79,172)	240,713	387	6,636	(136)	(5,985)	(1,425)	–	(30)	104	12,564	343,658	(90,830)	252,828

C1-7 Infrastructure, property, plant and equipment (continued)

Material accounting policy information

Infrastructure, property, plant and equipment are held at fair value. Independent comprehensive valuations are performed at least every five years, however the carrying amount of assets is assessed by Council at each reporting date to confirm that it is not materially different from current fair value.

Water and sewerage network assets are indexed at each reporting period in accordance with the Rates Reference Manual issued by Department of Climate Change, Energy, the Environment and Water (DCCEEW).

Depreciation

Land is not depreciated. Depreciation on other assets is calculated using the straight-line method to allocate their cost, net of their residual values, over their estimated useful lives as follows:

Plant and equipment	Years	Other equipment	Years
Office equipment	5 to 10	Playground equipment	5 to 15
Office furniture	10 to 20	Benches, seats etc.	10 to 20
Computer equipment	4		
Vehicles	5 to 8	Buildings	
Heavy plant/road making equipment	5 to 8	Buildings: masonry	50 to 100
Other plant and equipment	5 to 15	Buildings: other	20 to 40
Water and sewer assets		Stormwater assets	
Dams and reservoirs	80 to 100	Drains	80 to 100
Bores	20 to 40	Culverts	50 to 80
Reticulation pipes: PVC	70 to 80	Flood control structures	80 to 100
Reticulation pipes: other	25 to 75		
Pumps and telemetry	15 to 20		
Transportation assets		Other infrastructure assets	
Sealed roads: surface	20	Bulk earthworks	100
Sealed roads: structure	50	Swimming pools	5 to 60
Unsealed roads	20	Unsealed roads	20
Bridge: concrete	100	Other open space/recreational assets	20
Bridge: other	50	Other infrastructure	20
Road pavements	60		
Kerb, gutter and footpaths	40		

The assets' residual values and useful lives are reviewed, and adjusted if appropriate, at each reporting date.

Land under roads

Land under roads is land under roadways and road reserves including land under footpaths, nature strips and median strips.

Council has elected not to recognise land under roads acquired before 1 July 2008. Land under roads acquired after 1 July 2008 is recognised in accordance with the IPPE accounting policy.

Crown reserves

Crown reserves under Council's care and control are recognised as assets of the Council. While ownership of the reserves remains with the Crown, Council retains operational control of the reserves and is responsible for their maintenance and use in accordance with the specific purposes to which the reserves are dedicated.

Improvements on Crown reserves are also recorded as assets, while maintenance costs incurred by Council and revenues relating to the reserves are recognised within Council's Income Statement.

C2 Leasing activities

C2-1 Council as a lessee

Council has leases over some assets including land and buildings. However, those leases are at below market value.

Leases at significantly below market value – concessionary / peppercorn leases

Council has a number of leases at significantly below market for land and buildings which are used for:

- workshop; and
- truckyard.

The leases are generally for 20 years and require payments of a maximum amount of \$3,000 per year. The use of the right-of-use asset is restricted by the lessors to specified community services which Council must provide, these services are detailed in the leases.

Council does not believe that any of the leases in place are individually material from a statement of financial position or performance perspective.

Material accounting policy information

Council has elected not to separate non-lease components from lease components for any class of asset and has accounted for payments as a single component.

The right-of-use asset is measured using the cost model where cost on initial recognition comprises: the lease liability, initial direct costs, prepaid lease payments, estimated cost of removal and restoration, less any lease incentives received. The right-of-use asset is depreciated over the lease term on a straight-line basis and assessed for impairment in accordance with the impairment of asset accounting policy.

The lease liability is initially recognised at the present value of the remaining lease payments at the commencement of the lease. The discount rate is the rate implicit in the lease, however where this cannot be readily determined then the Council's incremental borrowing rate for a similar term with similar security is used.

Exceptions to lease accounting

Council has applied the exceptions to lease accounting for both short-term leases (i.e. leases with a term of less than or equal to 12 months) and leases of low-value assets. Council recognises the payments associated with these leases as an expense on a straight-line basis over the lease term.

Leases at significantly below market value / Concessionary leases

Council has elected to measure the right of use asset arising from the concessionary leases at cost which is based on the associated lease liability at initial recognition.

C2-2 Council as a lessor

Operating leases

Council leases out a number of properties to community groups. This property is held to meet community service delivery objectives rather than to earn rental or for capital appreciation. These leases have been classified as operating leases for financial reporting purposes and the assets are included as IPP&E in the Statement of Financial Position.

The amounts recognised in the Income Statement relating to operating leases where Council is a lessor are shown below:

	2025 \$ '000	2024 \$ '000
(i) Assets held as property, plant and equipment		
Lease income (excluding variable lease payments not dependent on an index or rate)	153	138
Total income relating to operating leases for Council assets	153	138

C3 Liabilities of Council

C3-1 Payables

	2025 Current \$ '000	2025 Non-current \$ '000	2024 Current \$ '000	2024 Non-current \$ '000
Goods and services – operating expenditure	655	–	3,066	–
Goods and services – capital expenditure	1,313	–	733	–
PAYG Tax Instalments	–	–	95	–
Accrued expenses:				
– Salaries and wages	257	–	8	–
Advances	–	51	–	51
Security bonds, deposits and retentions	49	–	45	–
ATO – net GST payable	–	–	130	–
Other	42	–	36	–
Total payables	2,316	51	4,113	51

Payables

Payables represent liabilities for goods and services provided to Council prior to the end of financial year that are unpaid. The amounts are unsecured and are usually paid within 30 days of recognition.

C3-2 Contract Liabilities

		2025 Current \$ '000	2025 Non-current \$ '000	2024 Current \$ '000	2024 Non-current \$ '000
	Notes				
Grants and contributions received in advance:					
Unexpended capital grants (to construct Council controlled assets)	(i)	7,730	–	5,400	–
Total grants received in advance		7,730	–	5,400	–
Total contract liabilities		7,730	–	5,400	–

Notes

(i) The funds received are under an enforceable contract which require Council to construct an identified asset which will be under Council's control on completion. The revenue is recognised as Council constructs the asset and the contract liability reflects the funding received which cannot yet be recognised as revenue. The revenue is expected to be recognised in the next 12 months.

Revenue recognised that was included in the contract liability balance at the beginning of the period

	2025 \$ '000	2024 \$ '000
Grants and contributions received in advance:		
Capital grants (to construct Council controlled assets)	2,206	3,322
Total revenue recognised that was included in the contract liability balance at the beginning of the period	2,206	3,322

Significant changes in contract liabilities

Increase in contract liabilities was mostly due to receipt of \$3M funds for construction of PCYC Youth Hub in 2025 financial year. Council carried forward the project into the following year for commencement.

C3-3 Borrowings

(a) Changes in liabilities arising from financing activities

	2024		Non-cash movements				2025
	Opening Balance \$ '000	Cash flows \$ '000	Acquisition \$ '000	Fair value changes \$ '000	Acquisition due to change in accounting policy \$ '000	Other non-cash movement \$ '000	Closing balance \$ '000
Loans – secured	–	–	–	–	–	–	–
Total liabilities from financing activities	–	–	–	–	–	–	–

	2023		Non-cash movements				2024
	Opening Balance \$ '000	Cash flows \$ '000	Acquisition \$ '000	Fair value changes \$ '000	Acquisition due to change in accounting policy \$ '000	Other non-cash movement \$ '000	Closing balance \$ '000
Loans – secured	363	(363)	–	–	–	–	–
Total liabilities from financing activities	363	(363)	–	–	–	–	–

(b) Financing arrangements

	2025 \$ '000	2024 \$ '000
Total facilities		
Total financing facilities available to Council at the reporting date are:		
Credit cards/purchase cards	40	40
Total financing arrangements	40	40
Drawn facilities		
Financing facilities drawn down at the reporting date are:		
Undrawn facilities		
Undrawn financing facilities available to Council at the reporting date are:		
– Credit cards/purchase cards	38	39
Total undrawn financing arrangements	38	39

Breaches and defaults

During the current and prior year, there were no defaults or breaches on any of the loans.

C3-4 Employee benefit provisions

	2025 Current \$ '000	2025 Non-current \$ '000	2024 Current \$ '000	2024 Non-current \$ '000
Annual leave	458	–	486	–
Long service leave	703	75	804	89
Other leave – RDO	89	–	79	–
Total employee benefit provisions	1,250	75	1,369	89

Current employee benefit provisions not anticipated to be settled within the next twelve months

	2025 \$ '000	2024 \$ '000
--	-----------------	-----------------

The following provisions, even though classified as current, are not expected to be settled in the next 12 months.

Provisions – employees benefits	589	665
	589	665

Material accounting policy information

Long-term employee benefit obligations

The liability for long-service leave and annual leave that is not expected to be wholly settled within 12 months after the end of the period in which the employees render the related service is recognised in the provision for employee benefits and measured as the present value of expected future payments to be made in respect of services provided by employees up to the end of the reporting period using the projected unit credit method. Consideration is given to expected future wage and salary levels, experience of employee departures, and periods of service. Expected future payments are discounted using market yields at the end of the reporting period on national government bonds with terms to maturity and currency that match, as closely as possible, the estimated future cash outflows.

C4 Reserves

C4-1 Nature and purpose of reserves

IPPE Revaluation Surplus

The infrastructure, property, plant and equipment (IPPE) revaluation surplus is used to record increments and decrements in the revaluation of infrastructure, property, plant and equipment.

D Council structure

D1 Results by fund

General fund refers to all Council activities other than water and sewer. All amounts disclosed in this note are gross i.e. inclusive of internal charges and recoveries made between the funds. Assets and liabilities shown in the water and sewer columns are restricted for use for these activities.

D1-1 Income Statement by fund

	General 2025 \$ '000	Water 2025 \$ '000	Sewer 2025 \$ '000
Income from continuing operations			
Rates and annual charges	1,468	835	531
User charges and fees	7,279	380	–
Interest and investment revenue	891	149	91
Other revenues	456	–	–
Grants and contributions provided for operating purposes	10,636	–	–
Grants and contributions provided for capital purposes	3,513	–	137
Other income	153	–	–
Total income from continuing operations	24,396	1,364	759
Expenses from continuing operations			
Employee benefits and on-costs	6,089	260	132
Materials and services	12,676	339	149
Other expenses	2,697	440	185
Net losses from the disposal of assets	823	–	175
Total expenses from continuing operations excluding depreciation, amortisation and impairment of non-financial assets	22,285	1,039	641
Operating result from continuing operations excluding depreciation, amortisation and impairment of non-financial assets	2,111	325	118
Depreciation, amortisation and impairment of non-financial assets	4,925	539	225
Operating result from continuing operations	(2,814)	(214)	(107)
Net operating result for the year	(2,814)	(214)	(107)
Net operating result attributable to each council fund	(2,814)	(214)	(107)
Net operating result for the year before grants and contributions provided for capital purposes	(6,327)	(214)	(244)

D1-2 Statement of Financial Position by fund

	General 2025 \$ '000	Water 2025 \$ '000	Sewer 2025 \$ '000
ASSETS			
Current assets			
Cash and cash equivalents	(524)	1,067	1,154
Investments	19,500	—	—
Receivables	6,607	241	84
Inventories	200	—	—
Contract assets and contract cost assets	5,034	—	—
Other	70	—	—
Total current assets	30,887	1,308	1,238
Non-current assets			
Infrastructure, property, plant and equipment	220,115	15,996	8,859
Total non-current assets	220,115	15,996	8,859
Total assets	251,002	17,304	10,097
LIABILITIES			
Current liabilities			
Payables	2,310	6	—
Contract liabilities	7,730	—	—
Employee benefit provision	1,250	—	—
Total current liabilities	11,290	6	—
Non-current liabilities			
Payables	51	—	—
Employee benefit provision	75	—	—
Total non-current liabilities	126	—	—
Total liabilities	11,416	6	—
Net assets	239,586	17,298	10,097
EQUITY			
Accumulated surplus	172,529	2,127	547
IPPE revaluation surplus	67,057	15,171	9,550
Council equity interest	239,586	17,298	10,097
Total equity	239,586	17,298	10,097

E Risks and accounting uncertainties

E1-1 Risks relating to financial instruments held

Council's overall risk management program focuses on the unpredictability of financial markets and seeks to minimise potential adverse effects on the financial performance of Council.

Council's objective is to maximise its return on cash and investments while maintaining an adequate level of liquidity and preserving capital. The finance team manage the cash and investments portfolio with the assistance of independent advisers. Council has an investment policy which complies with s 625 of the Act and the Ministerial Investment Order. The policy is regularly reviewed by Council and a monthly investment report is provided to Council setting out the make-up and performance of the portfolio as required by local government regulations.

Council does not engage in transactions expressed in foreign currencies and is therefore not subject to foreign currency risk.

Financial risk management is carried out by the finance team under policies approved by the Councillors.

The fair value of receivables, loans, investments and financial liabilities approximates the carrying amount. The risks associated with the financial instruments held are:

- interest rate risk – the risk that movements in interest rates could affect returns
- liquidity risk – the risk that Council will not be able to pay its debts as and when they fall due
- credit risk – the risk that a contracting entity will not complete its obligations under a financial instrument resulting in a financial loss to the Council.

Council manages these risks by diversifying its portfolio and only purchasing investments with high credit ratings or capital guarantees.

(a) Market risk – interest rate and price risk

	2025 \$ '000	2024 \$ '000
The impact on the result for the year and equity of a reasonably possible movement in the price of investments held and interest rates is shown below. The reasonably possible movements were determined based on historical movements and economic conditions in place at the reporting date.		
Impact of a 1% movement in interest rates		
– Equity / Income Statement	212	268

E1-1 Risks relating to financial instruments held (continued)

(b) Credit risk

Council's major receivables comprise (i) rates and annual charges and (ii) user charges and fees.

Council manages the credit risk associated with these receivables by monitoring outstanding debt and employing stringent debt recovery procedures. Council also encourages ratepayers to pay their rates by the due date through incentives.

The credit risk for liquid funds and other short-term financial assets is considered negligible, since the counterparties are reputable banks with high quality external credit ratings.

There are no significant concentrations of credit risk, whether through exposure to individual customers, specific industry sectors and/or regions.

The level of outstanding receivables is reported to Council monthly and benchmarks are set and monitored for acceptable collection performance.

Council makes suitable provision for doubtful receivables as required and carries out credit checks on most non-rate debtors.

There are no material receivables that have been subjected to a re-negotiation of repayment terms.

Credit risk profile

Receivables – rates and annual charges

Credit risk on rates and annual charges is minimised by the ability of Council to recover these debts as a secured charge over the land; that is, the land can be sold to recover the debt. Council is also able to charge interest on overdue rates and annual charges at higher than market rates which further encourages payment.

	Not yet overdue \$ '000	overdue rates and annual charges		Total \$ '000
		< 5 years \$ '000	≥ 5 years \$ '000	
2025				
Gross carrying amount	–	592	43	635
Expected loss rate (%)	0.00%	74.00%	100.00%	0.00%
ECL provision	–	516	43	559
2024				
Gross carrying amount	–	477	173	650
Expected loss rate (%)	0.00%	74.00%	100.00%	0.00%
ECL provision	–	351	173	524

Receivables - non-rates and annual charges

Council applies the simplified approach for non-rates debtors to provide for expected credit losses prescribed by AASB 9, which permits the use of the lifetime expected loss provision. To measure the expected credit losses, non-rates and annual charges debtors have been grouped based on shared credit risk characteristics and the days past due. The loss allowance provision as at 30 June 2025 is determined as follows. The expected credit losses incorporate forward-looking information.

	Not yet overdue \$ '000	0 - 30 days \$ '000	Overdue debts			Total \$ '000
			31 - 60 days \$ '000	61 - 90 days \$ '000	> 91 days \$ '000	
2025						
Gross carrying amount	11,417	–	3	1	781	12,202
Expected loss rate (%)	0.00%	3.47%	7.00%	17.00%	39.90%	2.56%
ECL provision	–	–	–	–	312	312
2024						
Gross carrying amount	10,292	591	32	656	306	11,877
Expected loss rate (%)	0.00%	3.47%	7.00%	17.00%	70.00%	2.93%
ECL provision	–	21	2	111	213	347

E1-1 Risks relating to financial instruments held (continued)

(c) Liquidity risk

Payables, lease liabilities and borrowings are both subject to liquidity risk; that is, the risk that insufficient funds may be on hand to meet payment obligations as and when they fall due.

Council manages this risk by monitoring its cash flow requirements and liquidity levels, and by maintaining an adequate cash buffer. Payment terms can be extended, and overdraft facilities drawn upon in extenuating circumstances.

Borrowings are also subject to interest rate risk: the risk that movements in interest rates could adversely affect funding costs. Council manages this risk through diversification of borrowing types, maturities and interest rate structures.

The finance team regularly reviews interest rate movements to determine if it would be advantageous to refinance or renegotiate part or all of the loan portfolio.

The timing of cash flows presented in the table below to settle financial liabilities reflects the earliest contractual settlement dates. The timing of expected outflows is not expected to be materially different from contracted cashflows.

The amounts disclosed in the table are the undiscounted contracted cash flows for non-lease liabilities (refer to Note C2-1(b) for lease liabilities) and therefore the balances in the table may not equal the balances in the Statement of Financial Position due to the effect of discounting.

	Weighted average interest rate %	Subject to no maturity \$ '000	payable in: ≤ 1 Year \$ '000	1 - 5 Years \$ '000	> 5 Years \$ '000	Total cash outflows \$ '000	Actual carrying values \$ '000
2025							
Payables	0.00%	49	2,267	51	–	2,367	2,367
Total financial liabilities		49	2,267	51	–	2,367	2,367
2024							
Payables	0.00%	45	4,068	51	–	4,164	4,164
Total financial liabilities		45	4,068	51	–	4,164	4,164

E2-1 Fair value measurement

The Council measures the following asset and liability classes at fair value on a recurring basis:

- Infrastructure, property, plant and equipment
- Financial assets and liabilities

The fair value of assets and liabilities must be estimated in accordance with various accounting standards for either recognition and measurement requirements or for disclosure purposes.

AASB 13 Fair Value Measurement requires all assets and liabilities measured at fair value to be assigned to a 'level' in the fair value hierarchy as follows:

Level 1: Unadjusted quoted prices in active markets for identical assets or liabilities that the entity can access at the measurement date.

Level 2: Inputs other than quoted prices included within level 1 that are observable for the asset or liability, either directly or indirectly.

Level 3: Inputs for the asset or liability that are not based on observable market data (unobservable inputs).

Fair value measurement hierarchy								
Notes	Date of latest valuation		Level 2 Significant observable inputs		Level 3 Significant unobservable inputs		Total	
	2025	2024	2025	2024	2025	2024	2025	2024
	\$ '000	\$ '000	\$ '000	\$ '000	\$ '000	\$ '000	\$ '000	\$ '000
Infrastructure, property, plant and equipment								
C1-7								
Plant and equipment	30/06/20	30/06/20	–	–	3,156	4,073	3,156	4,073
Office equipment	30/06/20	30/06/20	–	–	109	139	109	139
Furniture and fittings	30/06/20	30/06/20	–	–	6	10	6	10
Operational land	30/06/23	30/06/23	–	–	2,302	2,097	2,302	2,097
Community land	30/06/23	30/06/23	–	–	434	397	434	397
Buildings – non-specialised	30/06/23	30/06/23	2,119	2,105	–	–	2,119	2,105
Buildings – specialised	30/06/23	30/06/23	–	–	27,445	26,829	27,445	26,829
Other structures	30/06/21	30/06/21	–	–	6,062	5,147	6,062	5,147
Roads	30/06/25	30/06/20	–	–	143,511	151,068	143,511	151,068
Bridges	30/06/25	30/06/20	–	–	16,351	18,831	16,351	18,831
Footpaths	30/06/25	30/06/20	–	–	3,009	3,009	3,009	3,009
Bulk earthworks – Levee banks	30/06/25	30/06/20	–	–	4,899	3,877	4,899	3,877
Stormwater drainage	30/06/25	30/06/20	–	–	714	708	714	708
Water supply network	30/06/22	30/06/22	–	–	15,651	14,247	15,651	14,247
Sewerage network	30/06/22	30/06/22	–	–	8,792	8,539	8,792	8,539
Swimming pools	30/06/21	30/06/21	–	–	1,685	1,732	1,685	1,732
Other open spaces/recreational assets	30/06/21	30/06/21	–	–	2,129	1,174	2,129	1,174
Airports	30/06/25	30/06/20	–	–	3,233	2,631	3,233	2,631
Total infrastructure, property, plant and equipment			2,119	2,105	239,488	244,508	241,607	246,613

Valuation techniques

Where Council is unable to derive fair valuations using quoted market prices of identical assets (ie. level 1 inputs) Council instead utilises a spread of both observable inputs (level 2 inputs) and unobservable inputs (level 3 inputs).

The fair valuation techniques Council has employed while utilising level 2 and level 3 inputs are as follows:

Infrastructure, property, plant and equipment (IPPE)

There has been no change in valuation techniques during the reporting period.

E2-1 Fair value measurement (continued)

The values of Plant and Equipment, Office Equipment, and Furniture and Fittings have been disclosed at cost due to the nature of these assets.

All buildings and other structures were valued by an external registered valuer on the basis of fair value. The values include normal fixtures and fittings, internal finishes, electrical and mechanical services, fire / security, transportation, and roofing. The specialised buildings and other structures have no active market and have been classified as Level 3.

In 2025 Roads, comprising roadway, roadside shoulders, kerb and guttering, Bridges, Footpaths, Stormwater drainage and Airports have been valued by external valuer DCPM on a fair value basis. This group has been classified as level 3 as market based evidence could not be supported.

Levee Banks, Swimming Pools, Open Space and Recreation Assets have all been externally valued on a fair value basis. As market based evidence was unable to be supported for these categories they have all been classified as level 3.

Water Supply Network and Sewerage Services Network have been externally valued by a qualified independent valuer on a fair value basis. They are classified as level 3 as market evidence was not supported. These assets have been indexed annually at an indexation rate supplied by the Department of Climate Change, Energy, the Environment and Water (DCCEEW).

Fair value measurements using significant unobservable inputs (level 3)

For changes in Level 3 input fair value asset classes refer to Note C1-7.

There were no transfers into or out of the Level 3 fair valuation hierarchy.

Valuation process and significant unobservable valuation inputs used (for level 2 and 3 fair value hierarchy asset classes)

Land - Values were determined with reference to the NSW Valuer General's 2022 land valuation.

All Other Level 2 and 3 Asset Classes

Where there was an active and liquid market as evidenced by sales transactions of similar property types, a Market Approach by way of Direct Comparison, Income Capitalisation or Summation methods was utilised.

These are accepted valuation methodologies under AASB 13. If a Market Approach is adopted, the building valuation is deemed to be a Level 2 input.

Direct comparison and summation methods involve analysis of sales evidence and comparisons with the subject taking into account matters such as method of construction, size, condition, age, land area and location. The land value is subtracted from the Market Value of the property to measure the building asset Fair Value.

For those assets not assessed under a Market Approach due to their predominantly specialised nature, a Current Replacement Cost (CRC) approach to valuation has been adopted, being an accepted valuation methodology under AASB 13. The CRC approach is deemed Level 3 methodology on the Fair Value Hierarchy.

Where there is no depth of market, as determined for the specified Brewarrina Shire Council assets, the net current value of an asset is the gross current value less accumulated depreciation to reflect the consumed or expired service potential of the asset.

Under this approach, the following process is adopted:

- Published/available market data for recent projects, and/or published cost guides are utilised to determine the estimated replacement cost (gross value) of the asset, including allowances for preliminaries and professional fees. This is considered a Level 2 input.
- A condition assessment is applied, which is based on factors such as the age of the asset, overall condition as noted by the Valuer during inspection, economic and/or functional obsolescence. The condition assessment directly translates to the level of depreciation applied. The conditions assessed are considered a Level 3 input.
- While the replacement cost of the assets could be supported by market supplied evidence (level 2), other unobservable inputs (such as estimates of residual value, useful life, asset condition) were also required (level 3).

To calculate the appropriate amount of accumulated depreciation, assets were either subject to a site inspection or an assessment to determine remaining useful life. Where site inspections were conducted (i.e. for visible aboveground assets), the assets were allocated a condition assessment, which was used to estimate remaining useful life.

E2-1 Fair value measurement (continued)

Where site inspections were not conducted (i.e. for passive assets and active assets for which no site inspections were undertaken), the remaining useful life was calculated on asset age and estimated useful life.

The valuation techniques used in the determination of fair values maximise the use of observable data where it is available and relies as little as possible on entity specifics. The disclosure of valuation estimates is designed to provide users with an insight into the judgements that have been made in the determination of fair values.

Infrastructure - Calculation of Current Replacement Cost

Water and Sewerage Infrastructure

The water assets were segregated into Systems; Reticulation, Raw Supply, Potable Storage, and Treatment assets; reticulation assets were not further componentised and consisted of mains, hydrants, stop valves and water meters. Other asset systems were componentised based on usage profile. Unit rates were applied based on similar recent project costs, unit rate databases, indices, Rawlinson's Construction rates and quotations.

The remaining system assets consisted of treatment, pumping and storage assets. These assets were componentised and valued individually, with allowances for complexity, size, function and site factors. These are generally totalled to a lump sum item and compared against recent similar projects and in-house databases to check for relativity, appropriateness and sensibility.

Location factors, soil type, weather conditions, raw material access and service level standards were assumed to be uniform across the council area.

Unit rates were increased depending on project complexity to allow for project overheads including survey, environmental and investigation costs, engineering design, planning and project management.

Road Infrastructure

The Roads infrastructure assets were classified as passive assets; passive assets were further componentised and consisted of Formation, Pavement and Seal for roads assets. Unit rates were applied based on similar recent project costs, unit rate databases, indices, Rawlinson's Construction rates and quotations.

Roads were segmented based on the main roads standard, these are categorised as Formed, Unformed and then further by sealed and unsealed types.

The Current Replacement Cost was calculated by reference to asset length and width for Formation and Seal and Depth for Pavements. Location Factors, soil type, weather conditions, raw material access and service level standards were assumed to be uniform across the council area.

Valuation Processes

Council's valuation policies and procedures are set out by the leadership team which comprises the General Manager, Finance and Admin Manager, and the Transport Manager. They are reviewed annually taking into consideration an analysis of movements in fair value and other relevant information. Non-recurring fair value measurements are made at the point of reclassification by a registered valuer.

Highest and best use

All of Council's non-financial assets are considered as being utilised for their highest and best use.

E3-1 Contingencies

The following assets and liabilities do not qualify for recognition in the Statement of Financial Position, but their knowledge and disclosure is considered relevant to the users of Council's financial report.

LIABILITIES NOT RECOGNISED

1. Guarantees

(i) Defined benefit superannuation contribution plans

Council is party to an Industry Defined Benefit Plan under the Local Government Superannuation Scheme, named The Local Government Superannuation Scheme – Pool B (the Scheme) which is a defined benefit plan that has been deemed to be a 'multi-employer fund' for purposes of AASB119 Employee Benefits for the following reasons:

- Assets are not segregated within the sub-group according to the employees of each sponsoring employer.
- The contribution rates have been the same for all sponsoring employers. That is, contribution rates have not varied for each sponsoring employer according to the experience relating to the employees of that sponsoring employer.
- Benefits for employees of all sponsoring employers are determined according to the same formulae and without regard to the sponsoring employer.
- The same actuarial assumptions are currently used in respect of the employees of each sponsoring employer.

Given the factors above, each sponsoring employer is exposed to the actuarial risks associated with current and former employees of other sponsoring employers, and hence shares in the associated gains and losses (to the extent that they are not borne by members).

Description of the funding arrangements.

Pooled Employers are required to pay future service employer contributions and past service employer contributions to the Fund.

The future service employer contributions were determined using the new entrant rate method under which a contribution rate sufficient to fund the total benefits over the working life-time of a typical new entrant is calculated. The current future service employer contribution rates are::

Division B	1.9 times member contributions for non-180 Point Members; Nil for 180 Point Members*
Division C	2.5% salaries
Division D	1.64 times member contributions

* For 180 Point Members, Employers are required to contribute 9% of salaries for the year ending 30 June 2025 (increasing to 9.5% in line with the increase in the Superannuation Guarantee) to these members' accumulation accounts, which are paid in addition to members' defined benefits.

The past service contribution for each Pooled Employer is a share of the total past service contributions of \$20.0 million per annum for 1 January 2022 to 31 December 2024, apportioned according to each employer's share of the accrued liabilities as at 30 June. Given the funding position of the Fund as at 30 June 2024, it was recommended to cease these past service contributions effective 1 January 2025.

The adequacy of contributions is assessed at each triennial actuarial investigation which will be conducted annually, the next of which is due effective 30 June 2025.

Description of the extent to which Council can be liable to the plan for other Council's obligations under the terms and conditions of the multi-employer plan

As stated above, each sponsoring employer (Council) is exposed to the actuarial risks associated with current and former employees of other sponsoring employers and hence shares in the associated gains and losses.

However, there is no relief under the Fund's trust deed for employers to walk away from their defined benefit obligations. Under limited circumstances, an employer may withdraw from the plan when there are no active members, on full payment of outstanding additional contributions. There is no provision for allocation of any surplus which may be present at the date of withdrawal of the Council.

There are no specific provisions under the Fund's trust deed dealing with deficits or surplus on wind-up.

E3-1 Contingencies (continued)

There is no provision for allocation of any surplus which may be present at the date of withdrawal of an employer.

The amount of Council contributions to the defined benefit section of the Local Government Superannuation Scheme and recognised as an expense for the year ending 30 June 2025 was \$40,664.19. The last valuation of the Scheme was performed by fund actuary, Richard Boyfield, FIAA as at 30 June 2024.

The amount of additional contributions included in the total employer contribution advised above is \$476.64. Council's expected contribution to the plan for the next annual reporting period is \$3,081.84.

The estimated employer reserves financial position for the Pooled Employers at 30 June 2025 is:

Employer reserves only *	\$millions	Asset Coverage
Assets	2,197.6	
Past Service Liabilities	2,092.0	105.0%
Vested Benefits	2,130.4	103.2%

* excluding member accounts and reserves in both assets and liabilities.

The share of any funding surplus or deficit that can be attributed to Council is 0.05%

Council's share of that deficiency cannot be accurately calculated as the Scheme is a mutual arrangement where assets and liabilities are pooled together for all member councils. For this reason, no liability for the deficiency has been recognised in Council's accounts. Council has a possible obligation that may arise should the Scheme require immediate payment to correct the deficiency.

The key economic long term assumptions used to calculate the present value of accrued benefits are:

Investment return	6.0% per annum
Salary inflation	3.5% per annum
Increase in CPI	2.5% per annum

The contribution requirements may vary from the current rates if the overall sub-group experience is not in line with the actuarial assumptions in determining the funding program; however, any adjustment to the funding program would be the same for all sponsoring employers in the Pooled Employers group.

Please note that the estimated employer reserves financial position above is a preliminary calculation, and once all the relevant information has been received by the Funds Actuary, the final end of year review will be completed by December 2025.

(ii) Statewide Limited

Council is a member of Statewide Mutual, a mutual pool scheme providing liability insurance to local government.

Membership includes the potential to share in either the net assets or liabilities of the fund depending on its past performance. Council's share of the net assets or liabilities reflects Council's contributions to the pool and the result of insurance claims within each of the fund years.

The future realisation and finalisation of claims incurred but not reported to 30 June this year may result in future liabilities or benefits as a result of past events that Council will be required to fund or share in respectively.

(iii) StateCover Limited

Council is a member of StateCover Mutual Limited and holds a partly paid share in the entity.

StateCover is a company providing workers compensation insurance cover to the NSW local government industry and specifically Council.

Council has a contingent liability to contribute further equity in the event of the erosion of the company's capital base as a result of the company's past performance and/or claims experience or as a result of any increased prudential requirements from APRA.

E3-1 Contingencies (continued)

These future equity contributions would be required to maintain the company's minimum level of net assets in accordance with its licence requirements.

(iv) Other guarantees

Council has provided no other guarantees other than those listed above.

2. Other liabilities

(i) Third party claims

The Council is involved from time to time in various claims incidental to the ordinary course of business including claims for damages relating to its services.

Council believes that it is appropriately covered for all claims through its insurance coverage and does not expect any material liabilities to eventuate.

(ii) Potential land acquisitions due to planning restrictions imposed by Council

Council has classified a number of privately owned land parcels as local open space or bushland.

As a result, where notified in writing by the various owners, Council will be required to purchase these land parcels.

At reporting date, reliable estimates as to the value of any potential liability (and subsequent land asset) from such potential acquisitions has not been possible.

ASSETS NOT RECOGNISED

(i) Land under roads

As permitted under AASB 1051, Council has elected not to bring to account land under roads that it owned or controlled up to and including 30/6/08.

F People and relationships

F1 Related party disclosures

F1-1 Key management personnel (KMP)

Key management personnel (KMP) of the council are those persons having the authority and responsibility for planning, directing and controlling the activities of the council, directly or indirectly.

The aggregate amount of KMP compensation included in the Income Statement is:

	2025 \$ '000	2024 \$ '000
Compensation:		
Short-term benefits	928	980
Post-employment benefits	83	84
Other long-term benefits	18	16
Total	1,029	1,080

Other transactions with KMP and their related parties

Council has determined that transactions at arm's length between KMP and Council as part of Council delivering a public service objective (e.g. access to library or Council swimming pool by KMP) will not be disclosed.

Other specific transactions are detailed below.

Nature of the transaction	Ref	Transactions during the year \$ '000	Outstanding balances including commitments \$ '000	Terms and conditions
2025				
Supply of Materials & Services	1	457	–	30-day term on invoice
Employee expenses relating to close family members of KMP	2	99	–	Council Staff Award

F1-1 Key management personnel (KMP) (continued)

Nature of the transaction	Ref	Transactions during the year \$ '000	Outstanding balances including commitments \$ '000	Terms and conditions
2024				
Swimming Pool Contract, Labour and Plant Hire		–	–	30-day term on invoice
Swimming Pool Contract and Catering		–	–	30-day term on invoice
Supply of Materials & Services	1	692	–	30-day term on invoice
Employee expenses relating to close family members of KMP	2	144	–	Council Staff Award

In 2025 council purchased materials and services from:

- 1
- Services from Barwon Livestock Pty Ltd is owned by the close family member of KMP of the council. The total payment is \$268,620.
 - Services from Muddy Water Brewarrina is owned by the close family member of KMP of the council. The total payment is \$1,745.
 - Services from John Francis Taylor is owned by the close family member of KMP of the council. The total payment is \$8,900
 - Services from Top River Pty Ltd is owned by the close family member of KMP of the council. The total payment is \$177,748.

In 2024 council purchased materials and services from:

- Services from Barwon Livestock Pty Ltd owned by the close family member of KMP of the council. The total payment is \$646,892.
- Holz Trade Service Pty owned by the council's KMP. Total payment value is \$44,162.
- Services from First Linguists PTY LTD owned by the close family member of the council's KMP. Total payment value is \$500.

* New coming Councillor, Belinda Colless, swore at 9 Oct 2024 and relation transaction was from 9 Oct 2024 onward but not prior to 9 Oct 24.

- 2
- Close family members of Council's KMP are employed by the council under the state award on an arm's length basis. There are 2 close family members of KMP currently employed by the council.

F1-2 Councillor and Mayoral fees and associated expenses

	2025 \$ '000	2024 \$ '000
The aggregate amount of Councillor and Mayoral fees and associated expenses included in materials and services expenses in the Income Statement are:		
Mayoral fee	28	21
Councillors' fees	105	123
Other Councillors' expenses (including Mayor)	18	29
Total	151	173

F2 Other relationships

F2-1 Audit fees

	2025 \$ '000	2024 \$ '000
During the year, the following fees were incurred for services provided by the auditor of Council, related practices and non-related audit firms		
Auditors of the Council - NSW Auditor-General:		
(i) Audit and other assurance services		
Audit and review of financial statements	84	86
Remuneration for audit and other assurance services	84	86
Total audit fees	84	86

G Other matters

G1-1 Statement of Cash Flows information

Reconciliation of Operating Result

	2025 \$ '000	2024 \$ '000
Net operating result from Income Statement	(3,135)	5,138
Add / (less) non-cash items:		
Depreciation and amortisation	5,689	5,910
(Gain) / loss on disposal of assets	998	110
Non-cash capital grants and contributions	–	(104)
Movements in operating assets and liabilities and other cash items:		
(Increase) / decrease of receivables	3,768	(4,816)
Increase / (decrease) in provision for impairment of receivables	–	176
(Increase) / decrease of inventories	84	59
(Increase) / decrease of other current assets	(25)	(22)
(Increase) / decrease of contract asset	(4,078)	3,649
Increase / (decrease) in payables	(2,411)	1,806
Increase / (decrease) in accrued interest payable	–	(3)
Increase / (decrease) in other accrued expenses payable	249	(183)
Increase / (decrease) in other liabilities	(215)	79
Increase / (decrease) in contract liabilities	2,330	2,078
Increase / (decrease) in employee benefit provision	(133)	334
Net cash flows from operating activities	3,121	14,211

G2-1 Commitments

Capital commitments (exclusive of GST)

	2025	2024
	\$ '000	\$ '000

Capital expenditure committed for at the reporting date but not recognised in the financial statements as liabilities:

Property, plant and equipment

Plant and equipment	566	47
Other Structures	–	212
Road infrastructure	–	6
Total commitments	566	265

These expenditures are payable as follows:

Within the next year	566	265
Total payable	566	265

Sources for funding of capital commitments:

Unrestricted general funds	566	265
Total sources of funding	566	265

G3-1 Events occurring after the reporting date

Council is unaware of any material or significant non-adjusting events that should be disclosed.

End of the audited financial statements



INDEPENDENT AUDITOR'S REPORT

Report on the general purpose financial statements

Brewarrina Shire Council

To the Councillors of Brewarrina Shire Council

Opinion

I have audited the accompanying financial statements of Brewarrina Shire Council (the Council), which comprise the Statement by Councillors and Management, the Income Statement and Statement of Comprehensive Income for the year ended 30 June 2025, the Statement of Financial Position as at 30 June 2025, the Statement of Changes in Equity and Statement of Cash Flows for the year then ended, and notes to the financial statements, including material accounting policy information and other explanatory information.

In my opinion:

- the Council's accounting records have been kept in accordance with the requirements of the *Local Government Act 1993*, Chapter 13, Part 3, Division 2 (the Division)
- the financial statements:
 - have been prepared, in all material respects, in accordance with the requirements of the Division
 - are, in all material respects, consistent with the Council's accounting records
 - present fairly, in all material respects, the financial position of the Council as at 30 June 2025, and of its financial performance and its cash flows for the year then ended in accordance with Australian Accounting Standards
- all information relevant to the conduct of the audit has been obtained
- no material deficiencies in the accounting records or financial statements have come to light during the audit.

My opinion should be read in conjunction with the rest of this report.

Basis for Opinion

I conducted my audit in accordance with Australian Auditing Standards. My responsibilities under the standards are described in the 'Auditor's Responsibilities for the Audit of the Financial Statements' section of my report.

I am independent of the Council in accordance with the requirements of the:

- Australian Auditing Standards
- Accounting Professional and Ethical Standards Board's APES 110 'Code of Ethics for Professional Accountants (including Independence Standards)' (APES 110).

Parliament promotes independence by ensuring the Auditor-General and the Audit Office of New South Wales are not compromised in their roles by:

- providing that only Parliament, and not the executive government, can remove an Auditor-General
- mandating the Auditor-General as auditor of councils
- precluding the Auditor-General from providing non-audit services.

I have fulfilled my other ethical responsibilities in accordance with APES 110.

I believe the audit evidence I have obtained is sufficient and appropriate to provide a basis for my audit opinion.

Other Information

The Council's annual report for the year ended 30 June 2025 includes other information in addition to the financial statements and my Independent Auditor's Report thereon. The Councillors are responsible for the other information. At the date of this Independent Auditor's Report, the other information I have received comprise the special purpose financial statements and Special Schedules (the Schedules).

My opinion on the financial statements does not cover the other information. Accordingly, I do not express any form of assurance conclusion on the other information. However, as required by the *Local Government Act 1993*, I have separately expressed an opinion on the special purpose financial statements and Special Schedule - Permissible income for general rates.

In connection with my audit of the financial statements, my responsibility is to read the other information and, in doing so, consider whether the other information is materially inconsistent with the financial statements or my knowledge obtained in the audit, or otherwise appears to be materially misstated.

If, based on the work I have performed, I conclude there is a material misstatement of the other information, I must report that fact.

I have nothing to report in this regard.

The Councillors' Responsibilities for the Financial Statements

The Councillors are responsible for the preparation and fair presentation of the financial statements in accordance with Australian Accounting Standards and the *Local Government Act 1993*, and for such internal control as the Councillors determine is necessary to enable the preparation and fair presentation of the financial statements that are free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud or error.

In preparing the financial statements, the Councillors are responsible for assessing the Council's ability to continue as a going concern, disclosing, as applicable, matters related to going concern and using the going concern basis of accounting.

Auditor's Responsibilities for the Audit of the Financial Statements

My objectives are to:

- obtain reasonable assurance about whether the financial statements as a whole are free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud or error
- issue an Independent Auditor's Report including my opinion.

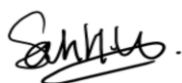
Reasonable assurance is a high level of assurance, but does not guarantee an audit conducted in accordance with Australian Auditing Standards will always detect material misstatements.

Misstatements can arise from fraud or error. Misstatements are considered material if, individually or in aggregate, they could reasonably be expected to influence the economic decisions users take based on the financial statements.

A description of my responsibilities for the audit of the financial statements is located at the Auditing and Assurance Standards Board website at: www.auasb.gov.au/auditors_responsibilities/ar4.pdf. The description forms part of my auditor's report.

The scope of my audit does not include, nor provide assurance:

- that the Council carried out its activities effectively, efficiently and economically
- on the Original Budget information included in the Income Statement, Statement of Cash Flows, and Note B5-1 'Material budget variations'
- on the Special Schedules. A separate opinion has been provided on Special Schedule - Permissible income for general rates
- about the security and controls over the electronic publication of the audited financial statements on any website where they may be presented
- about any other information which may have been hyperlinked to/from the financial statements.



Hong Wee Soh
Delegate of the Auditor-General for New South Wales

29 October 2025
SYDNEY



Cr Tommy Stanton
Mayor
Brewarrina Council
PO Box 125
BREWARRINA NSW 2839

Contact: Hong Wee Soh
Phone no: 02 9275 7397
Our ref: R008-1981756498-7032

29 October 2025

Dear Mayor

Report on the Conduct of the Audit
for the year ended 30 June 2025
Brewarrina Shire Council

I have audited the general purpose financial statements (GPFS) of the Brewarrina Shire Council (the Council) for the year ended 30 June 2025 as required by section 415 of the *Local Government Act 1993* (the Act).

I expressed an unmodified opinion on the Council's GPFS.

My audit procedures did not identify any instances of material non-compliance with the financial reporting requirements in Chapter 13, Part 3, Division 2 of the LG Act and the associated regulation or a material deficiency in the Council's accounting records or financial statements. The Council's:

- accounting records were maintained in a manner and form to allow the GPFS to be prepared and effectively audited
- staff provided all accounting records and information relevant to the audit.

This Report on the Conduct of the Audit (the Report) for the Council for the year ended 30 June 2025 is issued in accordance with section 417 of the Act. The Report:

- must address the specific matters outlined in the Local Government Code of Accounting Practice and Financial Reporting 2024-25
- may include statements, comments and recommendations that I consider to be appropriate based on the conduct of the audit of the GPFS.

This Report should be read in conjunction with my audit opinion on the GPFS issued under section 417(2) of the Act.

INCOME STATEMENT

Financial performance

	2025	2024	Variance
	\$m	\$m	%
Rates and annual charges revenue	2.8	2.7	3.7
Grants and contributions provided for operating purposes revenue	10.6	15.2	30.3
Grants and contributions provided for capital purposes revenue	3.7	6.0	38.3
Operating result from continuing operations	(3.1)	5.1	>100
Net Operating result for the year before grants and contributions provided for capital purposes	(6.8)	(0.9)	>100

Operating result from continuing operations

This graph shows the operating result from continuing operations for the current and prior two financial years.

Council's operating result from continuing operations for the year was \$8.2 million lower than the 2023–24 result.

In 2024-25, depreciation, amortisation and impairment of non-financial assets expense (\$5.7 million) decreased by \$0.2 million (3.4 per cent).

The decrease in the operating result is primarily due to reduced revenue from grants and contributions and incurring expenses funded by grants received from prior years.

The net operating result for the year before grants and contributions provided for capital purposes was a deficit of \$6.8 million. Refer to 'Grants and contributions revenue' below for details.



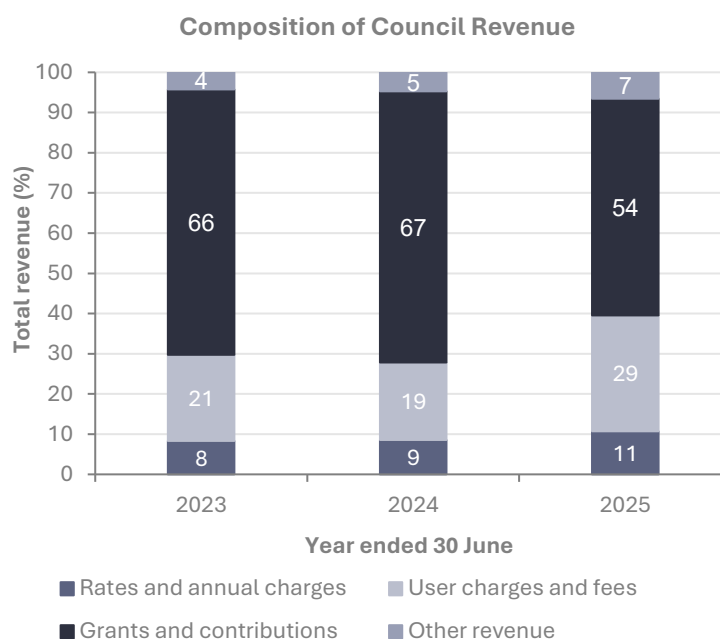
Income

Council revenue

This graph shows the composition of Council's revenue recognised for the current and prior two financial years.

Council revenue (\$26.5 million) decreased by \$5 million (15.8 per cent) in 2024–25 due to:

- rates and annual charges revenue (\$2.8 million) increased by \$0.1 million (3.7 per cent)
- user charges and fees revenue (\$7.7 million) increased by \$1.6 million (26.1 per cent) due to an increase in Transport for NSW works
- grants and contributions revenue (\$14.3 million) decreased by \$7 million (32.7 per cent) – see additional details below.

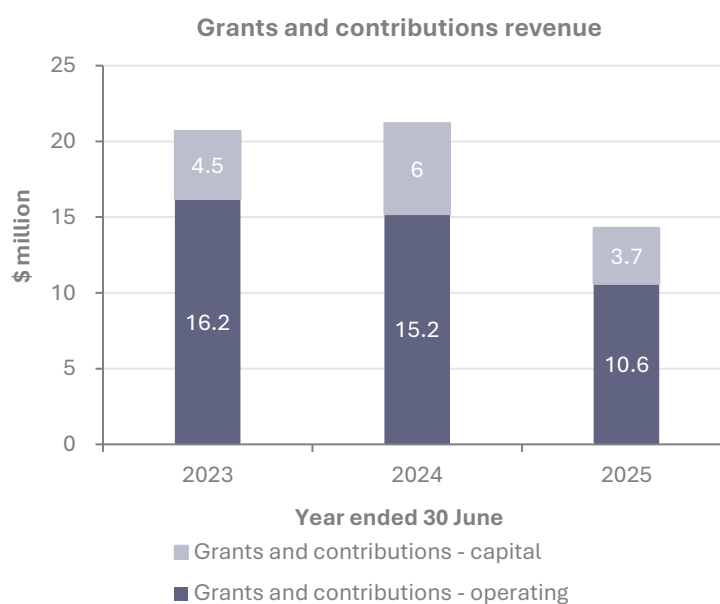


Grants and contributions revenue

This graph shows the amount of grants and contributions revenue recognised for the current and prior two financial years.

Grants and contributions revenue (\$14.3 million) decreased by \$7 million (32.7 per cent) in 2024–25 due to:

- a decrease in specific purpose operating grants of \$3 million, primarily relating to roads funding
- a decrease in capital grants of \$2.3 million, primarily relating to roads capital projects
- receiving 50 per cent of the financial assistance grants for 2025-26 in advance compared to receiving 85 per cent for 2024-25 in 2023-24.



CASH FLOWS

Statement of cash flows

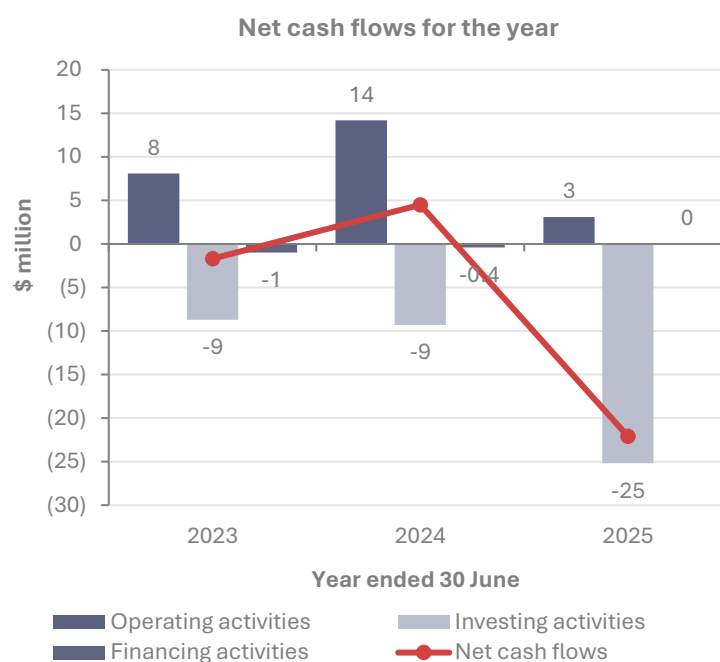
The Statement of Cash Flows details the Council's inflows and outflows of cash over a specific period. It helps in assessing the Council's ability to generate cash to fund its operations, pay off debts, and support future projects. It also aids in identifying any pressures or issues in the Council operating in a financially sustainable manner.

This graph shows the net cash flows for the current and prior two financial years.

The net cash outflows for the year were \$22.1 million (inflow of \$4.5 million in 2023-24).

In 2024-25 the net cashflows:

- from operating activities decreased by \$11.1 million, mainly due to reduced revenue from grants and contributions
- used in investing activities increased by \$15.9 million, due to increased purchases of investments in long term deposits and capital expenditure
- used in financing activities decreased by \$0.4 million as borrowing were fully repaid in the prior year.



FINANCIAL POSITION

Cash, cash equivalents and investments

This section of the Report provides details of the amount of cash, cash equivalents and investments recorded by the Council at 30 June 2025.

Externally restricted funds are the cash, cash equivalents and investments that can only be used for specific purposes due to legal or contractual restrictions.

Cash, cash equivalents, and investments without external restrictions can be allocated internally by the elected Council's resolution or policy. These allocations are matters of Council policy and can be changed or removed by a Council resolution.

Cash, cash equivalents and investments	2025	2024	Percentage of total cash and investments 2025	Commentary
	\$m	\$m	%	
Total cash, cash equivalents and investments	21.2	26.8		Externally restricted balances are those which are only available for specific use due to a restriction placed by legislation or third-party

Restricted and allocated cash, cash equivalents and investments:				
• External restrictions	12.4	15.2	58.5	
• Internal allocations	8.7	11.1	41.0	

contract. A breakdown of the sources of externally restricted balances is included in the graph below.

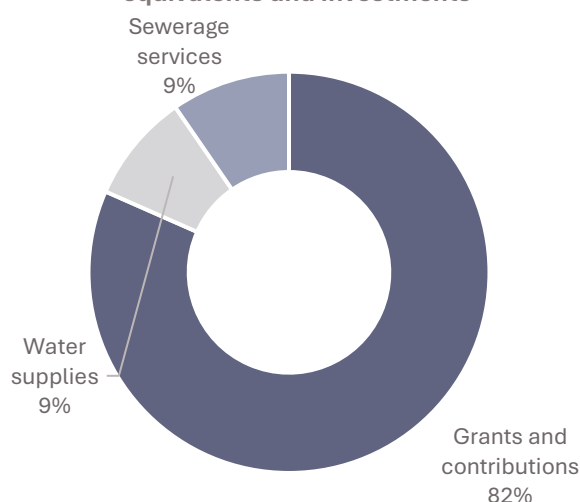
Internal allocations are determined by council policies or decisions, which are subject to change.

This graph shows the sources of externally restricted cash, cash equivalents and investments.

In 2024-25 the Council's main sources of externally restricted cash, cash equivalents and investments include:

- grants and contributions of \$10.2 million
- water supplies of \$1.1 million
- sewerage services of \$1.2 million.

Source of externally restricted cash, cash equivalents and investments



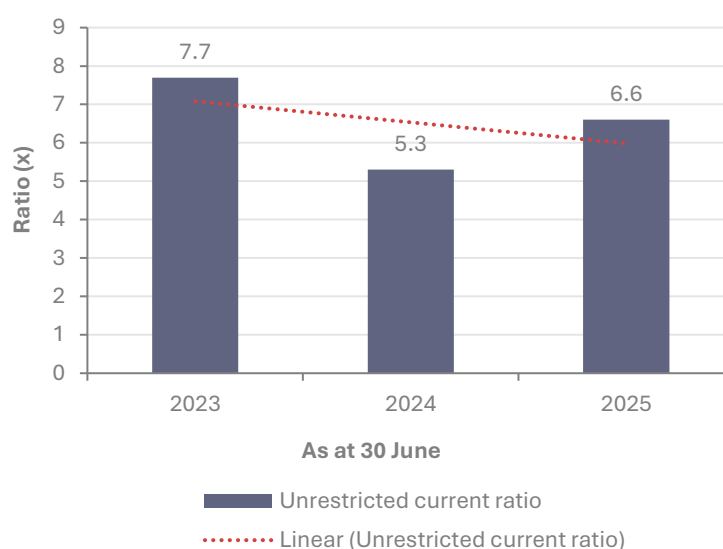
Council liquidity

This graph shows the Council's unrestricted current ratio for the current and prior two financial years.

The unrestricted current ratio is specific to local government and represents council's ability to meet its short-term obligations as they fall due. It measures the ratio of unrestricted current assets to specific purpose liabilities.

In 2023-24, the average unrestricted current ratio was an average of 5.6x for rural councils.

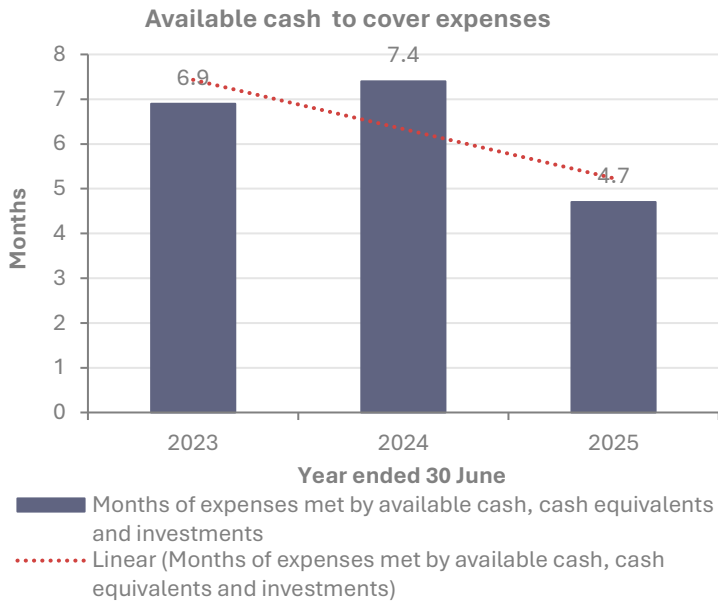
Unrestricted current ratio



This graph shows the number of months of general fund expenses (excluding depreciation and borrowing costs), Council can fund from its available cash, cash equivalents and investments (not subject to external restrictions).

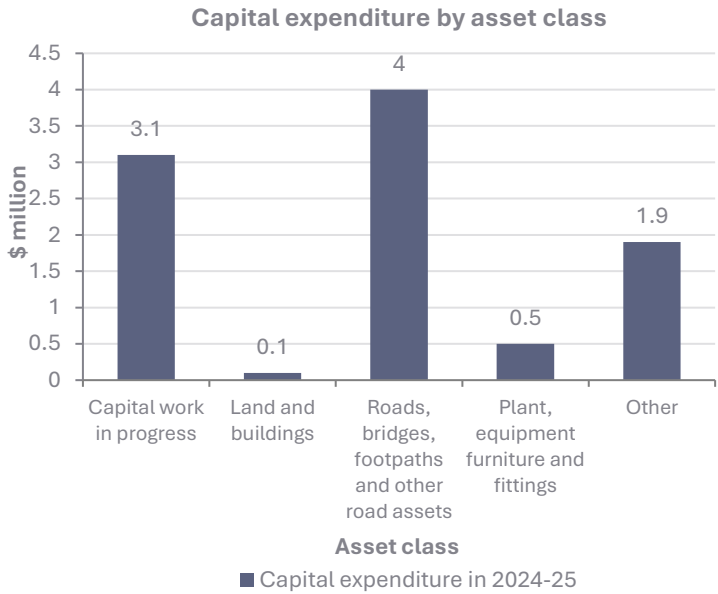
Further details on cash, cash equivalents and investments including the sources of external restrictions are included in the section above.

In 2023–24, the available cash to cover expenses was an average of 8 months for rural councils.



Infrastructure, property, plant and equipment

This graph shows how much the Council spent on renewing and purchasing assets in 2024-25. Council renewed \$2.1 million of infrastructure, property, plant and equipment during the 2024-25 financial year. This was mainly spent on roads and other capital works in progress. A further \$7.6 million was spent on new assets including roads and other infrastructure.



Hong Wee Soh
Associate Director - Financial Audit

Delegate of the Auditor-General

Brewarrina Shire Council

SPECIAL PURPOSE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS for the year ended 30 June 2025

*Building on the economic and social sustainability in order
to preserve the rich heritage of the community*



Special Purpose Financial Statements

for the year ended 30 June 2025

Contents	Page
Statement by Councillors and Management	3
Special Purpose Financial Statements:	
Income Statement of water supply business activity	4
Income Statement of sewerage business activity	5
Statement of Financial Position of water supply business activity	6
Statement of Financial Position of sewerage business activity	7
Note – Material accounting policy information	8
Auditor's Report on Special Purpose Financial Statements	10

Background

- i. These Special Purpose Financial Statements have been prepared for the use by both Council and the Office of Local Government in fulfilling their requirements under National Competition Policy.
- ii. The principle of competitive neutrality is based on the concept of a 'level playing field' between persons/entities competing in a market place, particularly between private and public sector competitors.

Essentially, the principle is that government businesses, whether Commonwealth, state or local, should operate without net competitive advantages over other businesses as a result of their public ownership.

- iii. For Council, the principle of competitive neutrality and public reporting applies only to declared business activities.

These include **(a)** those activities classified by the Australian Bureau of Statistics as business activities being water supply, sewerage services, abattoirs, gas production and reticulation, and **(b)** those activities with a turnover of more than \$2 million that Council has formally declared as a business activity (defined as Category 1 activities).

- iv. In preparing these financial statements for Council's self-classified Category 1 businesses and ABS-defined activities, councils must **(a)** adopt a corporatisation model and **(b)** apply full cost attribution including tax-equivalent regime payments and debt guarantee fees (where the business benefits from Council's borrowing position by comparison with commercial rates).

Brewarrina Shire Council

Special Purpose Financial Statements

for the year ended 30 June 2025

Statement by Councillors and Management made pursuant to the Local Government Code of Accounting Practice and Financial Reporting

The attached special purpose financial statements have been prepared in accordance with:

- NSW Government Policy Statement, *Application of National Competition Policy to Local Government*
- Division of Local Government Guidelines, *Pricing and Costing for Council Businesses: A Guide to Competitive Neutrality*
- The Local Government Code of Accounting Practice and Financial Reporting
- Sections 3 and 4 of the NSW Department of Climate Change, Energy, the Environment and Water's (DCCEEW) Regulatory and assurance framework for local water utilities, July 2022

To the best of our knowledge and belief, these statements:

- present fairly the operating result and financial position for each of Council's declared business activities for the year,
- accord with Council's accounting and other records; and
- present overhead reallocation charges to the water and sewerage businesses as fair and reasonable.

We are not aware of any matter that would render these statements false or misleading in any way.

Signed in accordance with a resolution of Council made on 26 August 2025.



Tommy Stanton

Mayor

26 August 2025



Vivian Slack-Smith

Deputy Mayor

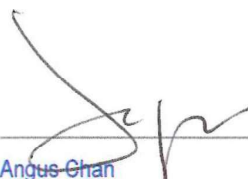
26 August 2025



David Kirby

General Manager

26 August 2025



Angus Chan

Responsible Accounting Officer

26 August 2025

Brewarrina Shire Council

Income Statement of water supply business activity

for the year ended 30 June 2025

	2025 \$ '000	2024 \$ '000
Income from continuing operations		
Access charges	835	805
User charges	380	436
Interest and investment income	149	136
Total income from continuing operations	1,364	1,377
Expenses from continuing operations		
Employee benefits and on-costs	260	289
Administration and engineering supervision	348	335
Materials and services	339	437
Depreciation, amortisation and impairment	539	513
Other expenses	92	69
Total expenses from continuing operations	1,578	1,643
Surplus (deficit) from continuing operations before capital amounts	(214)	(266)
Surplus (deficit) from continuing operations after capital amounts	(214)	(266)
Surplus (deficit) from all operations before tax	(214)	(266)
Surplus (deficit) after tax	(214)	(266)
Plus accumulated surplus	2,338	2,604
Other adjustments	3	–
Closing accumulated surplus	2,127	2,338
Return on capital %	(1.3)%	(1.8)%
Subsidy from Council	879	911
Calculation of dividend payable:		
Surplus (deficit) after tax	(214)	(266)
Surplus for dividend calculation purposes	–	–
Potential dividend calculated from surplus	–	–

Brewarrina Shire Council

Income Statement of sewerage business activity

for the year ended 30 June 2025

	2025 \$ '000	2024 \$ '000
Income from continuing operations		
Access charges	531	512
Interest and investment income	91	71
Total income from continuing operations	622	583
Expenses from continuing operations		
Employee benefits and on-costs	132	140
Administration and engineering supervision	148	144
Materials and services	149	145
Depreciation, amortisation and impairment	225	207
Net loss from the disposal of assets	175	—
Other expenses	37	18
Total expenses from continuing operations	866	654
Surplus (deficit) from continuing operations before capital amounts	(244)	(71)
Grants and contributions provided for capital purposes	137	—
Surplus (deficit) from continuing operations after capital amounts	(107)	(71)
Surplus (deficit) from all operations before tax	(107)	(71)
Surplus (deficit) after tax	(107)	(71)
Plus accumulated surplus	654	725
Plus adjustments for amounts unpaid:		
Closing accumulated surplus	547	654
Return on capital %	(2.8)%	(0.8)%
Subsidy from Council	613	445
Calculation of dividend payable:		
Surplus (deficit) after tax	(107)	(71)
Less: capital grants and contributions (excluding developer contributions)	(137)	—
Surplus for dividend calculation purposes	—	—
Potential dividend calculated from surplus	—	—

Brewarrina Shire Council

Statement of Financial Position of water supply business activity

as at 30 June 2025

	2025 \$ '000	2024 \$ '000
ASSETS		
Current assets		
Cash and cash equivalents	1,067	1,848
Receivables	241	348
Total current assets	1,308	2,196
Non-current assets		
Infrastructure, property, plant and equipment	15,996	14,992
Total non-current assets	15,996	14,992
Total assets	17,304	17,188
LIABILITIES		
Current liabilities		
Payables	6	36
Total current liabilities	6	36
Total liabilities	6	36
Net assets	17,298	17,152
EQUITY		
Accumulated surplus	2,127	2,338
IPPE revaluation surplus	15,171	14,814
Total equity	17,298	17,152

Brewarrina Shire Council

Statement of Financial Position of sewerage business activity

as at 30 June 2025

	2025 \$ '000	2024 \$ '000
ASSETS		
Current assets		
Cash and cash equivalents	1,154	1,273
Receivables	84	76
Total current assets	1,238	1,349
Non-current assets		
Infrastructure, property, plant and equipment	8,859	8,689
Total non-current assets	8,859	8,689
Total assets	10,097	10,038
LIABILITIES		
Current liabilities		
Contract liabilities	–	45
Total current liabilities	–	45
Total liabilities	–	45
Net assets	10,097	9,993
EQUITY		
Accumulated surplus	547	654
IPPE revaluation surplus	9,550	9,339
Total equity	10,097	9,993

Note – Material accounting policy information

A statement summarising the supplemental accounting policies adopted in the preparation of the special purpose financial statements (SPFS) for National Competition Policy (NCP) reporting purposes follows.

These financial statements are SPFS prepared for use by Council and the Office of Local Government. For the purposes of these statements, the Council is a non-reporting not-for-profit entity.

The figures presented in these special purpose financial statements have been prepared in accordance with the recognition and measurement criteria of relevant Australian Accounting Standards, other authoritative pronouncements of the Australian Accounting Standards Board (AASB) and Australian Accounting Interpretations.

The disclosures in these special purpose financial statements have been prepared in accordance with the *Local Government Act 1993* (Act), the *Local Government (General) Regulation 2021* (Regulation) and the Local Government Code of Accounting Practice and Financial Reporting.

The statements are prepared on an accruals basis. They are based on historic costs and do not take into account changing money values or, except where specifically stated, fair value of non-current assets. Certain taxes and other costs, appropriately described, have been imputed for the purposes of the National Competition Policy.

The Statement of Financial Position includes notional assets/liabilities receivable from/payable to Council's general fund. These balances reflect a notional intra-entity funding arrangement with the declared business activities.

National Competition Policy

Council has adopted the principle of 'competitive neutrality' in its business activities as part of the National Competition Policy which is being applied throughout Australia at all levels of government. The framework for its application is set out in the June 1996 NSW Government Policy statement titled 'Application of National Competition Policy to Local Government'. *The Pricing and Costing for Council Businesses – A Guide to Competitive Neutrality* issued by the Office of Local Government in July 1997 has also been adopted.

The pricing and costing guidelines outline the process for identifying and allocating costs to activities and provide a standard for disclosure requirements. These disclosures are reflected in Council's pricing and/or financial reporting systems and include taxation equivalents, Council subsidies, and returns on investments (rate of return and dividends paid).

Declared business activities

In accordance with Pricing and Costing for Council Businesses – A Guide to Competitive Neutrality, Council has declared that the following are to be considered as business activities:

Category 1

(where gross operating turnover is over \$2 million)

Council has no Category 1 business activities.

Category 2

(where gross operating turnover is less than \$2 million)

a. Brewarrina Shire Water Supplies

Comprising the whole of the water supply operations and net assets servicing the town of Brewarrina and the village of Goodooga.

b. Brewarrina Shire Sewerage Service

Comprising the whole of the sewerage reticulation and treatment operations and net assets servicing the town of Brewarrina and the village of Goodooga.

Taxation equivalent charges

Council is liable to pay various taxes and financial duties. Where this is the case, they are disclosed as a cost of operations just like all other costs. However, where Council does not pay some taxes, which are generally paid by private sector businesses, such as income tax, these equivalent tax payments have been applied to all Council-nominated business activities and are reflected in special purpose financial statements. For the purposes of disclosing comparative information relevant to the private sector equivalent, the following taxation equivalents have been applied to all Council-nominated business activities (this does not include Council's non-business activities):

Notional rate applied (%)

Corporate income tax rate – 25% (LY 25%)

Note – Material accounting policy information (continued)

Land tax – the first \$1,075,000 of combined land values attracts **0%**. For the combined land values in excess of \$1,075,000 up to \$6,571,000 the rate is **\$100 + 1.6%**. For the remaining combined land value that exceeds \$6,571,000 a premium marginal rate of **2.0%** applies.

Payroll tax – **5.45%** on the value of taxable salaries and wages in excess of \$1,200,000.

In accordance with DCCEEW's regulatory and assurance framework, a payment for the amount calculated as the annual tax equivalent charges (excluding income tax) must be paid from water supply and sewerage business activities.

The payment of taxation equivalent charges, referred to in the regulatory and assurance framework as a 'dividend for taxation equivalent', may be applied for any purpose allowed under the Act.

Achievement of substantial compliance to DCCEEW's regulatory and assurance framework is not a prerequisite for the payment of the tax equivalent charges; however the payment must not exceed \$3 per assessment.

Income tax

An income tax equivalent has been applied on the profits of the business activities. Whilst income tax is not a specific cost for the purpose of pricing a good or service, it needs to be taken into account in terms of assessing the rate of return required on capital invested. Accordingly, the return on capital invested is set at a pre-tax level – gain/(loss) from ordinary activities before capital amounts, as would be applied by a private sector competitor. That is, it should include a provision equivalent to the relevant corporate income tax rate, currently 25% (LY 25%).

Income tax is only applied where a gain from ordinary activities before capital amounts has been achieved. Since the taxation equivalent is notional – that is, it is payable to the 'Council' as the owner of business operations – it represents an internal payment and has no effect on the operations of the Council.

Accordingly, there is no need for disclosure of internal charges in the SPFS. The rate applied of 25% is the equivalent company tax rate prevalent at reporting date.

Local government rates and charges

A calculation of the equivalent rates and charges for all Category 1 businesses has been applied to all assets owned, or exclusively used by the business activity.

Loan and debt guarantee fees

The debt guarantee fee is designed to ensure that Council business activities face 'true' commercial borrowing costs in line with private sector competitors. In order to calculate a debt guarantee fee, Council has determined what the differential borrowing rate would have been between the commercial rate and Council's borrowing rate for its business activities.

(i) Subsidies

Government policy requires that subsidies provided to customers, and the funding of those subsidies, must be explicitly disclosed. Subsidies occur where Council provides services on a less than cost recovery basis. This option is exercised on a range of services in order for Council to meet its community service obligations. The overall effect of subsidies is contained within the Income Statements of business activities.

(ii) Return on investments (rate of return)

The NCP policy statement requires that councils with Category 1 businesses 'would be expected to generate a return on capital funds employed that is comparable to rates of return for private businesses operating in a similar field'.

Funds are subsequently available for meeting commitments or financing future investment strategies. The rate of return is disclosed for each of Council's business activities on the Income Statement.

(iii) Dividends

Council is not required to pay dividends to either itself (as owner of a range of businesses) or to any external entities.



INDEPENDENT AUDITOR'S REPORT

Report on the special purpose financial statements

Brewarrina Shire Council

To the Councillors of Brewarrina Shire Council

Opinion

I have audited the accompanying special purpose financial statements (the financial statements) of Brewarrina Shire Council's (the Council) Declared Business Activities, which comprise the Statement by Councillors and Management, the Income Statement of each Declared Business Activity for the year ended 30 June 2025, the Statement of Financial Position of each Declared Business Activity as at 30 June 2025 and the Material accounting policy information note.

The Declared Business Activities of the Council are:

- Water supply
- Sewerage

In my opinion, the financial statements present fairly, in all material respects, the financial position of the Council's declared Business Activities as at 30 June 2025, and their financial performance for the year then ended, in accordance with the Australian Accounting Standards described in the Material accounting policy information note and the Local Government Code of Accounting Practice and Financial Reporting 2024-25 (LG Code).

My opinion should be read in conjunction with the rest of this report.

Basis for Opinion

I conducted my audit in accordance with Australian Auditing Standards. My responsibilities under the standards are described in the 'Auditor's Responsibilities for the Audit of the Financial Statements' section of my report.

I am independent of the Council in accordance with the requirements of the:

- Australian Auditing Standards
- Accounting Professional and Ethical Standards Board's APES 110 'Code of Ethics for Professional Accountants (including Independence Standards)' (APES 110).

Parliament promotes independence by ensuring the Auditor-General and the Audit Office of New South Wales are not compromised in their roles by:

- providing that only Parliament, and not the executive government, can remove an Auditor-General
- mandating the Auditor-General as the auditor of councils
- precluding the Auditor-General from providing non-audit services.

I have fulfilled my other ethical responsibilities in accordance with APES 110.

I believe the audit evidence I have obtained is sufficient and appropriate to provide a basis for my audit opinion.

Emphasis of Matter - Basis of Accounting

Without modifying my opinion, I draw attention to the Material accounting policy information note to the financial statements which describes the basis of accounting. The financial statements have been prepared for the purpose of fulfilling the Council's financial reporting responsibilities under the LG Code. As a result, the financial statements may not be suitable for another purpose.

Other Information

The Council's annual report for the year ended 30 June 2025 includes other information in addition to the financial statements and my Independent Auditor's Report thereon. The Councillors are responsible for the other information. At the date of this Independent Auditor's Report, the other information I have received comprise the general purpose financial statements and Special Schedules (the Schedules).

My opinion on the financial statements does not cover the other information. Accordingly, I do not express any form of assurance conclusion on the other information. However, as required by the *Local Government Act 1993*, I have separately expressed an opinion on the general purpose financial statements and Special Schedule 'Permissible income for general rates'.

In connection with my audit of the financial statements, my responsibility is to read the other information and, in doing so, consider whether the other information is materially inconsistent with the financial statements or my knowledge obtained in the audit, or otherwise appears to be materially misstated.

If, based on the work I have performed, I conclude there is a material misstatement of the other information, I must report that fact.

I have nothing to report in this regard.

The Councillors' Responsibilities for the Financial Statements

The Councillors are responsible for the preparation and fair presentation of the financial statements and for determining that the accounting policies, described in the Material accounting policy information note to the financial statements, are appropriate to meet the requirements in the LG Code. The Councillors' responsibility also includes such internal control as the Councillors determine is necessary to enable the preparation and fair presentation of the financial statements that are free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud or error.

In preparing the financial statements, the Councillors are responsible for assessing the Council's ability to continue as a going concern, disclosing, as applicable, matters related to going concern and using the going concern basis of accounting.

Auditor's Responsibilities for the Audit of the Financial Statements

My objectives are to:

- obtain reasonable assurance about whether the financial statements as a whole are free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud or error
- issue an Independent Auditor's Report including my opinion.

Reasonable assurance is a high level of assurance, but does not guarantee an audit conducted in accordance with Australian Auditing Standards will always detect material misstatements.

Misstatements can arise from fraud or error. Misstatements are considered material if, individually or in aggregate, they could reasonably be expected to influence the economic decisions users take based on the financial statements.

A description of my responsibilities for the audit of the financial statements is located at the Auditing and Assurance Standards Board website at: www.auasb.gov.au/auditors_responsibilities/ar4.pdf. The description forms part of my auditor's report.

The scope of my audit does not include, nor provide assurance:

- that the Council carried out its activities effectively, efficiently and economically
- about the security and controls over the electronic publication of the audited financial statements on any website where they may be presented
- about any other information which may have been hyperlinked to/from the financial statements.

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read 'Soh Wee Hong'.

Hong Wee Soh
Delegate of the Auditor-General for New South Wales

29 October 2025
SYDNEY

Brewarrina Shire Council

SPECIAL SCHEDULES
for the year ended 30 June 2025

*Building on the economic and social sustainability in order
to preserve the rich heritage of the community*



Brewarrina Shire Council

Special Schedules

for the year ended 30 June 2025

Contents	Page
Special Schedules:	
Permissible income for general rates	3
Report on infrastructure assets as at 30 June 2025	7

Brewarrina Shire Council

Permissible income for general rates

	Notes	Calculation 2024/25 \$ '000	Calculation 2025/26 \$ '000
Notional general income calculation ¹			
Last year notional general income yield	a	1,154	1,228
Plus or minus adjustments ²	b	—	(9)
Notional general income	c = a + b	1,154	1,219
Permissible income calculation			
Percentage increase	d	3.50%	4.10%
Plus percentage increase amount ³	f = d x (c + e)	40	50
Sub-total	g = (c + e + f)	1,194	1,269
Plus (or minus) last year's carry forward total	h	33	(1)
Sub-total	j = (h + i)	33	(1)
Total permissible income	k = g + j	1,227	1,268
Less notional general income yield	l	1,228	1,275
Catch-up or (excess) result	m = k - l	(1)	(7)
Carry forward to next year ⁴	p = m + n + o	(1)	(7)

Notes

- (1) The notional general income will not reconcile with rate income in the financial statements in the corresponding year. The statements are reported on an accrual accounting basis which include amounts that relate to prior years' rates income.
- (2) Adjustments account for changes in the number of assessments and any increase or decrease in land value occurring during the year. The adjustments are called 'supplementary valuations' as defined in the *Valuation of Land Act 1916 (NSW)*.
- (3) The 'percentage increase' is inclusive of the rate-peg percentage, and/or special variation and/or Crown land adjustment (where applicable).
- (4) Carry-forward amounts which are in excess (an amount that exceeds the permissible income) require Ministerial approval by order published in the *NSW Government Gazette* in accordance with section 512 of the Act. The OLG will extract these amounts from Council's Permissible income for general rates Statement in the financial data return (FDR) to administer this process.



INDEPENDENT AUDITOR'S REPORT

Special Schedule – Permissible income for general rates

Brewarrina Shire Council

To the Councillors of Brewarrina Shire Council

Opinion

I have audited the accompanying Special Schedule – Permissible income for general rates (the Schedule) of Brewarrina Shire Council (the Council) for the year ending 30 June 2026.

In my opinion, the Schedule is prepared, in all material respects in accordance with the requirements of the Local Government Code of Accounting Practice and Financial Reporting 2024–25 (LG Code) and is in accordance with the books and records of the Council.

My opinion should be read in conjunction with the rest of this report.

Basis for Opinion

I conducted my audit in accordance with Australian Auditing Standards. My responsibilities under the standards are described in the 'Auditor's Responsibilities for the Audit of the Schedule' section of my report.

I am independent of the Council in accordance with the requirements of the:

- Australian Auditing Standards
- Accounting Professional and Ethical Standards Board's APES 110 'Code of Ethics for Professional Accountants (including Independence Standards)' (APES 110).

Parliament promotes independence by ensuring the Auditor-General and the Audit Office of New South Wales are not compromised in their roles by:

- providing that only Parliament, and not the executive government, can remove an Auditor-General
- mandating the Auditor-General as auditor of councils
- precluding the Auditor-General from providing non-audit services.

I have fulfilled my other ethical responsibilities in accordance with APES 110.

I believe that the audit evidence I have obtained is sufficient and appropriate to provide a basis for my audit opinion.

Emphasis of Matter - Basis of Accounting

Without modifying my opinion, I draw attention to the special purpose framework used to prepare the Schedule. The Schedule has been prepared for the purpose of fulfilling the Council's reporting obligations under the LG Code. As a result, the Schedule may not be suitable for another purpose.

Other Information

The Council's annual report for the year ended 30 June 2025 includes other information in addition to the Schedule and my Independent Auditor's Report thereon. The Councillors are responsible for the other information. At the date of this Independent Auditor's Report, the other information I have received comprise the general purpose financial statements, special purpose financial statements and Special Schedule 'Report on infrastructure assets as at 30 June 2025.

My opinion on the Schedule does not cover the other information. Accordingly, I do not express any form of assurance conclusion on the other information. However, as required by the *Local Government Act 1993*, I have separately expressed an opinion on the general purpose financial statements and the special purpose financial statements.

In connection with my audit of the Schedule, my responsibility is to read the other information and, in doing so, consider whether the other information is materially inconsistent with the Schedule or my knowledge obtained in the audit, or otherwise appears to be materially misstated.

If, based on the work I have performed, I conclude there is a material misstatement of the other information, I must report that fact.

I have nothing to report in this regard.

The Councillors' Responsibilities for the Schedule

The Councillors are responsible for the preparation of the Schedule in accordance with the LG Code. The Councillors' responsibility also includes such internal control as the Councillors determine is necessary to enable the preparation of the Schedule that is free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud or error.

In preparing the Schedule, the Councillors are responsible for assessing the Council's ability to continue as a going concern, disclosing, as applicable, matters related to going concern and using the going concern basis of accounting.

Auditor's Responsibilities for the Audit of the Schedule

My objectives are to:

- obtain reasonable assurance whether the Schedule as a whole is free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud or error
- issue an Independent Auditor's Report including my opinion.

Reasonable assurance is a high level of assurance, but does not guarantee an audit conducted in accordance with Australian Auditing Standards will always detect material misstatements.

Misstatements can arise from fraud or error. Misstatements are considered material if, individually or in aggregate, they could reasonably be expected to influence the economic decisions users take based on the Schedule.

A description of my responsibilities for the audit of the Schedule is located at the Auditing and Assurance Standards Board website at: www.auasb.gov.au/auditors_responsibilities/ar8.pdf. The description forms part of my auditor's report.

The scope of my audit does not include, nor provide assurance:

- that the Council carried out its activities effectively, efficiently and economically
- about the security and controls over the electronic publication of the audited Schedule on any website where it may be presented
- about any other information which may have been hyperlinked to/from the Schedule.



Hong Wee Soh
Delegate of the Auditor-General for New South Wales

29 October 2025
SYDNEY

Brewarrina Shire Council

Report on infrastructure assets as at 30 June 2025

Asset Class	Asset Category	Estimated cost to bring assets to satisfactory standard	Estimated cost to bring to the agreed level of service set by Council	2024/25 Required maintenance ^a	2024/25 Actual maintenance	Net carrying amount	Gross replacement cost (GRC)	Assets in condition as a percentage of gross replacement cost				
		\$ '000	\$ '000	\$ '000	\$ '000			1	2	3	4	5
Buildings	Buildings – specialised	663	182	133	133	27,444	40,233	30.0%	36.0%	25.0%	8.0%	1.0%
	Buildings – non-specialised	291	255	–	–	2,120	3,845	26.0%	10.0%	33.0%	24.0%	7.0%
	Sub-total	954	437	133	133	29,564	44,078	29.7%	33.7%	25.7%	9.4%	1.5%
Other structures	Other structures	419	486	–	–	6,062	9,603	42.0%	20.0%	23.0%	10.0%	5.0%
	Sub-total	419	486	–	–	6,062	9,603	42.0%	20.0%	23.0%	10.0%	5.0%
Roads, Bridges & Footpaths	Sealed	3,233	3,038	217	217	125,187	162,628	64.0%	25.0%	3.0%	5.0%	3.0%
	Unsealed roads	432	227	20	20	15,415	22,959	47.0%	10.0%	36.0%	7.0%	0.0%
	Bridges	–	–	1	1	16,351	25,105	42.0%	33.0%	25.0%	0.0%	0.0%
	Footpaths	41	–	–	–	3,008	4,232	55.0%	35.0%	6.0%	4.0%	0.0%
	Sub-total	3,706	3,265	238	238	162,871	214,924	59.4%	24.5%	9.2%	4.6%	2.3%
Water supply network	Water supply network	2,365	4,783	–	–	15,651	28,146	20.0%	34.0%	12.0%	17.0%	17.0%
	Sub-total	2,365	4,783	–	–	15,651	28,146	20.0%	34.0%	12.0%	17.0%	17.0%
Sewerage network	Sewerage network	1,438	1,799	–	–	8,793	15,880	16.0%	42.0%	10.0%	20.0%	12.0%
	Sub-total	1,438	1,799	–	–	8,792	15,880	16.0%	42.0%	10.0%	20.0%	12.0%
Stormwater drainage	Stormwater drainage	331	–	2	2	714	2,039	1.5%	10.0%	2.0%	86.0%	0.5%
	Sub-total	331	–	2	2	714	2,039	1.5%	10.0%	2.0%	86.0%	0.5%
Open space / recreational assets	Swimming pools	532	1,539	81	81	1,685	3,250	29.0%	21.0%	2.0%	1.0%	47.0%
	Other recreational	19	–	232	232	2,129	2,383	87.0%	8.0%	3.0%	2.0%	0.0%
	Sub-total	551	1,539	313	313	3,814	5,633	53.5%	15.5%	2.4%	1.4%	27.2%
Aerodromes	Aerodromes	–	337	36	36	3,233	4,884	5.0%	83.0%	0.0%	5.0%	7.0%
	Sub-total	–	337	36	36	–	4,884	5.0%	83.0%	0.0%	5.0%	7.0%
Additional asset class (if required)	Levee Bank – Levee Bank	411	822	–	–	4,899	7,299	33.0%	33.0%	22.0%	0.0%	12.0%
	Sub-total	411	822	–	–	4,899	7,299	33.0%	33.0%	22.0%	0.0%	12.0%
Total – all assets		10,175	13,468	722	722	232,367	332,486	47.7%	28.1%	12.0%	7.5%	4.7%

Brewarrina Shire Council

Report on infrastructure assets as at 30 June 2025 (continued)

(a) Required maintenance is the amount identified in Council's asset management plans.

Infrastructure asset condition assessment 'key'

#	Condition	Integrated planning and reporting (IP&R) description
1	Excellent/very good	No work required (normal maintenance)
2	Good	Only minor maintenance work required
3	Satisfactory	Maintenance work required
4	Poor	Renewal required
5	Very poor	Urgent renewal/upgrading required

Brewarrina Shire Council

Report on infrastructure assets as at 30 June 2025

Infrastructure asset performance indicators (consolidated) *

	Amounts 2025 \$ '000	Indicator 2025	Indicators 2024 2023		Benchmark
Buildings and infrastructure renewals ratio					
Asset renewals ¹	2,072	43.96%	3.35%	37.62%	> 100.00%
Depreciation, amortisation and impairment	4,713				
Infrastructure backlog ratio					
Estimated cost to bring assets to a satisfactory standard	10,175	4.32%	4.31%	4.48%	< 2.00%
Net carrying amount of infrastructure assets	235,730				
Asset maintenance ratio					
Actual asset maintenance	722	100.00%	100.00%	100.00%	> 100.00%
Required asset maintenance	722				
Cost to bring assets to agreed service level					
Estimated cost to bring assets to an agreed service level set by Council	13,468	4.05%	4.18%	5.16%	
Gross replacement cost	332,486				

(*) All asset performance indicators are calculated using classes identified in the previous table.

(1) Asset renewals represent the replacement and/or refurbishment of existing assets to an equivalent capacity/performance as opposed to the acquisition of new assets (or the refurbishment of old assets) that increases capacity/performance.

Brewarrina Shire Council

Report on infrastructure assets as at 30 June 2025

Infrastructure asset performance indicators (by fund)

\$ '000	General fund		Water fund		Sewer fund		Benchmark
	2025	2024	2025	2024	2025	2024	
Buildings and infrastructure renewals ratio							
Asset renewals ¹							
Depreciation, amortisation and impairment	13.73%	3.89%	222.47%	0.00%	159.38%	0.00%	> 100.00%
Infrastructure backlog ratio							
Estimated cost to bring assets to a satisfactory standard							
Net carrying amount of infrastructure assets	3.02%	3.27%	15.11%	15.40%	16.36%	15.83%	< 2.00%
Asset maintenance ratio							
Actual asset maintenance							
Required asset maintenance	100.00%	100.00%	∞	100.00%	∞	100.00%	> 100.00%
Cost to bring assets to agreed service level							
Estimated cost to bring assets to an agreed service level set by Council							
Gross replacement cost	2.39%	2.50%	16.99%	18.01%	11.33%	11.41%	

(1) Asset renewals represent the replacement and/or refurbishment of existing assets to an equivalent capacity/performance as opposed to the acquisition of new assets (or the refurbishment of old assets) that increases capacity/performance.

Internal audit and risk management attestation statement for the 2024/25 financial year for Brewarrina Shire Council

I am of the opinion that Brewarrina Shire Council ("Council") has an audit, risk and improvement committee, risk management framework and internal audit function that operate in compliance with the following requirements except as may be otherwise provided below:

Audit, risk and improvement committee

	Requirement	Compliance
1.	Council has appointed an audit, risk and improvement committee that comprises of an independent chairperson and at least two independent members (section 428A of the <i>Local Government Act 1993</i> , section 216C of the <i>Local Government (General) Regulation 2021</i>).	Compliant
2.	The chairperson and all members of Council's audit, risk and improvement committee meet the relevant independence and eligibility criteria prescribed under the <i>Local Government (General) Regulation 2021</i> and have not exceeded the membership term limits prescribed under the Regulation (sections 216D, 216E, 216F, 216G of the <i>Local Government (General) Regulation 2021</i>).	Compliant
3.	Council has adopted terms of reference for its audit, risk and improvement committee that are informed by the model terms of reference approved by the Departmental Chief Executive of the Office of Local Government and the committee operates in accordance with the terms of reference (section 216K of the <i>Local Government (General) Regulation 2021</i>).	Compliant
4.	Council provides the audit, risk and improvement committee with direct and unrestricted access to the General Manager and other senior management and the information and resources necessary to exercise its functions (section 216L of the <i>Local Government (General) Regulation 2021</i>).	Compliant
5.	Council's audit, risk and improvement committee exercises its functions in accordance with a four-year strategic work plan that has been endorsed by the governing body and an annual work plan that has been developed in consultation with the governing body and senior management (Core requirement 1 of the Office of Local Government's <i>Guidelines for Risk Management and Internal Audit for Local Government in NSW</i>).	Compliant
6.	Council's audit, risk and improvement committee provides the governing body with an annual assessment each year, and a strategic assessment each council term of the matters listed in section 428A of the <i>Local Government Act 1993</i> reviewed during that term (Core requirement 1 of the Office of Local Government's <i>Guidelines for Risk Management and Internal Audit for Local Government in NSW</i>).	[not yet due]

	Requirement	Compliance
7.	The governing body of Council reviews the effectiveness of the audit, risk and improvement committee at least once each council term (Core requirement 1 of the Office of Local Government's <i>Guidelines for Risk Management and Internal Audit for Local Government in NSW</i>).	[not yet due]

Membership

The chairperson and membership of the audit, risk and improvement committee are:

Chairperson	Ron Gillard	30 June 2025	30 June 2029
Independent member	Grantley Wilson	30 June 2025	30 June 2028
Independent member	Liz Jeremy	30 June 2025	30 June 2028
Councillor member	Clr Belinda Colless	30 June 2025	8 September 2028

Risk Management

	Requirement	Compliance
8.	Council has adopted a risk management framework that is consistent with current Australian risk management standard and that is appropriate for the Council's risks (section 216S of the <i>Local Government (General) Regulation 2021</i>).	Compliant
9.	Council's audit, risk and improvement committee reviews the implementation of its risk management framework and provides a strategic assessment of its effectiveness to the governing body each council term (section 216S of the <i>Local Government (General) Regulation 2021</i>).	[not yet due]

Internal Audit

	Requirement	Compliance
10.	Council has an internal audit function that reviews the Council's operations and risk management and control activities (section 216O of the <i>Local Government (General) Regulation 2021</i>).	Compliant
11.	Council's internal audit function reports to the audit, risk and improvement committee on internal audit matters (sections 216M, 216P and 216R of the <i>Local Government (General) Regulation 2021</i>).	Compliant
12.	Council's internal audit function is independent and internal audit activities are not subject to direction by the Council (section 216P of the <i>Local Government (General) Regulation 2021</i>).	Compliant
13.	Council has adopted an internal audit charter that is informed by the model internal audit charter approved by the Departmental Chief Executive of the Office of Local Government and the internal audit function operates in accordance with the charter (section 216O of the <i>Local Government (General) Regulation 2021</i>).	Compliant

	Requirement	Compliance
14.	Council has appointed a member of staff to direct and coordinate internal audit activities (section 216P of the <i>Local Government (General) Regulation 2021</i>).	Compliant
15.	Internal audit activities are conducted in accordance with the International Professional Practices Framework (Core requirement 3 of the Office of Local Government's <i>Guidelines for Risk Management and Internal Audit for Local Government in NSW</i>).	Compliant
16.	Council provides the internal audit function with direct and unrestricted access to staff, the audit, risk and improvement committee, and the information and resources necessary to undertake internal audit activities (section 216P of the <i>Local Government (General) Regulation 2021</i>).	Compliant
17.	Council's internal audit function undertakes internal audit activities in accordance with a four-year strategic work plan that has been endorsed by the governing body and an annual work plan that has been developed in consultation with the governing body and senior management (Core requirement 3 of the Office of Local Government's <i>Guidelines for Risk Management and Internal Audit for Local Government in NSW</i>).	Not compliant [development and endorsement of internal audit plans will occur during 2025-26]
18.	Council's audit, risk and improvement committee reviews the effectiveness of the internal audit function and reports the outcome of the review to the governing body each council term (section 216R of the <i>Local Government (General) Regulation 2021</i>).	[not yet due]



David Kirby – General Manager

10th October 2025



BREWARRINA SHIRE COUNCIL

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION
PLEASE CONTACT

Phone: 02 6830 5100

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